THURSDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2026

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THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPEN

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON[(1)]: FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

[(1)] *UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided in the Pre-Issue and Price Band advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

[1] *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

[2] *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

[3] *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ million)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

ASBA* Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

* Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, please check section on ASBA below.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI - UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (iii) Eligible RIL Shareholders in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion; (iv) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section **"Issue Procedure"** on page 534 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (**"AIBI"**) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, Axis Bank Limited and State Bank of India have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opened on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on(1)	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

(1) *UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, i.e. Friday, October 23, 2026*

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail: mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary	Compliance Officer
Ms. Savithri Parekh	Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

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AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000; **BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000; **Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183; **BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999; **CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000; **HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289; **ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100; **IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728; **Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000; **JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000; **SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807; **UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000; **and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000; **Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400, **Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "**Risk Factors**" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

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The Editorial Page: Let's recreate the UN — 81 years show why it's worth the effort 8

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DAY AFTER RUBIO SAYS '99% OF WORK DONE' ON A BILATERAL TRADE AGREEMENT

Pretty close, a much different kind of deal: Trump on India trade pact

Signals deal will be unlike the ones the US has with others

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 21

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump has said that the US and India are "pretty close" to a bilateral trade agreement which will be "a much different kind of deal" than the pacts that the US has with others.

INSIDE PAGE 5
AT JAMNAGAR FACILITY, RUBIO DISCUSSES ENERGY AND TECH

Responding to a question on the India trade agreement, Trump, while speaking to reporters at the Oval Office, said, "They want to make a deal. We are going to make a deal. Pretty close, yeah. It's going to be a »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, RIL Chairman and MD Mukesh Ambani and US Ambassador Sergio Gor in Jamnagar, Wednesday. PTI

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



EXPRESS INVESTIGATION PART 1

Dry for a decade, Bihar hit by a new lethal high: Drugs & addicts

Crackdown on liquor masks alarming surge in narcotics that has stretched security and health apparatus: NDPS cases rise four-fold in 6 years, pills seizure 30-fold in 4 years

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, October 21

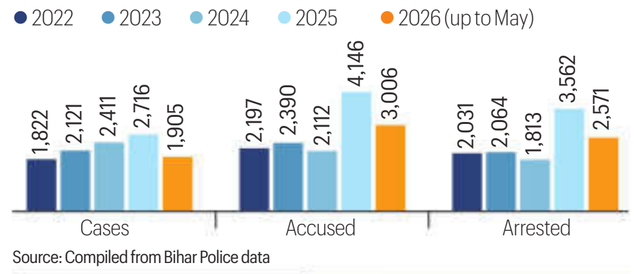
IN THE 10 years since Bihar imposed prohibition, its police have seized around 3.16 crore litres of liquor and made around 7.15 lakh related arrests across the state — around 8,650 litres and 196 arrests on an average, every day. This is known. What is under the radar, however, is that beyond the smuggled bottle, a parallel world of intoxicants is taking shape — one that involves pocket-sized packets, tablet strips, heroin to a distinctive variant "kota", vials, soap boxes or even a petticoat fold.

For a police force that spent a decade learning to find contraband liquor in trains, tankers and horse-borne consignments, the fast-emerging market in drugs has set off a series of alarm bells they have begun tuning into, an investigation by *The Indian Express* shows.

Over the past three months, this newspaper reviewed case records and official data, and spoke to police officers, social workers and doctors to find how Bihar's drugs map has steadily — and very sharply — expanded, shifting to newer districts; how police fear this market is fuelling juvenile crime; and how treatment has hardly kept pace, with Centrally supported facilities operating in less than one-third of the state's districts.

The numbers from the state and Centre capture the crisis — key indicators have jumped:

NUMBERS RISING, ALARMS RINGING
Details of cases registered in Bihar under NDPS Act



Source: Compiled from Bihar Police data

20-FOLD RISE IN 3 YRS
Beneficiaries of de-addiction centres in Bihar supported under Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan
1,639 (2023-24)
1,487 (2022-23)
29,429 (2024-25)

Source: Reply in Parliament dated March 10, 2026, by MoS Social Justice and Empowerment

● Data compiled by the Bihar Police HQ shows that the number of cases registered under the National Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act in the first five months of 2026 alone (1,905) was 83 cases more than those registered in the whole of 2022 (*see chart*). This number was only 697 in 2019.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 10

IED disguised as torch behind blast that injured two in Bengaluru: Probe

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, October 21

PRELIMINARY INVESTIGATIONS into a blast that occurred on October 20 at an under-construction building in east Bengaluru, in which two workers from UP and Assam were injured, have revealed that an Improvised Explosive Device (IED) disguised as a torch caused the explosion, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

One of the injured, Suraj Kumar (28), a painter from Gorakhpur, suffered the brunt of »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'No more Jantar Mantar protest call': Das, Ranka give undertaking, freed

Earlier, HC enquired if they were Gen Z, flagged talk about 'regime change'

Pragynesh & Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 21

BRINGING TO an end the seven-day judicial custody of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, a Special Executive Magistrate (SEM) in New Delhi ordered their release Wednesday after they gave an »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



CJP's Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka after their release. ANI

'Wrong to curb art': Vadra son Raihan as his photos on protests are removed

Anusree K C
New Delhi, October 21

VISUAL ARTIST and curator Raihan Rajiv Vadra, son of Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and businessman Robert Vadra, said Wednesday that he was told by authorities to "remove/replace 74 out of 105" »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Raihan Vadra with one of his exhibits at Bikaner House. PTI

Happening today

● **PRESIDENT DROUPADI** Murmu will begin a two-day visit to Chhattisgarh.

● **INDIA FACE** New Zealand in the first of the five-match T20 International at Christchurch.

Coma patient's kin unable to access bank funds, HC seeks RBI and Centre's stand

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, October 21

IN JULY, Parveen Jahan had approached the Allahabad High Court seeking access to her comatose husband's bank account. The family was going through financial hardship and needed money to pay for his medical expenses. But her husband died on October 8 while the petition remained pending.

Taking stern view of the Uttar Pradesh Chief Secretary's failure to comply with a 2020 judgment and implement guidelines to help families in such situations, a division bench of Justices Ajit Kumar and Garima Prashad said: "It is indeed a matter of concern that a person who passes away in a state of coma, the dependents become absolutely remediless in a sense that they do not have necessary funds and source of finances to not only take care of the patient by meeting expenses of the hospital but even to manage the household."

The bench, which was hearing the matter the day the patient died, directed that the central government and Reserve Bank of India be impleaded as respondents.

"…. Some sort of legislation from the competent legislature or even guidelines… from the Reserve Bank of India regulating nationalised banks and subsidiary banks… for providing a necessary mechanism as to how money lying in the savings bank account of such patients can be released in favour of the dependents. The central government, therefore, has to come up with its stand on the issue in black and white. We also need the Reserve Bank of India to give its response…," it said.

The next hearing is scheduled for November 6.

Jahan had approached the court stating that her husband, Shamshad Ali, had slipped into a coma and finances were needed for further treatment and care. She sought to be declared his guardian so that she could withdraw money from his SBI account at a Kanpur branch.

During the August hearing, Jahan's counsel cited a 2020 Allahabad HC judgment in Uma Mittal and others v. Union of India and others, submitting despite the guidelines and recommendations made that year, no steps were taken to implement them. The 2020 judgment had drawn on a judgment of a division bench of the Kerala HC, which had framed broad guidelines for appointing guardians of people in a comatose state. Finding those guidelines sound, the Allahabad HC had said they can be used as a framework for state until legislation could be enacted to specify how guardians should be appointed.

One of the key provisions stated that the guardian appointed should be the spouse or a child of the person in a coma.

In its August order, while hearing Jahan's petition, the bench had reproduced the 2020 guidelines and the Chief Secretary was directed to file an affidavit on what steps have been taken in compliance with it.

When the matter came up in September, the bench did not receive any communication from the Chief Secretary on compliance. The bench said that judgments laying down guidelines were often ignored unless coercive action was taken.

The Chief Secretary was then asked to file his affidavit within three days, without fail, in compliance with the August order.

In its October 8 order, the court noted that the Chief Secretary, in his affidavit, had sought more time, stating that enacting legislation would require a lengthy process involving the competent legislature.

"… We make it clear that if the Chief Secretary does not come up with such a solution in black and white, he will have to appear in person before this Court on the next date fixed. The Reserve Bank of India and the Central Government will have to file their respective affidavits, failing which the court will be compelled to summon the officers responsible for both…," the bench said.

IIT Madras launches finishing school to bridge skills gap

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

GIVEN THE rapid pace at which India's biotechnology and biopharmaceutical sectors are expanding, there is a growing dearth in professionals with practical expertise.

And that is precisely what the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M) hopes to address with its latest school, UDYOG (Upskilling and Development for Young Graduates).

This industry-oriented finishing school will bridge the gap between academic education and industry requirements by equipping students with practical skills and professional competencies required by the biotechnology and biomanufacturing sectors.

It will follow a three-stage training pathway. The first comprises three months of online learning delivered through Centre for Outreach and Digital Education (CODE), supplemented by lectures from industry experts.

Next comes a four-week intensive hands-on training programme at the institute's Biofoundry, launched on Wednesday. Here, students will be introduced to laboratory processes and manufacturing workflows.

"Following this training, selected participants may have opportunities to engage with industry partners and participate in interviews for long-term internships, providing a potential pathway from academic learning to workplace experience," IIT Madras said. "AI also means Academia-Industry. It is becoming an absolute necessity that every discipline of science and engineering must look at AI with care to make themselves relevant to the modern world. UDYOG is yet another effort taken by IIT Madras in this direction," IIT-M director V Kamakoti said.

The first batch of UDYOG will start from January next year and the early-bird registration closes on December 15, 2026.



[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Pretty close, a much different kind of deal: Trump on India trade pact

much different kind of deal than we have done."

This echoes what US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told *The Indian Express* a day earlier when he said the two sides are "incredibly close" to signing the deal, and that "99 per cent of the work" had been done.

Since early 2025 when the Trump administration entered office a second time, the US has inked trade pacts with Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, the United Kingdom and the European Union.

On Tuesday, Rubio said, "I don't want to get into the details of the sticking points. I can simply tell you that (they are) there. I won't call them technicalities, but it's language-related. It's basically down to what certain words mean, what certain phrases mean. Because it's important for both sides to have full agreement. Both sides have to 100% agree on what a deal means. If they don't, then in the future it can unravel… I think we are incredibly close. The way I would say it is, we are weeks, not months, away from, I think, finalising it. I think 99% of the work is done. The remaining factor, you have to have 100% done. But I feel very positive about the trajectory that it's on."

The trade deal, which has been in the works since February 2025 after Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Trump agreed to launch negotiations, had hit a hurdle after ties soured in May 2025.

Trump's claim to brokering the ceasefire after the India-Pakistan hostilities in the wake of Operation Sindoor put a spanner in the ties. The imposition of 50 per cent tariffs — 25 per cent as reciprocal tariffs and another 25 per cent for buying Russian energy — queered the pitch for the trade deal. Talks picked up momentum after India reduced Russian oil imports.

The two sides agreed on a framework in early February this year, and were expected to sign the deal by March. But the US Supreme Court's order in February striking down the President's emergency wartime powers to impose tariffs on countries changed the negotiating field.

Indian negotiators were said to have started renegotiating the terms and the tariffs in the changed circumstances. Delhi and Washington have since been trying to bridge the gap.

In the last six months, the negotiations have been close, but have not been concluded. On October 1, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the Trump administration was working with India to finalise a bilateral trade deal, but added that an agreement was "not imminent".

On October 5, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that trade negotiations had reached a "plateau", that further concessions or demands from either side had become "very, very difficult" as tariffs were being increasingly weaponised.

On October 14, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said the two countries continued to engage to iron out differences over the deal, and negotiations were heading towards a "landing point".

The very next day, US Ambassador Sergio Gor, on being asked about the status of the negotiations, said, "I won't like to get into too many details at this stage, and let the ministers announce that. But in the grand scheme of things, big items are done."

"We are actively engaged… Within three weeks of arriving here, we announced a trade deal. The European Union trade deal took almost 20 years. So we are at an incredible pace, and I am confident that we will get it done. We are getting there. I am confident that we will have a trade deal here, as you heard Dr Jaishankar say right on this stage, and we are very close to landing it."

On October 16, Trump's decision to pause a new law – the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 – that authorised imposition of tariffs up to 100% on top buyers of Russian energy came as a relief for India, one of the top two destinations for Russian crude.

In fact, Rubio told *The Indian Express* Tuesday that Trump did not impose tariffs on India because of their close ties. "One of the reasons why he didn't impose them is because he understands that it would have a very detrimental impact on a very important relationship with India. So, it's part of balancing foreign policy, and it's difficult because, on the one hand, you want to make sure you can pressure the warring parties to the table to negotiate an outcome in that war… and, on the other hand, sometimes by imposing pressure through tariffs, you are creating stress on other important relationships… I think the President is trying very hard to balance that… but it will be a challenge," he said.

Having paused the punitive tariffs, Trump's statement is amplifying the message that the deal is close. Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met Greer in Milwaukee and Washington earlier this month to discuss the finer aspects of the trade deal.

With the US midterm elections weeks from now, and an expected visit by Prime Minister Modi to the US for the G20 leaders' summit in December, there is once again momentum to conclude the negotiations and sign the deal.

Officials said Rubio's visit to Mumbai was an outreach to India's business elite – he met top business leaders – and his conversation with Jaishankar was focussed on India buying energy and defence equipment from the US.

This appears to be paving the framework for the trade deal, which is expected to reach the USD 500 billion trade target by 2030, set by Trump and Modi at their February 2025 meeting in the White House.

EXPLAINED

Working on the fineprint

Remarks by Trump and his team and Jaishankar suggest that the two sides have been actively working on the fineprint of the proposed trade deal. This comes after months of strained relations over the imposition of tariffs, especially over India's purchase of Russian energy, and Trump's claims of brokering a ceasefire between India and Pakistan in May 2025 following hostilities in the wake of Operation Sindoor.

IED disguised as torch behind Bengaluru blast

the impact, losing two fingers, along with severe burns and shrapnel wounds on his face, head and chest. The other, Alauddin Barbhaij (53) from Dimapur, a security guard at the seven-storey building site in Pulakeshinagar, suffered a minor injury on his eye, said sources in hospitals that treated them.

Police sources told this newspaper that Barbhaij, who had been working at the construction site for around 15 days, obtained a parcel on the afternoon of October 20 at the ground floor of the site. "CCTV footage shows the parcel was delivered by an unidentified person and was picked up by the security guard," the sources said.

"The guard called Kumar, who was on the seventh floor, for help to activate a torch that was in the parcel. The guard then took the torch up to the fifth floor. There, the torch exploded in Kumar's hands when he tried to switch it on," the sources said.

"My brother was working on the seventh floor and I was on the sixth floor. We don't know how he came down but somebody seems to have called him down. After the incident happened he was lying on the floor bleeding profusely. We did not wait for a moment to see what happened and rushed him to hospital," said Abhi Kumar (18), Suraj's brother.

"We were working in the building for only two days when the incident happened. We do not know any one at a personal level at the building. We have not been able to ask him how it happened as his face is badly injured," Abhi said.

"The IED torch contained a small amount of explosive material in the form of gunpowder (nitroglycerin and nitrocellulose), with the torch battery providing energy to trigger a detonator. It contained some ball bearings, which acted as shrapnel and pierced the victim and nearby windows," sources said.

"The torch was converted into a small but powerful IED to target an individual rather than for terrorism. The torch completely disintegrated," sources said.

Bengaluru Police began questioning Barbhaij on Wednesday after he was discharged from the Minto Eye Hospital following minor treatment for a cut near his eye from the blast. The guard has been providing contradictory versions of the incident, sources said.

The police, however, have not officially confirmed that an IED was involved in the blast. Police Commissioner Seemant Kumar said police were awaiting final results of a forensic examination to establish the nature of the device. "There is nothing to panic about at this stage. The festive season is underway, and we are very alert. We are investigating the incident and are not ruling out anything," he said.

Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge said material recovered from the site was being examined. "We are evaluating that. All materials have gone for a forensic audit," he said.

(WITH ATIYA FIRDOS)

Das, Ranka freed

undertaking that they would not call for any further protest at Jantar Mantar until it remained a denotified site.

Sent to judicial custody on October 14, a day after the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the special intensive revision of electoral rolls, Das and Ranka were produced before the SEM at Mandir Marg police station.

The SEM's order stated that both Das and Ranka gave a written undertaking promising to maintain "peace and tranquillity".

"We will not make any calls for protest at Jantar Mantar till such a time that it is denotified in accordance with law. That we further reiterate that any protest undertaken would be done within the four corners of the Constitution," the undertaking stated. The SEM's order also directed Das and Ranka to furnish personal bonds and surety bonds worth Rs 50,000.

Welcoming their release, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, in a post on X, said, "Saurav and Ashu are not just better but much, much bigger leaders than me. Happy to follow your orders, my leaders. Jaan hazir hai. Lekin iske baad mere bina garden mein koi akela nahi ghumega!!! (After this, don't walk in the garden without me)."

AAP leader Arvind Kejriwal also welcomed the SEM"s order releasing Das and Ranka and said the entire nation stands with them.

Earlier in the day, Das and Ranka withdrew their plea from the Delhi High Court where they had challenged the SEM order extending their judicial custody. They took back the plea after the High Court pointed out that they had breached a peace bond signed earlier, and that they had an alternative remedy available.

Addressing their counsel Abhik Chimni, the bench of Justice Subramonium Prasad observed that the bond furnished on October 10 was breached the very next day, October 11. He said the High Court examines the decision-making process rather than the decision itself, unless the decision is so perverse that it "shocks the conscience".

The bench also asked whether authorities were entitled to demand stricter proof when Das and Ranka had "breached" the peace bond for a second time by trespassing at Jantar Mantar and waving a flag.

Justice Prasad remarked, "The two petitioners are out there at the forefront. Now when you go there (Jantar Mantar) and break a barricade – the barricade is meant for a particular purpose – chances of 10-20 more people violating are very bright… There can be persons who might not be in your control and who do things… We have seen it outside the country… You could start with something which is peaceful but then you cannot control… police permission is just not to stop you, it is also to prevent unwanted elements from joining your group and spoiling the name."

Questioning why their plea should be entertained, the bench pointed to the alternative remedy of challenging the SEM's October 19 order before an appellate court. It noted that even as it was hearing the matter, the outcome of the proceedings before the magistrate concerning the duo's custody remained to be seen.

Chimni, along with advocate Pranjal Abrol, said Das and Ranka should not have to spend another two days in custody and questioned the legality of the October 19 order. He contended that the magistrate lacked jurisdiction to extend their custody.

During the hearing, Justice Prasad also asked the age of Das and Ranka. When Chimni said they were 27 and 31, respectively, the judge remarked, "So you are not Gen Z?"

He said the initial protest had involved students and young people, including Gen Z, but the cause appeared to be changing while the same people remained involved.

"Why I am asking (about their ages) is… the first protest (in July, triggered by the NEET-UG paper leak) was a student protest, children were there… Now cause is changing, people are remaining the same… Suddenly they are talking about 'regime change', about 'ballot'… What is your purpose, what do you do in your life otherwise… We will have to go into all these questions then," Justice Prasad said.

The bench, meanwhile, adjourned All India Students' Association president Neha Bora's plea to Thursday. She had challenged a notice by the SEM to explain why she should not sign a bond assuring she will maintain peace.

Ranka and Das were arrested on October 14 for allegedly breaching security and entering Jantar Mantar during the protests. On October 19, the SEM extended their custody by two days, taking the total time in custody to seven days.

The order signed by SEM Ritu Raj, an ACP-rank officer with Delhi Police, had said that the conduct of Ranka and Das did not inspire "confidence", that they have "no respect for law" and that they have habitually called for protests at a denotified site.

'Not a puppet': RSS-affiliated trade union opens first office in Kashmir

Bashaarat Masood
Awantipora, October 21

A NARROW lane branches off the highway and winds its way towards Barsoo, a secluded village in Awantipora in south Kashmir's Pulwama district. At its entrance stands a single-storey building, fitted with security cameras and fronted by steel railings, as police personnel stand guard. There is no signboard or flag, only a small signboard that reads "office".

This is the divisional office of the Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh (BMS), the RSS-affiliated trade union. It is the RSS' first affiliate to have opened its office publicly in Kashmir.

For years, the RSS and its affiliates have maintained a low profile in the Valley, working discreetly, especially in border areas, where the Sewa Bharti run and fund schools besides undertaking projects to renovate ancient temples.

The opening of the BMS office, however, marks a shift from a discreet presence to a visible public footprint.

"This is the first experience of a Sangathan office in Kashmir. It is time to work openly and not discreetly. The situation in Kashmir has changed and we are coming forward now," says 36-year-old Sameer Kuchay, the BMS's Kashmir in-charge.

The BMS claims to have 20 affiliated labour unions in Kashmir. While most remain marginal players, the affiliations give the BMS a foothold in the Valley, where the BJP and its ideological mentor RSS continue to face resistance.



BMS's Kashmir in-charge Sameer Kuchay. EXPRESS

Kuchay knows this from personal experience. A resident of Barsoo, he joined the Sangh in 2016, when Kashmir was witnessing a resurgence of militancy with Burhan Wani at its centre.

"I have seen it at home," he says. "There were days when even my relatives wouldn't touch the glass from which I drank water. They would use a cloth to pick it up. For them, I was a Sanghi. I remember posting a video of myself hoisting the Tricolour on Facebook. I received 1,384 comments. Of those, 1,382 were abuses."

For Kuchay, Kashmir has come a long way since. And, on Monday, the BMS's first office in the Valley was opened in his village, Barsoo. But he is reluctant to attach any element of bravado to the development. "We have a strong presence in the four districts of south Kashmir," he says. "We chose Awantipora as our divisional office because it is accessible to both south Kashmir and Srinagar."

Kuchay seeks to maintain a distance from the BJP in the Valley, much as BJP leaders appear keen to distance themselves from his organisation. BJP leaders say they are unaware of any BMS office in the Valley, while the BMS insists it is not anyone's "puppet".

"We are not the puppets of the BJP or any other party. We have nothing to do with politics and nothing to do with religion. There is a feeling that we are anti-Muslim. There is nothing like that. We have nothing to do with religion," says Kuchay.

He hopes this message will help the organisation reach out to people in the Valley. "I try to convince people. I tell them, 'If you feel the RSS is bad, come and join us and see for yourself,'" he says. "We are far from politics."

While the RSS has little or no presence in Kashmir, over the last many years, especially after the abrogation of Article 370 in 2019, the organisation has been trying to have a footprint in the Valley.

The Sangh previously had some presence among Kashmiri Pandits but halted its activities in 1990 after the community left the Valley following the onset of militancy.

The Sangh's critics, however, call the development a "state-sponsored project". "The administrative machinery pushing a certain organisation is not surprising," says CPI(M) leader and Centre of Indian Trade Unions (CITU) chief M Y Tarigami. "But the fact is that everybody knows what RSS stands for. They have been openly talking about divisive politics and against minorities. People do understand and realise what it stands for. In any case, there is no space being provided in the Valley for any trade union activism."

'Wrong to curb art': Vadra son as his photos on protests removed

photographs, many of them related to the recent protests by students and youth in New Delhi, hours before his exhibition *No Idea Is Final* was due to open at Bikaner House in the Capital.

By evening, barely 35 exhibits remained, and authorities also objected to the blank frames that had replaced the photographs taken down.

"As a citizen and an artist, for me it was my duty to take and display these images," Raihan said. "Any restrictions on art in my opinion are wrong and futile. No matter how many such restrictions are placed, the art itself will find a way to reach the people."

The Indian Express reached out to officials at Bikaner House for comment, but there was no immediate response.

News agency PTI quoted Priyanka Gandhi Vadra calling the move ridiculous and "muzzling" the voice of the youth across the nation. "Today it's him, tomorrow it will be another artist," she said,

The photographs at the centre of the dispute document the last six months of public movements in Delhi, "but through the lens of movement and rhythm," Raihan said.

The 26-year-old artist describes shooting them as a participant as much as an observer. "It was fascinating capturing a gathering from within, and seeing the poetry that large movements bring out," he said.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Raihan said, "The first objection was raised at 6 pm the day before the show and I was told that they would revert. The first written objection was sent to me at 3.30 pm (Wednesday), three hours before the show opened, giving me 30 minutes to remove/replace 74 out of 105 images."

He said the only explanation he received was that "the timing and the context" of the works was inappropriate and overtly political, and that with the whole city fortified, this was not the right time to show such images.

In a statement circulated at the venue, Raihan said his team had replaced the photographs with blank frames. "We were then told that those were also unacceptable and would have to be removed as well," he wrote.

On the venue for his exhibition, he said, "I had shared a layout with them on the 15th of October, which they today said to me was not legible/readable." He had already removed photographs containing political slogans, since the venue has a policy against "political content".

"At no point did they say that each artwork would be under review. Nor did they ask me to furnish all images beforehand," he said. His statement from the preview of the show stated that the proposal was approved on June 30, 2025 and "stated clearly that the exhibit would feature images depicting themes of choice, control and unity".

The photographs that were being asked to be taken down also included the ones with the national flag. "I was shocked to see that they also wanted me to remove images of the Indian flag," Raihan said. "I objected and told them that I myself would not remove any of these. As soon as I was off premises, they removed the image themselves."

Raihan, who also founded the Usual Suspects gallery and the You Cannot Miss This art collective, said, "I find their decision and frankly their policy itself strange. All art, in my opinion, is political."

He said the episode has sharpened his view of what public cultural spaces owe. "For me, it has been a surprise to see this unfold. It's my view that public cultural venues have a responsibility not just towards the people that own or run them but also to the public at large. Any venue censoring artworks and content, regardless of whom they offend or disrupt, is wrong."

He describes No Idea Is Final as a work that is a break from his earlier method. "The central theme was to curate an art show of works that speak to me first and then fit into a theme second. It was a step away from how I had done things previously, which was curating a story first and then working the artworks into it," he said. The works span from wildlife, public movements, abstract images.

The remaining works stay open to the public until October 25. "I will soon display the entire collection at another venue," he said on Instagram.

Ensure night-time cleaning, deploy extra staff: CM to MCD before Diwali

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

CHIEF MINISTER Rekha Gupta on Wednesday instructed the Municipal Corporation of Delhi to introduce night-time cleaning in residential colonies and markets, and deploy additional staff to ensure public spaces remain clean ahead of Diwali and other festivals.

Chairing a high-level meeting on Wednesday, Gupta asked departments concerned and agencies to immediately remove garbage dumps and streamline waste collection. The meeting was attended by Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood, Mayor Parvesh Wahi, Chief Secretary Rajiv Verma, Municipal Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar and senior officials.

Gupta also directed the Mayor and Municipal Commissioner to immediately deploy additional staff in areas where manpower was inadequate to carry out cleaning operations.

COMMUTE TO AIRPORT AFFECTED

Traffic hit in South Delhi as key flyover closes temporarily

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 21

COMMUTERS TRAVELLING between Indira Gandhi International Airport and South Delhi are set to face a harrowing time till Sunday as the Old Rao Tula Ram (RTR) flyover carriageway towards Vasant Vihar has been temporarily closed after cracks were detected at two locations, officials said on Wednesday.

With the closure of the arterial stretch, traffic snarls were also witnessed on Wednesday and motorists were diverted onto the adjoining service road. The flyover serves as a key link for motorists travelling from the airport towards Vasant Vihar and other parts of South Delhi.

It is also an important route for commuters coming from Gurugram and heading towards South Delhi, with many continuing their journey onwards towards Noida and other nearby cities in the National Capital Region (NCR).

After the cracks were noticed by traffic personnel, a senior Delhi Traffic Police officer said, the matter was immediately reported to the Public Works Department (PWD) for necessary repairs.

The carriageway was closed as a precautionary measure to prevent any accident or injury to commuters, the officer added.

PWD officials, in coordination with the Delhi Traffic Police, are carrying out repair work simultaneously at both affected locations to restore the flyover for safe movement of traffic at the earliest.

The repair work is expected to be completed by October 26. Following a safety clearance, the flyover will be subsequently opened, according to officials.

Until then, commuters have been advised to use alternative routes, plan their journeys in advance and expect additional travel time.

They have also been asked to follow the instructions of traffic personnel deployed in the area.

For traffic-related assistance, commuters can contact the Delhi Traffic Police helpline at 1095, said officers.

The traffic police has updated Google Maps to reflect the diversion via the service road and marked the flyover as closed.

Old RTR flyover closed till Oct 25

Roads likely to be affected: Nelson Mandela Marg, Africa Avenue, key stretches near Dhaula Kuan and Ring Road



Road repair underway on the Old RTR flyover on Wednesday. ANI

EXPRESS special

'Capping not the solution': Experts weigh in on proposed e-rickshaw policy

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 21

DELHI HAS proposed capping the number of e-rickshaws on its roads to 2.5 lakh, from an estimated 4.5 lakh to 5 lakh. But experts and e-rickshaw associations said this alone may not ease traffic congestion or road encroachment and could leave drivers without a livelihood.

Rolling out a new regulatory framework aimed at improving road safety, curbing congestion and regulating the growing fleet, the government has proposed making a digital E-Rickshaw Compliance Certificate (ECC) mandatory for all vehicles. It has invited suggestions from the public for 30 days before formally launching the scheme.

E-rickshaw associations have planned to meet the government and request changes to the policy to ensure that drivers who lose their jobs are provided with alternative employment opportunities.

Uneven distribution

E-rickshaws are concentrated on some roads, while other areas with high demand have limited availability, according to unions and EV experts.

Capping the number of e-rickshaws would be a setback for poor and unemployed people who have taken up driving as a means of livelihood, said EV expert Dinesh Goyal.

"An e-rickshaw, which is already categorised as a special-category vehicle, costs around Rs 1.5 lakh. After the cap is imposed, those looking to earn a living through driving with a relatively small investment may have to opt for auto-rickshaws or other commercial vehicles, which are much more expensive," he said.

He added that if the government wants to tackle traffic congestion and road encroachment, it can regulate e-rickshaws through proper management and ensure their balanced deployment on roads.

Goyal also pointed out that there is no cap on other vehicles: "Is there any cap on private and commercial vehicles, whose numbers are also increasing every day? Do they not contribute to traffic congestion?"

Concerns flagged

Anuj Sharma, E-rickshaw Vehicles Federation Chairman and former chairman of the e-rickshaw committee at the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), said the government should have made arrangements for those who could lose their livelihoods before deciding to cap the number of e-rickshaws, given that the existing fleet is over double the proposed limit of 2.5 lakh.

"Has the government made any arrangements for those who will become unemployed? The policy should be implemented only after consultation with stakeholders, rather than being framed solely by officials sitting in the Transport Department," Sharma said.

"We will meet the government to put forward this request...," Sharma said, adding the government could make changes to better manage the deployment of these last-mile vehicles.

He claimed that capping the number of e-rickshaws could also create opportunities for corruption.

"The certificate may be issued to those who would pay or have nexus in the department. In this case, who will ensure who gets the certificate or licence? An open policy is always corruption free," Sharma said.

Sanjay Bathla, chairman of the Electric Vehicle Association and a member of the Transport Operators and Labour Welfare Association, said e-rickshaws should be brought under a permit system administered by the Transport Department, like other commercial vehicles.

"Issuing an ECC will not, by itself, ensure proper regulation. Under which rule or law can the Traffic Police impound these vehicles if they do not come under the permit system?" Bathla asked.

"For effective regulation, the government needs to ensure that e-rickshaws operate on roads and in lanes according to demand," he added.

Bathla also said the proposed policy does not clarify whether subsidies for e-rickshaw buyers would continue.

What the proposed policy says

90-DAY COMPLIANCE WINDOW: Existing Delhi-registered e-rickshaws will have 90 days from the date of notification to obtain an ECC. The certificate will be valid for two years unless suspended or cancelled earlier.



ACTION AGAINST UNREGISTERED VEHICLES: E-rickshaws operating without registration after the notification may be impounded and crushed or auctioned in accordance with prescribed guidelines.

OWNERSHIP LIMITS: Owners will be allowed to own a maximum of five e-rickshaws, while entities will be permitted to own up to 100.

DRIVER REQUIREMENTS: Drivers must hold a valid e-rickshaw driving licence and a Public Service Vehicle (PSV) badge.

'Chats don't show consent': Professor denied pre-arrest bail in rape case

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, October 21

A DELHI court has denied anticipatory bail to a former Delhi University professor accused of raping a former student and threatening to circulate her objectionable videos.

"WhatsApp chats between the accused and the victim do not merely show a past consensual relationship... (it) also discloses creation of objectionable recording, threat and continued pressure on the victim," Additional Sessions Judge (ASJ) Gomati Manocha said in her order dated October 12 while denying the professor anticipatory bail.

"The accused, being the prosecutrix's teacher, is a material circumstance and cannot be ignored," Additional Sessions Judge Manocha said.

She added that if bail is granted, "there is a substantial risk of influencing or threatening the victim, risk of tampering with electronic evidence and possibility of repetition of threats or coercive contact".

"The chat messages cannot be assessed selectively. They are messages vide which the accused has also threatened to circulate objectionable video. They corroborate the victim's allegation of coercion and intimidation and continuing control of the accused upon the victim," ASJ Manocha said in her order.

"This also shows the real possibility of the witness tampering and also explains why the victim may have continued contact with the accused,"

The court also directed that the investigation be assigned to a senior police officer to ensure a fair probe in the case.

The complainant had alleged that the professor invited her to his flat in July 2023 and covertly recorded objectionable videos of her and then used them to compel her to meet him again.

She alleged that in November 2023, the professor engaged in non-consensual sexual relations with her, recorded objectionable videos, and threatened to make them public if she disclosed the matter or refused his demands.

The FIR in this case was lodged on August 18, 2026. In her allegations, the complainant also said that the professor continued to sexually exploit her across various locations between December 2024 and May 2026 under repeated threats of releasing the alleged videos.

The professor was booked under sections of punishment for rape, sexual intercourse by employing deceitful means such as a false promise of marriage, voyeurism and criminal intimidation of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

According to the police, the professor used to allegedly send the former student personal messages often during late-night hours.

He also allegedly used to send her objectionable photographs and videos and also asked her to visit his residence on the pretext of discussing her studies and future.

Amid outrage over 'racist' video, Tripura CM seeks police action

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

AMID OUTRAGE over a purported video showing a content creator allegedly hurling racist remarks at a young man from Tripura, Chief Minister Manik Saha has asked the state's police chief to coordinate with Delhi Police, his office said on Wednesday.

In a post on X, the Tripura CMO said, "CM Manik Saha has directed DGP Tripura to coordinate with Delhi Police over derogatory remarks made by a content creator against a young man from the state. Law will take its course of action."

The purported clip allegedly shows Amir Shokeen, a content creator with about 142,000,000 followers on Instagram, asking the youth's name and then faking an attempt to pronounce. "Are you China's President?" he asks.

He then goes on to comment on the youth's looks and calls him "Michael Jackson".

In response to the outpouring of anger over the comments, the content creator then posted an apology on his Instagram account, and said that the clip was scripted. "I swear... I don't know where Tripuram is... It was a clip made for the sake of fun. The people from the area think I have hurt their sentiments. It was a scripted video. We know that young man... He works at a friend's cafe. I am sorry if I have hurt anyone," he can be heard saying in the clip posted in the early hours of Wednesday.



Content creator Amir Shokeen
INSTAGRAM/AMIRSHOKEEN

However, social media users continued to criticise Shokeen.

Meanwhile, a complaint has also been filed at the New Capital Complex Police Station by Tipra Motha Party's arm, the Youth Tipra Federation's president Suraj Debbarma, on Wednesday, alleging that the Delhi-based content creator was involved in racial harassment, cyberbullying, and made hate speech and defamatory remarks targeting Tripura's indigenous people. TMP is a key ally of the BJP-led coalition government in Tripura.

Govt sanctions Rs 25 cr to tackle waterlogging on 2 major stretches

New Delhi: To address persistent waterlogging on Mandi Road and Bandh Road in Chhatarpur, the Delhi government has sanctioned Rs 25.6 crore to set up a drainage network and two pump houses. The move comes as a relief to Sultanpur, Gadaipur and Jaunapur residents who had to navigate flooding during monsoon for several years.

The project includes the construction of precast drains along both sides of Mandi Road and one side of Bandh Road, along with two pump houses to ensure quicker removal of stormwater, officials said. Under the plan, 710 metres of precast drain will be constructed on each side of Mandi Road. Bandh Road will have a 1,920-metre precast drain along one side. ENS

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to all the registered apartment owners of Amore (2B Parcel) Wave City Center, to participate in the "General Body Meeting" to be held on 21.11.2026 at Wave City Center, Plot No. CC 01, Sector-32, Noida – 201 301 U.P.
The "General Body Meeting" shall be conducted for the formation of Apartment Owners Association of Amore (Parcel 2B) and Registration of the same. Your presence will be highly solicited.

WAVE MEGACITY CENTRE PVT. LTD.
Plot no. CC 01, Sector 32, Noida -201301
email id: possession@wavecitycenter.in
call: 96674 53849

EXPRESS Careers

Shri Shivaji Maratha Society's
425, Shukrawar Peth, Pune - 411002
Phone: 24473946 | Email: shrishivajimarathasociety@rediffmail.com

APPOINTMENT

SHRI SHIVAJI MARATHA SOCIETY'S LAW COLLEGE, PUNE-2
Email: ssmslawpune@yahoo.com | Web.: ssmslawpune.com | Contact: 020-24431144
Applications are invited for the following post

Sr.No.	Post	No.of Posts	Category
1.	Principal	One	Open to All

Qualification / Experience are per Govt. of Maharashtra, UGC, BCI & Savitribai Phule Pune University pune.

Shri Shivaji Maratha Society's Institute of Management & Research
Aranyeshwar, Parvati, Pune-09
Tel-020-24222612| E-Mail ID:imrpune@rediffmail.com | Website: www.ssmsimr.edu.in

Sr.No.	Post	No.of Posts	Category
1.	Director	One	Open to All

Eligibility, Qualification & Experience are required as per UGC, AICTE & Savitribai Phule Pune University & DTE. Govt. of Maharashtra.

SHRI SHIVAJI MARATHA SOCIETY'S COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE
Aranyeshwar, Parvati, Pune-09
ssmscoa@gmail.com | www.ssmscoa.org | Tel: 020-24222771

Sr.No.	Post	No.of Posts	Category
1.	Principal	One	Open to All

Qualification, Experience, Conditions shall be as per the norms of Council of Architecture, New Delhi, DTE Govt. of Maharashtra Savitribai Phule university, Pune.

All Above Application along with attested copies of certificates must reach to the Hon. Secretary, Shri Shivaji Maratha Society, 425 Shukrawar Peth. Pune - 411002, within 30 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.

Shri Janardan G. Thorat,
Hon. Secretary, SSMS

IN THE SUPREME COURT OF INDIA
CIVIL APPELLATE JURISDICTION
CIVIL APPEAL No(s) 9952-9953 OF 2026

RELIGARE ENTERPRISES LIMITED .....Petitioner(s)/Appellant(s)
VERSUS
CHANDRA SHEKHAR JHA AUTHORISED OFFICER AND OTHERS
.....Respondent(s)

To,
1 RHC FINANCE PVT. LTD, THROUGH ITS AUTHORISED REPRESENTATIVE G-16, MARINA ARCADE, CONNAUGHT CIRCUS, NEW DELHI AND 110001, DISTRICT-NEW DELHI, DELHI, PID: 275734/2026 FOR R[2] IN C.A. NO. 9952/2026 C.A. NO. 9952- 9953/2026 (SEC XVII-B)
2 LIGARE AVIATION LIMITED, (FORMERLY KNOWN AS RELIGARE AVIATION LTD.) HAVING ITS REGISTERED OFFICE AT GROUND FLOOR, PRIUS PLATINUM D3, DISTRICT CENTRE, SAKET, NEW DELHI & NDASH; 110017 THROUGH ITS AUTHORISED REPRESENTATIVE, PID: 275735/2026 FOR R[3](ACTUALLY IN THE POSITION OF CIVIL APPEAL IS R-4) IN TC.A. NO. 9952/2026, C.A. NO. 9953/2026 C.A. NO. 9952-9953/2026 (SEC XVII-B)

WHEREAS the CIVIL APPEAL with application for **EX-PARTE STAY** above mentioned (copy enclosed) filed in the Registry by **Ms. SANYA SUD,** Advocate on behalf of the Appellant above named was listed for hearing before this Court on **18th August, 2026,** when the Court was pleased to pass the following order:-

"1. Issue notice, returnable on 10-09-2026 for final disposal. 2. Mr. Kunal Chatterji, the learned Advocate-on-Record, who is on Reason: caveat, accepts and waives formal notice for and on behalf of Respondent No.3 Daiichi Sankyo Company Limited in Civil Appeal No.9953/2026. 3. Let notice be issued to other Respondents. 4. Dasti service, in addition, is permitted."

WHEREAS the CIVIL APPEAL with application for **SUBSTITUTED SERVICE, EX-PARTE STAY** above mentioned (copy enclosed) filed in the Registry by Ms. SANYA SUD-3634, Advocate on behalf of the Appellant above named was listed for hearing before this Court on **08th October, 2026** along with the connected matters, when the Court was pleased to pass the following order:

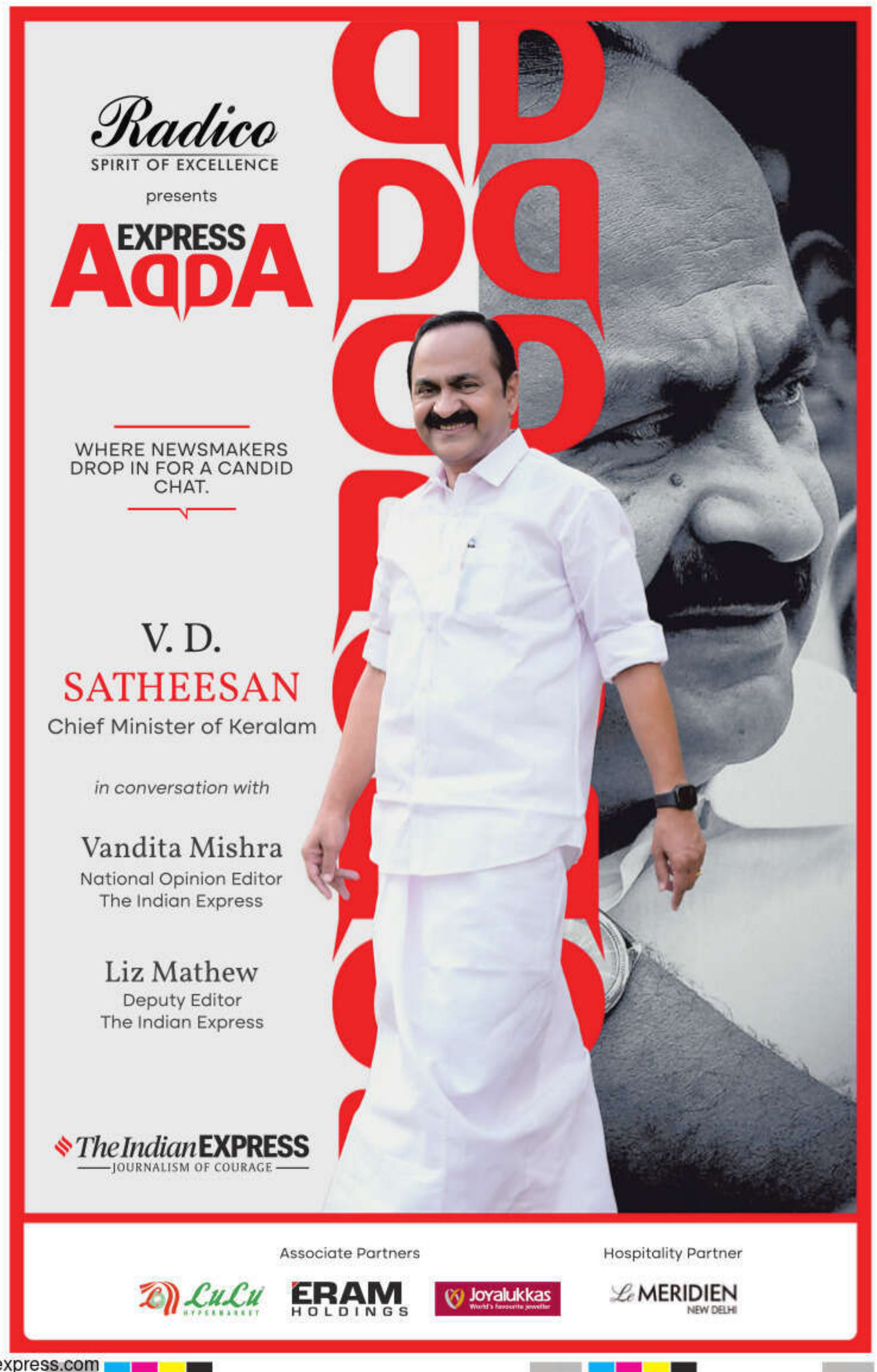
"1. We have one interlocutory application, i.e., I.A. No.311468 of 2026 preferred by the appellant, praying for the following reliefs:- "(a) Grant leave to the Appellant to serve Respondent Nos. 2 (RHC Finance Private Limited) and 4 (Ligare Aviation Limited), by way of substituted service through publication of notice (in the form prescribed or as directed by this Hon'ble Court) in Dainik Bhaskar and Indian Express; (b) Pass such other and further order(s) as this Hon'ble Court may deem fit and proper in the facts and circumstances of the case." 2. Having heard Dr. Abhishek Manu Singhvi assisted by Mr. Abhimanyu Bhandari, the learned senior counsel appearing for the appellant, the relief as prayed for in terms of 'Prayer (a)' is granted. 3. I.A. No.311468/2026 stands disposed of accordingly. 4. We also take notice of the fact that the respondent no. 3 has filed its counter affidavit, to which the appellant wants to file rejoinder affidavit. Let the rejoinder affidavit be filed within a period of two weeks from today. 5. List on 18.11.2026."

NOW, THEREFORE, TAKE NOTICE that the above applications above-mentioned will be posted for hearing before this Court on **18th November, 2026** at 10.30 O'Clock in the forenoon or so soon thereafter as may be convenient to the Court when you may appear before this Court either in person or through an Advocate-on-record of this Court duly appointed by you and show cause to the Court as to why the appeal may not be granted.

You may file your affidavit in opposition to the petition as provided under Rule 14(1) of Order XXI, SCR 2013 (as amended) within 30 days from the date of publication of notice or not later than 2 weeks before the date appointed for hearing, whichever be earlier, but shall do so only by setting out the grounds in opposition to the questions of law or grounds set out in the matter and may produce such pleadings and documents filed before the Court against whose order the appeal is filed and shall also set out the grounds for not granting interim order.

TAKE FURTHER NOTICE that if you fail to enter appearance as aforesaid, no further notice shall be given to you even after the grant of Civil appeal for hearing of the resultant appeal and the matter above-mentioned shall be disposed of in your absence.

Sd/-
Dated: 10th October, 2026 **ASSISTANT REGISTRAR**



STAGE 1 OF THE GRADED RESPONSE ACTION PLAN ENFORCED BY WATCHDOG

Capital sees worst air quality in 100 days

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, October 21

WITH DELHI'S air quality deteriorating to the 'poor' category on Wednesday, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) invoked Stage I of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) across the National Capital Region with immediate effect, directing agencies to intensify pollution-control measures.

The city's Air Quality Index (AQI), which stood at 179 in the 'moderate' category on October 20, deteriorated to 244 on Wednesday — entering the 'poor' category. In neighbouring Gurugram and Noida too, air quality was also in 'poor' category, with respective AQI of 220 and 281.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) and the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM) have forecast that the AQI is likely to remain in the 'poor' category over the coming days, the CAQM said in its order.

The GRAP Sub-Committee reviewed the air quality , along with the weather and air quality forecasts, before deciding to invoke Stage I across the entire NCR, the order said.

Under the revised GRAP schedule issued on September 29, Stage I applies when Delhi's AQI is between 201 and 300.

Schools and offices will continue to function normally under these curbs.

Stage II kicks in for 'very poor' air quality (301-400), Stage III for 'severe' air quality (401-450) and Stage IV for 'severe+' air quality (above 450).

Here are the measures taken:

- **Construction curbs**: Projects with plot sizes of 500 sqm or more that are not registered on the relevant state or Delhi government web portal, or do not meet prescribed requirements for remote monitoring of dust-mitigation measures, not permitted to operate.
- **Ban on the use of coal and wood in eateries**: Ban on coal and firewood as fuels in tandoors at hotels, restaurants and open eateries.
- **Ban on open waste burning**: Authorities must strictly enforce prohibition on open burning of biomass and municipal solid waste.
- **Waste dumping prohibited:** Illegal dumping of waste on open land is prohibited. Municipal bodies, pollution-control boards and district administrations must ensure regular lifting of municipal solid waste, construction and demolition waste, industrial waste and hazardous waste from designated dumpsites and industrial areas.
- **Curbs against polluting vehicles:** Enforcement of existing court orders on restrictions on overage diesel and petrol vehicles. Transport departments and traffic police must strictly enforce pollution-under-control (PUC) norms and take action against visibly polluting vehicles, including impounding them or imposing the maximum applicable penalty.
- **Vehicle diversions**: Inter-city and interstate buses entering Delhi from cities and towns in Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and other specified adjoining states are restricted to electric, CNG or BS-VI diesel vehicles, subject to the coverage specified in the GRAP schedule. Authorities have been directed to enforce diversion of non-destined truck traffic away from Delhi through the Eastern and Western Peripheral Expressways.

Dust control measures

- Authorities have directed intensifying dust suppression measures during road construction, widening, repair and maintenance work. These include the use of anti-smog guns and water sprinkling systems.
- Directions have been issued to carry out periodic mechanised sweeping and water sprinkling on roads.

Meanwhile, police in Delhi and other NCR towns have been directed to synchronise traffic signals and deploy adequate personnel at identified congested corridors, intersections and other traffic bottlenecks to ensure smoother movement. Additional public transport services through CNG and electric buses, Metro and the Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS). Transport authorities have been directed to augment fleets and increase service frequency. Differential fares to encourage travel during off-peak hours are also included in the measures.



Delhi woke up to a hazy morning on Wednesday with AQI shooting up to 244 in the poor category. TASHI TOBGYAL

Why Delhi air quality deteriorates in October

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, October 21

DUSSEHRA CELEBRATIONS triggered a spike in Delhi's air pollution, pushing the city's AQI (air quality index) to 244 on Wednesday. This is the highest in 100 days since July 13, when the AQI stood at 246.

Dussehra emissions, post-monsoon weather transition, pollution from vehicular emissions and rising farm fires have added to the Capital's pollution burden, official data and experts suggest.

Worrying surge in PM levels

Wednesday's rise coincided with high particulate matter (PM) levels overnight, with PM10 levels peaking in several areas — the level stood at 488 micrograms per cubic metre in Anand Vihar. On the other hand, PM2.5 level reached 305 micrograms per cubic metre in Punjabi Bagh of West Delhi.

Several monitoring stations recorded high particulate matter — solid and liquid particles suspended in air, which can be inhaled and cause serious health problems — concentrations during the intervening night of October 20 and 21, and Wednesday morning. At Okhla Phase 2, PM10 peaked at 469 micrograms per cubic metre at 10 pm on Tuesday.

Anand Vihar recorded 488 micrograms per cubic metre at 8 pm, with levels remaining above 450 micrograms per cubic metre through Tuesday night. At Mandir Marg, PM10 reached 410 micrograms per cubic metre at 2 am on Wednesday.

PM2.5 levels also rose sharply. Punjabi Bagh recorded a peak of 305 micrograms per cubic metre at 11 pm on Tuesday, while Okhla Phase 2 recorded 269 micrograms per cubic metre at 10 pm.

The permissible standards of PM2.5 is 60 micrograms per cubic metre and PM10 is 100 micrograms per cubic metre. Overall, Delhi's AQI rose from 179 on Tuesday to 244 on Wednesday, while Noida recorded an AQI of 281 and Gurugram 220.

There are a combination of factors on the rise of pollution during this time of the year.

Studies on fireworks

Studies conducted in Delhi have documented sharp increases in particulate matter following the use of fireworks during festive season.

A 2024 study by IIT Delhi researchers found that during Diwali celebrations, between 2019 and 2021, fireworks accounted for more than 85% of the measured elemental mass in PM2.5 during the festival, after accounting for differences in atmospheric dispersion.

As winter approaches, Delhi's air quality becomes increasingly vulnerable to meteorological conditions that restrict the dispersion of pollutants.

Studies have found that the atmospheric boundary layer, the lowest part of the atmosphere through which pollutants mix, becomes shallower during winter, while night-time temperature inversions can prevent polluted air from rising and dispersing.

As per the India Meteorological Department's (IMD) bulletin "an average wind speed of less than 10 kmph is unfavorable for the dispersion of pollutants.

A 2026 study published in Atmospheric Environment journal, researchers affiliated with Physical Research Laboratory (PRL, the Space Applications Centre and the National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting, among others, found that in Delhi between October 2023 and February 2024, the boundary layer remained below 1 km from November to January. Higher PM2.5 concentrations were associated with lower boundary-layer heights.

Stubble burning

Farm fires in neighbouring states during the paddy harvesting season can add to Delhi's air pollution, depending on the number and location of fires and whether winds carry the smoke towards the city. According to the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology's (IITM) Decision Support System, used for data analysis, stubble burning contributed around four% to Delhi's PM2.5 pollution on Wednesday.

Transport emissions accounted for an estimated 21% of PM2.5 pollution and remained the highest pollution source.

Farm fires contribution is forecast to rise to 15% by Friday.

The Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI), which monitors agricultural residue burning using satellite remote sensing, reported 85 detected fire events across seven states and regions on October 21.

Between September 15 and October 21, satellites detected 1,350 events across the Northern belt with Punjab totalling to 454, Madhya Pradesh 393, Rajasthan 229, Uttar Pradesh 190, Uttarakhand 72, Haryana 11 and Delhi one.

Sunil Dahiya, lead pollution analyst at think-tank Envirocatalysts said, "The winds are coming from the northwest at low speeds of less than 4-5 kmph, which means smoke from the farm fires could be reaching Delhi. From last night, there is clear evidence of a rise in smoke coinciding with the hours of fireworks. Together, these factors have contributed to the increase in air pollution in Delhi."

He added, "This is just the start of the visible pollution in Delhi NCR. The emission loads from fireworks and other regional sources as well as emissions from within Delhi coming from transport, power, industries and other perennial sectors together contribute to this bad air quality season."

Delhi Metro's solution on pollution: More weekday trips

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

DELHI METRO will run 20 additional train trips on weekdays from Thursday to encourage the use of public transport amid implementation of Stage I of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) in the Capital on Wednesday to tackle pollution. The additional train services will operate Monday to Friday, officials said.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) announced on Wednesday that the additional trips would operate from Thursday, alongside intensified anti-pollution measures at its construction sites and surrounding areas, an official said.

As part of the drive, DMRC will undertake measures to reduce dust at construction sites, clear road dust from surrounding roads and remove garbage from footpaths and road medians. Engineers will also inspect construction sites and adjoining roads to ensure construction materials are properly covered and wheel-wash facilities for outgoing vehicles are functional.

• Skywatch

Forecast: October 22, 2026
Mainly clear sky, no rain
MAX: 31-33
0.4°C below normal
MIN: 17-19
0.6°C below normal

• AQI Tracker

Mundka	Burari
Poor	Poor
AQI:250	AQI: 261
Anand Vihar	**Shadipur**
Poor	Poor
AQI: 218	AQI: 264

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

EXPRESS special

'We are middle class, can't walk away': Gurgaon Greens buyers paid EMIs, spent lakhs on legal battles

HC recently upheld their right to claim interest after taking possession

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, October 21

EARLIER THIS month, the Punjab and Haryana High Court upheld their right to claim interest after taking possession, but buyers must prove they filed their complaints within the prescribed time limit.

For Jyotsna Kumar, the dream of owning a home has turned into a 14-year ordeal.

A lecturer who has taught at various colleges in the NCR, she booked a flat in Emaar's Gurgaon Greens project in Sector 102 in 2012, with possession promised by 2016. She received the keys only in December 2018. Now, she is still waiting for compensation for the delay, with the matter caught in another round of legal proceedings.

"Every hearing and delay takes its toll," Jyotsna said. "We are middle-class people, not ultra-privileged that we can let a delayed home just slide and move on. It became tough to carry on with daily life amid the tiring legal proceedings."

The experience, she added, has tested her faith in the system, though she remains hopeful.

Jyotsna is among nearly 50 homebuyers in the project who are yet to receive the interest they are seeking for delayed possession. They have each spent more than 20% of their claim amounts — ranging from Rs 20 lakh to Rs 40 lakh — on litigation. This is over and above the loans they took and the EMIs they paid for homes they had expected to receive on time.

On October 5, the Punjab and Haryana High Court upheld their right to seek compensation even after taking possession. However, the buyers must return to the real estate regulator and establish that their claims were filed within the legally permissible period.



Emaar's Gurgaon Greens project in Sector 102.

What the court said

In his judgment, Justice Jagmohan Bansal ruled in favour of the buyers on the core issue of their rights, stating: "Handing over possession or execution of conveyance deed does not take away the right of the allottee to file a complaint seeking interest".

However, the court also stipulated a limitation period, noting that a complaint seeking interest "should be filed within a reasonable period of limitation which would depend upon facts and circumstances of each case". It set a standard limitation period of three years from the date of taking possession, excluding the Covid-19 period between March 15, 2020, and February 28, 2022.

Because the High Court was dealing with a large batch of appeals simultaneously, it did not examine the specific dates of possession and complaint filing for each individual case.

Noting that "this factual finding needs to be recorded by the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HRERA)", the High Court partially allowed the appeals "by way of remand to the Authority to ascertain whether complaint was within reasonable period of limitation".

Parties have been directed to appear before HRERA on October 16, with instructions for the cases to be disposed of within four months.

When contacted, Emaar India told The Indian Express: "The order is in our favour. It is a landmark judgment and an achievement for all real estate developers who shall benefit from this order, that explicitly mentions the three-year limitation principle. The company will consider challenging the other grounds in the Supreme Court on the principles of waiver and admission."

Road to court

The High Court order is the latest chapter in a protracted dispute. The case of Poonam Goel, one of the homebuyers, illustrates how it unfolded.

In April 2013, the buyer and Emaar entered into a Buyer's Agreement, with construction commencing in June of that year. However, the promised deadline for handing over the flat expired in November 2016. It was not until May 2019 that Emaar received the occupation certificate and offered possession to the buyer. The completed unit was subsequently handed over in December 2019, and the conveyance deed was executed by February 2020.

In Poonam's case, the total sale consideration of the unit was set at Rs 96.40 lakh. She ultimately paid Rs 98.39 lakh to Emaar. Seeking interest on the delayed possession, Poonam and her husband filed a formal complaint before HRERA in September 2022.

In August 2024, the Authority ruled in favour of the buyer, directing Emaar to pay interest at 11% per annum for every month of delay — from the November 2016 due date until the offer of possession in May 2019.

Emaar challenged this order in July 2026. But the Haryana Real Estate Appellate Tribunal dismissed the appeal, ruling that the execution of a conveyance deed or delivery of possession does not extinguish the allottees' statutory rights.

The builder then approached the High Court.

As per the judgment, Emaar had submitted in court that the homebuyers voluntarily accepted the compensation offered at the time of possession, effectively concluding the contract. It contended that without a prescribed limitation period, allowing complaints at any time would create chaos.

During the hearings, allottees pointed out that in some cases, the statutory interest liability for delayed possession amounted to more than Rs 40 lakh, against which the developer had paid a meagre Rs 5 to Rs 6 lakh.

The HC rejected Emaar's argument that the contract concludes entirely upon possession, observing that unless a homebuyer explicitly gave in writing that they were accepting a smaller amount as a full settlement, the builder cannot escape its statutory liability.

If you're a good politician, you have to be an actor: Tavleen Singh on new book

Veteran journalist's debut work of fiction launched on Wednesday

Aishwarya Khosla
New Delhi, October 21

WHO IS Guruji modelled on? Tavleen Singh, veteran journalist and *The Indian Express* columnist, sidestepped the question through much of the launch of her debut novel, The Actor, at the India International Centre on Wednesday evening.

In the book, Guruji is a ruthless theocrat who rules a near-future India as its four-time Prime Minister.

Singh was in discussion with Najeeb Jung, former Lieutenant Governor of Delhi. Asked if Guruji was modelled on Prime Minister Modi, Singh disagreed. Guruji, she said, was "a kind of warning" of where India ends up "if we continue to have a society that becomes less and less liberal and less and less pluralistic."

She did, however, name other inspirations. Naresh Khanna, the MP who lures a fading Bollywood star into a new secular party, is "very loosely modelled" on Prashant Kishor, founder of Bihar's Jan Suraaj party. "Prashant Kishor is the only politician I have known in my lifetime, and I've covered politics for 50 years, who has actually done the hard work," she said, pointing to his two years travelling through Bihar's villages telling voters to stop voting on caste. "Which is why I support him."



Tavleen Singh and Delhi ex-LG Najeeb Jung at the event. ANIL SHARMA

But Kishor, Jung said, lacked Naresh's "solid principles". He offered former prime minister Rajiv Gandhi or his son Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, as more natural models, which drew Singh's retort that dynastic politics began when former prime minister Indira Gandhi handed her younger son Sanjay "not just the Congress party" but the country. "When politicians bring their children into politics," she said, "what they're doing is starting a business. It's not public service."

The actor of the title is Amit Singh, a superstar on the slide after three flops, whom Naresh recruits as the party's face.

The author said she had Amitabh Bachchan, Vinod Khanna and Rajesh Khanna in mind, all stars turned politicians. While researching the book, she had breakfast with lyricist and screenwriter Javed Akhtar, who told her that a real superstar would never have gone into politics.

The two worlds, she argued, draw the same kind of person. "If you're a good politician, you have to be an actor," she said. Some of the most decent men lost out for want of that gift; former prime minister Manmohan Singh "was a bad speaker".

THE EVENTFUL city

Jung steered the conversation to the treatment of Muslims, describing a "deliberate, conscious effort" over the past 12 years to make them feel like "second-class citizens".

"That's what the book is about," Singh replied. "Once religion becomes part of politics, then you will end up with a Guruji type figure."

She acknowledged the novel asks readers to read between the lines. "It is fiction, but it's fiction about real things," she said, adding that she had tried a more explicit version and "the lawyers stopped it."

The evening ended with Jung pitching a sequel in which the actor comes to power and gives Guruji a tough time. "Oh, that's a good idea," Singh said. "Maybe I will."

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Identity Crisis

A ROUTINE press conference turned into an inadvertent unmasking on Wednesday when organisers of a Kuki-Zo conference at the Constitution Club asked everyone in the hall, including journalists, to introduce themselves. Three police personnel in plain clothes raised their hands and introduced themselves, drawing laughter and murmurs from the gathering. The three, seated among reporters, were the Special Branch officers of Delhi Police. They, apparently, had been sent to monitor and cover the event.

Call & Probe

AN IPS officer of the AGMUT cadre, already facing a sexual harassment inquiry for allegedly harassing a junior woman constable in Arunachal Pradesh, is now facing another inquiry after a police Inspector made a call to the police control room, alleging that his senior officer misbehaved with him, pushing him into "depression". After senior officers at the Delhi Police headquarters learnt about the matter, a fact-finding inquiry was ordered.

Tusk meets Modi today, Polish defence industry looks at partnering with India

Would love to see more investments from India, says FM Domanski

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 21

AS POLAND'S Prime Minister Donald Tusk arrived in New Delhi for a meeting Thursday with Prime Minister Narendra Modi — the first visit to India in 16 years by a Polish Prime Minister — the country's Finance Minister Andrzej Domanski said Wednesday that the Polish defence industry is looking for partners and can supply "really great, and good value equipment" to India.

In an interview to *The Indian Express*, Domanski, who is accompanying Tusk, pitched Poland as an economic growth centre, a gateway for Indian business to access the European market.

"The Polish economy is doing pretty well so far. We are the fastest growing large European economy with GDP growth expected 3.6 per cent this year. Actually, the little known fact is that this year we are going to contribute more to the European Union to overall GDP than Germany or France, which are much bigger economies... So we do hope that we will maintain the pace of growth or similar above 3% in the following quarters and, hopefully, years," he said.





Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk arrives in New Delhi on Wednesday. x (Left) Poland Finance Minister Andrzej Domanski

"That being said, my job is always to worry, worry about the future, and think about threats and also about new engines of GDP growth. Poland is, I dare to say, the largest, the biggest field of clean energy transition in Europe. We will develop both large scale nuclear power plants as well as SMRs (small modular reactors), and of course all of this needs funding. So we are open also for equity investments in our economy, we are looking for foreign partners, and we would love to see more investments from the Indian economy as well. And I believe this is going to be one of the topics of discussion during the Prime Minister's visit," he said. A large business delegation is accompanying the Prime Minister on the trip to India.

Poland has developed a strong defence industry to meet the Russian military threat, as it shares borders with Russia and Ukraine.

"We can cooperate closer and serve our bilateral relations... Poland spends close to 5% of our GDP right now to modernise the Polish defence forces. But at the same time, we are really developing our defence industry, and I do believe that we can provide really great, and good value equipment for India," Domanski said.

"Our companies are willing to cooperate with Indian partners on some R&D development, as I strongly believe that what really serves the best is... close cooperation of defence industries, developing mutual trust on both sides," he said, citing the example of the WB Group, which makes state-of-the-art defence equipment for Poland and Ukraine.

Polish officials said "building trust with India is going to be the biggest task" in the bilateral relations — from the Polish perspective, India was considered close to the Soviet Union and its successor state, Russia. Poland's own historical experience during the Communist rule in the Soviet era created deep distrust towards Russia.

"What we are looking for are also foreign partners. Of course, we are looking for this partnership in many, many dimensions, and we are searching for export markets for our products. But we are also happy to have some technological R&D cooperation, and here I also see room for closer ties with our Indian partners," he said.

"We will, of course, discuss mainly economical issues, cooperation in the defence industry. There is lots of room for cooperation in clean energy transition. I am really encouraged by watching, seeing the progress made by India. At the same time, we are also doing a lot here in Poland to make our energy mix more balanced, and I believe that we can work together in this field as well."

"We have a very strong agriculture industry in Poland, ready to cooperate with Indian partners. Same in mining, also heavy industries... We are willing to cooperate much closer with our Indian partners right now," he said.

"Poland is the fastest growing European economy. Our contribution to European GDP growth actually is higher than that of Germany or France, and of course, it also means that Poland could serve as a great gain for Indian companies that would like to enter European markets. We are working really hard now to lower energy prices in Poland, and the investment process is smoother... I would like to use this opportunity to invite all Indian investors, all Indian companies...," he said.

"We have great companies from many sectors: Defence, dual use, space. We invest a lot in space industry right now, and we have companies like ICEYE that are providing the absolutely best solutions, for example, in satellites, and we are bringing to India more than 80 Polish companies, leaders of business leaders to meet with our Indian partners, both in Delhi and and in Bangalore, so we can strengthen relations... and with partners like India, with global superpower like India, we can together make a very good business," he said.

On Thursday, Prime Ministers Tusk and Modi will review the entire spectrum of bilateral relations, which was elevated to a Strategic Partnership during Modi's visit to Poland in August 2024.

Tusk will also travel to Bengaluru where he will engage with business stakeholders. An India-Poland Business Forum will be held in New Delhi and Bengaluru.

Annamalai on BJP: 12 years in power, yet manufactures enemy to stay relevant

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

FORMER TAMIL Nadu BJP president and ex-IPS officer K Annamalai on Wednesday targeted the Centre for its handling of the Cockroach Janta Party protesters, the de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site, preventive detentions, and the use of pellet guns by the Delhi Police.

In a post on X, Annamalai, who resigned from the primary membership of the party in June, invoked the 2011 crackdown on the anti-corruption campaign in Delhi and wrote that Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who was then the Gujarat Chief Minister, had said that "if his hands were not tied, he would have gone to Delhi and waged war against the central government".

Stating that he may not agree with the tactics of the CJP and may think many of their members are misguided, he said, "But if you ask me whether they have a right to oppose/argue/protest on an issue that they think is important? I would categorically say - YES."

He said he would like people to ask questions even if it makes "some of them uncomfortable". "I have a feeling the central government forgets it's been in power in Delhi for 12 plus years and still manufactures an enemy at all times to keep itself relevant. Sadly, that's a pity," he wrote.

Mann fined Rs 50,000 by Customs at Delhi airport

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, October 21

PUNJAB CHIEF Minister Bhagwant Mann was stopped for three hours at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport on Monday night and fined Rs 50,000 by Customs officials. Mann, returning from Paris on an Air France flight with his wife Dr Gurpreet Kaur opted for the green channel ('Nothing to Declare') despite allegedly carrying items that required clearance through the red channel ('Goods to Declare').

After landing around 11 pm, Mann and his wife waited at the VIP lounge for their luggage. After a two-hour delay, officials informed them that customs had held their baggage. Officials then escorted Mann to the Customs enclosure, where they opened and inspected his luggage in his presence.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that the baggage contained "everyday items", including shoes, belts, clothes, daily-use watches, and jewellery. After spending an hour at the Customs enclosure, CM Mann exited the airport.

Mann travelled to Paris on the intervening night of October 16–17 to promote Punjab's agricultural produce, specifically kidney beans and chickpeas, at an international food festival.

Rubio visits Reliance's Jamnagar refinery, discusses energy and tech opportunities

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, October 21

ACCOMPANIED BY United States Ambassador to India Sergio Gor, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio visited the Reliance refinery in Jamnagar Wednesday afternoon, spending nearly five hours at the complex. Discussions held on the occasion focussed on the "global energy landscape and opportunities for commercial partnerships across conventional and new energy".

A statement from Reliance Industries said Secretary Rubio and Ambassador Gor toured the refinery complex and were given "a first-hand view of its scale, advanced technology and integrated operations".

RIL Chairman and Managing Director Mukesh Ambani and Executive Director Anant Ambani "outlined Reliance's long-term vision for the Jamnagar complex and its development as a centre for deep-tech, innovation and advanced manufacturing. They shared their perspectives on opportunities for collaboration with US companies, drawing on complementary strengths in technology, engineering and advanced manufacturing," the statement said.



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, his wife Jeanette, Ambassador Sergio Gor with RIL Executive Director Anant Ambani and his wife Radhika in Jamnagar, Wednesday. @USAMBINDIA/X

There was also a briefing on Reliance's New Energy giga factories, which are currently undergoing phase-wise commissioning, and under-construction data centres. Reliance is developing a 168 MW data centre in partnership with Meta at Jamnagar. It is scheduled for completion in two years.

"...Discussions also explored the increasing intersection of energy and digital infrastructure, including the role of dependable power in supporting data centres and the expansion of the digital economy," said the statement.

Ambassador Gor posted on X, "Over the past year, India's imports of US LPG have surged from under 10% to 67%, making the United States India's largest LPG supplier. Reliance's planned investment in the first new US oil refinery in 50 years is another major opportunity to expand American energy production and create jobs."

Rubio arrived in Jamnagar a day after calling India a crude-refining "superpower" and urging more processing of Venezuelan crude there.

According to *PTI*, Rubio also visited Reliance's Vantara animal rescue centre. Gor posted a photograph on X in which Rubio and wife Jeanette are seen with Executive Director and Vantara founder Anant Ambani and wife Radhika, along with Hital Meswani, RIL whole-time director and the in-charge of Petroleum Refining and Marketing and Petrochemicals Manufacturing.

In March, President Donald Trump announced a USD 300 billion partnership with Reliance Industries for a major oil refinery in Brownsville, Texas, the country's first in 50 years.

At the Freedom 250 reception held in honour of Secretary Rubio in Mumbai on Tuesday, Gor said the US was "laser-focussed" on driving the bilateral trade target between India and the US to 500 billion USD from the current 240 billion USD "in the next three years".

"The US-India partnership is not just built in Delhi and Washington; it is built in Mumbai, it is built in Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Chennai that make the Indian engine of prosperity," said Ambassador Gor at the Mumbai event. Present at this event were Mahindra and Mahindra Chairperson Anand Mahindra, Tata Trusts chairperson Noel Tata, founder of Biocon Ltd Kiran Mazumdar Shaw and others.

UP CEO orders action as Cong alleges Pilibhit roll irregularities

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 21

HOURS AFTER the Congress alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Uttar Pradesh, claiming that more than 16,000 voter entries had been affected in the Pilibhit Sadar Assembly constituency alone, the state Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) on Wednesday evening ordered legal action against officials and staff responsible for the errors.

After an inquiry found that certain voters' Electors Photo Identity Card (EPIC) numbers displayed the details of other voters online, CEO Navdeep Rinwa ordered a probe by the District Election Officer (DEO), Pilibhit, and directed all DEOs to examine the electoral rolls of the Assembly constituencies in their respective districts and submit reports within two days.

Earlier in the day, the Congress flagged alleged irregularities in the Pilibhit Sadar Assembly voters' list and said it was examining "discrepancies" in other constituencies and would explore legal options.

Addressing the media, AICC general secretary in-charge of UP, Rajendra Pal Gautam, cited Pilibhit Sadar (constituency number 127) as an example of what he alleged were discrepancies between the draft and subsequent electoral rolls.



(From left) UP Congress chief Aradhana Misra with party leaders Rajendra Pal Gautam and Supriya Shrinate in Lucknow. PTI

Gautam alleged that after the draft SIR list was published in April, the names of 13,150 voters were changed between July and September.

"Congress workers checked the entries on the ground and found that the EPIC numbers and serial numbers were the same as those in the draft list, but the actual names had changed," he alleged.

He further claimed that 804 voters listed as missing had been removed from the rolls even though they were still living in the constituency. In addition, around 2,600 names had allegedly been added despite the individuals concerned not living in the area, he claimed.

Congress leader Supriya Shrinate alleged that the scale of the discrepancies was significant given the electoral arithmetic in Pilibhit Sadar. She said the seat was won by BJP minister Sanjay Gangwar by a margin of around 6,930 votes.

"Pilibhit has 3.48 lakh voters. These changes in names were made when Form 6 was not being used, yet 13,150 names were changed despite the EPIC numbers being correct," Shrinate alleged.

The Congress demanded judicial intervention.

• WHILE BJP TRACKS THE MANOEUVRINGS OF TDP CHIEF CHANDRABABU NAIDU, CONGRESS IS KEEPING A WATCH ON YSRCP CHIEF Y S JAGAN MOHAN REDDY

Naidu to Vijay, Jagan to Stalin — key South players hedging bets before 2029

CAPITAL CONTEXT
BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS IN A STATE FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

WHILE THE ruling BJP and the Opposition Congress-led INDIA bloc draw battle lines in the heartland in the run-up to several crucial elections, some leading regional parties in South India seem to be looking to expand their hefts to position themselves for any scenarios centred on the 2029 Lok Sabha polls.

While the BJP closely tracks the manoeuvrings of its key ally, TDP president and Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu — who has always displayed his political astuteness and strategic acumen — the Congress is keeping a watch on YSRCP chief and ex-Andhra CM Y S Jagan Mohan Reddy, who has yet to take a position on the question of realignment.

Jagan's recent statement expressing regret for helping the Narendra Modi-led NDA government pass the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, and calling it a "mistake", has reignited fresh hopes among the INDIA parties. The law provides for selection of the ECs by a three-member panel comprising the Prime Minister, a minister chosen by the PM and the Leader of Opposition, making it a government-dominated exercise.

Some observers see the shift in Jagan's stance on a major issue and Naidu's recent meeting with his Tamil Nadu counterpart, TVK chief C Joseph Vijay, as indications of a possible recalibration in their moves.

Naidu, Vijay bonhomie

Vijay attended Vijayawada Utsav 2.0 — a major cultural event of Andhra Pradesh held to mark Dussehra festivities — where Naidu rolled out a red carpet for him.

Naidu used his meeting with Vijay not just for cultural diplomacy but also for creating optics for his outreach to southern leaders across political spectrum. "Naidu is trying to get political leverage here. His attempts for the so-called southern alliance has sent a message to the BJP leadership — that he has the potential and ability to play from any side and can become a pressure group in his own right in the future," said a senior BJP leader who has worked with the Andhra Pradesh BJP.



Tamil Nadu CM Joseph Vijay with Andhra CM N Chandrababu Naidu during the Vijayawada Utsav 2.0 celebrations last week. PTI

"Naidu has started making these bids at a time when the BJP is facing pressure over multiple issues," the leader said. "The BJP has never underestimated him. Political alliance is a marriage of convenience."

A TDP leader said that Naidu's meeting with Vijay at a time when the youth and students have been venting their angst against the Modi government on the streets has sent out a signal.

"As of today, there is hardly anyone in the NDA camp who can get the pulse of Gen Z. The current political scene and what we are witnessing in the national capital are connected to what happened in Tamil Nadu politics where Gen Z lifted Vijay and TVK to the seat of power. Naidu's meeting with Vijay and its optics gave a message to the youngsters that 'I can understand you'. This will certainly boost his position in NDA," the TDP leader said.

However, Lavu Krishna Devarayalu, TDP parliamentary party leader, insisted that the Naidu-Vijay meeting was meant to push infrastructure and environmental projects. "More than politics, right now Naidu Garu is working on interlinking of rivers, an issue close to his heart. He has been taking it up at every platform whose need has been reinforced by the Super El Nino and its impact on our farming sector. The Chief Ministers of Tamil Nadu and Telangana are on board over the issue of interlinking of the rivers, which would be advantageous for Odisha, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka along with Andhra Pradesh...," he said.

Krishna also said the TDP-led government has been focusing on farmer centric initiatives in Andhra Pradesh.

"Since no irrigation project could take off between 2019 and 2024 due to mismanagement by the then (Jagan-led) government, we have taken up many projects to compensate for them. Mother of all projects is the inter-linking of the rivers and that's the reason Naidu has made those moves," he added.

DMK in a quandary

Reeling from the Congress's move to snap ties with it to join the Vijay-led government following the Tamil Nadu elections in May, the DMK has yet to firm up its roadmap ahead.

While the BJP has made overtures to the Dravidian party to seek its help for pushing a delimitation-linked constitutional amendment Bill to advance reservation for women to 2029 — which was defeated in the Lok Sabha in April — the DMK continues to be in a dilemma about the political ramifications of joining hands with the BJP.

"The DMK has no doubts that it has to oppose the Congress, but aligning with the BJP directly could be problematic. The best option before it is to explore the possibility of a third front (with non-Congress, non-BJP parties). And we are sure the parties in Tamil Nadu which are facing survival threat because of the TVK will join us," said a DMK insider.

DMK sources said the party is "deeply concerned" about the rapid decline in the Election Commission (EC)'s credibility and the BJP's "continued defence" of Gyanesh Kumar.

Provide police protection to YSRCP civic poll candidates: Apex court to Andhra DGP

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, October 21

IN A relief to the YSRCP, the Supreme Court on Monday directed the Andhra Pradesh State Election Commission (SEC) to resolve the party's complaints that its candidates were prevented from filing nomination papers for the upcoming urban local body elections, and directed the DGP to provide protection to those who seek it.

The special bench, comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, directed the SEC to postpone publication of the final list of contesting candidates till October 25.

The SC gave the directions on a petition filed by the YSR Congress Party (YSRCP) on October 19, stating that a large number of its candidates were stopped from filing their nomination papers, allegedly by the ruling Telugu Desam Party (TDP) cadres and supporters.

The top court has asked the SEC to decide by Thursday on extending the deadline in cases where it has received petitions from candidates, stating they were unable to file their nominations. The SEC has been directed to look into all the documentary and electronic evidence, if any, submitted by the candidates while seeking extension of nomination deadline.

The candidates must receive at least 48 hours from the publication of that decision to file nominations, and the election notification shall be amended accordingly, the SC said.

The SC has asked the state DGP to ensure adequate police bandobast, CCTV coverage at nomination centres, and protection for candidates going to file nominations, and submit a compliance report.

The SC has directed the SEC to take all steps to ensure that a fair and free election is held, concerns of all those participating in the electoral process are addressed, and a report is submitted to the top court in this regard. YSRCP leaders welcomed the SC's directions.

"The SC has taken note of our grievances that our candidates were prevented from filing nomination papers. The directions to the SEC and the DGP are very clear. We hope that at least now, they will put their act together and ensure that the process is fair and free, and our candidates are able to file their papers without fear," said former minister Peddireddy Ramachandra Reddy.

Maharashtra poacher killed as aide mistakes his phone flashlight for animal eyes; 2 held

Press Trust of India
Thane, October 21

POLICE ON Wednesday arrested two persons after a 60-year-old man, suspected to be a member of an illegal hunting expedition, died of a gunshot injury within the limits of the Sanjay Gandhi National Park (SGNP) in Maharashtra's Thane district.

Prima facie, the deceased, identified as Vijay Sapte, was struck by gunshot fired by an accomplice who mistook his mobile flashlight for an animal's eyes, according to a release issued by the Mira Bhayandar Vasai Virar Police.

Police said a group of seven individuals had ventured into the Debucha Ghat forest area inside the SGNP near Chenagaon for wild animal poaching on Tuesday. Around 9 pm, accused Mahesh Gaikwad spotted a mobile phone light shining from across the terrain. Mistaking the illumination for glowing eyes of an animal, Gaikwad fired his gun in that direction.

The stray pellets struck Sapte while two others also sustained serious injuries. As the injured victims were being rushed out of the forest for medical assistance, Sapte succumbed to his injuries, according to the release.

"In an attempt to cover up the shooting, the group approached a private practitioner, who allegedly examined the body via a WhatsApp video call and issued a death certificate without proper legal protocols or informing law enforcement. Subsequently, the victim's son and others disposed of the body by hastily cremating it at the Chenagaon cremation ground," police said.

The accused duo is identified as Mahesh Gaikwad (52) and Kathod Bistur Labad (55), out of the seven persons named in the FIR.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work..
Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1	**Name of work with its location :** Reconditioning of cupped AT welded joints using RDSO-approved technology over Delhi Division under DEN/Track/DLI. (NIT-16-26-27-WC)
2	**Approx. cost of work :** (1) Rs. 1,30,86,480.00/-
3	**Earnest money :** (1) Rs. 2,61,700.00/-
4	**Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time :** Starting time for filling e-tender is Date-30.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date-13.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5	**Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded :** Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**

No.: 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-16-26-27/WC Dated:- 21.10.2026 3665/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract (AMC) of Medha make EI for 22 stations of DLI Division for 3 years
App. Cost of the work	₹ 6,16,90,015.8/- **Bid Security** ₹12,33,800.00/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for upload the tender/ closing of tender	Tender uploading 21.10.2026/ closing date & time-12.11.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi- 110055.

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-T-AMC-102 Dated: 21.10.2026
SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 3660/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Neelam Rana W/o Rajesh Rana @ Bunty R/o H.No. 7/16, Tilak Nagar, Delhi and also at A-669, Village Khyala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 74/26 U/s 3 & 4 MCOCA Act at PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Neelam Rana** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neelam Rana** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Neelam Rana of FIR No. 74/26 U/s 3 & 4 MCOCA Act of PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.11.2026.**
By order
Surabhi Sharma Vats
Special Exclusive Court-12 (MCOCA)
Court No.403,
Rouse Avenue Court Complex,
New Delhi
DP/15124/WD/2026

Maharashtra Airport Development Company Ltd.
CIN: U45203MH2002SGC136979
TENDER NOTICE
MADC invites Tender for Appointment of Consultant for Preparation of Detailed Techno-Economic feasibility Study and Bid process management for development of Chhatrapati Sambhaji Raje Greenfield International airport at Purandar, Pune District, Maharashtra.
The detailed tender document can be downloaded from the website **www.mahatenders.gov.in** from **22/10/2026, 01:00 PM.**
Sd/-
Vice Chairman and Managing Director

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)
TNPDCL /SHORT/ PP-48/2026-2027
TNPDCL invites E-Tender for procurement of RTC (00 to 24 hrs), peak hour Power (00 to 06.00 hrs), and (18:00 to 24:00 hrs) from 01-11-2026 to 31-01-2027 from both Interstate and Intrastate generators on firm basis from CERC / TNERC approved Traders / Generators. Bidding will be done as per the revised guidelines for short term procurement of power notified by the Ministry of Power vide resolution dated 30.03.2016 and as per amendments dated: 21.02.2022 through e-Bidding portal (DEEP) only and subsequent amendments thereof are applicable to this tender specification. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power **(www.powermin.nic.in)** and PFC Consulting Ltd **(www.pfcclindia.com).** Specification is available in TNPDCL website and MSTC DEEP E-Bidding portal.
Sd/...21.10.26
DIPR/3183/Tender/2026 Chief Engineer / PPP, TNPDCL

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, **India CIN:** U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Service of condenser tube cleaning (HP Jetting & bullet shooting) in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1	**Tender Enquiry No. 196/GATP/MMD/TG/50007816** **"Service of condenser tube cleaning (HP Jetting & bullet shooting) in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 21/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
No. 16375/PB GATP-90/26

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai
e-mail : maha.mmgpa2023@gmail.com
MMGPA, 1st Floor, Arogya Bhavan, St. Georges Hospital Compound, MUMBAI-400 001.
TENDER NOTICE
Date : 19.10.2026
CHIEF Executive Officer, Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai invites tender in Two Envelope system from the eligible bidders for the following items for purchase of equipments.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Name of Item(s)	Period of sale, download & submission of bid	Bid Opening
1	RT-308	BPHU Equipments	Dt. 16.10.2026 at 06.55 PM. to Dt. 27.10.2026 up to 02.00 PM.	Dt. 28.10.2026 at 02.00 PM.

1. For detailed information, the interested bidders may visit the **web site https://mahatenders.gov.in.**
2. The Chief Executive Officer reserves the right to increase or decrease the quantity to be purchased and also reserves the right to cancel all the tenders without giving any reason to.
3. This advertisement should be published in 3"x3" size in newspaper.

For e-tendering help/information, please contact.
Web site : https://mahatenders.gov.in
E-mail : maha.mmgpa2023@gmail.com
Sd/-
Technical Officer,
Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai
DGIPR/2026-2027/3323

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506
Notice Inviting Bids for Procurement of Power on Short Term basis
Bids are invited by "Noida Power Company Limited having its registered office at Electric Sub-station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida – 201310 (U.P.)" for procurement of up to 200 MW during 01.04.2027 to 31.03.2028 as per the Guidelines of Ministry of Power, GoI dated 30.03.2016. Bid Document is available on www.mstcecommerce.com.
The Company reserves the right to reject all or any of the Bids or cancel the bidding process at any stage without assigning any reasons whatsoever and without any liability.
For any clarification, contact at e-mail id powertradingnpcl@rpsg.in or mobile no. 9718804966.
Head (Power Management Services)

कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम जबलपुर म.प्र.
निविदा सूचना क्र./उ.नि./2026-27/PRO-689 // प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना // दिनांक :-21/10/2026
निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्रीयकृत प्रणाली में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से ऑनलाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट https://mptenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

क्र.	टेण्डर क्रमांक जारी दिनांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की समयावधि एवं लागत (लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य एवं EMD	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	2026_UAD_544371_	उद्यानिकी कार्य के लिए कुशल एवं अकुशल श्रमिकों की आपूर्ति।	12 Month 5,60,25,216-00	20,000=00 2,80,130-00	25/11/2026

नोट :- निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन ऑनलाईन https://mptenders.gov.in की वेबसाइट पर ही किया जावेगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशन नहीं किया जावेगा।
उद्यान अधिकारी
नगर पालिक निगम, जबलपुर।

NORTHERN RAILWAY
No. :7PUB/e-Auction/NIT-2026 **E-AUCTION NOTICE** Dated : 21.10.2026
The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/ G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (**https://ireps.gov.in**) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt-Nov-2026-1	Procurement and Supply of Linen Bag	Reserved Coaches of Mail/Express Trains of Delhi Division.	Start: 04.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs.
Advt-Nov-2026-1	Luggage Trolley	Delhi Cantt. Railway Station.	Start: 04.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can bee seen https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/ G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi
3667/26 SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Govt. of Bihar
Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation
(A Government of Bihar undertaking)
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER
For
NIT. No:-366/26/TT/3447/26
Request for Proposal (RFP) for
Selection of Agencies for Operation and Maintenance of Water Sports Activities in Bihar
(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation Limited Invites Bids from reputed, experienced, and competent Agencies for operation and maintenance of water sports activities at eight identified locations in Bihar. Please refer to the RFP for details.
2. The selection shall be for an initial period of three years and may be extended annually on mutual assent

SL-No.	Name of properties	Bid processing Fees	Bid Document Cost	Bid (EMD)
1	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Agencies for Operation and Maintenance of Water Sports Activities in Bihar 1. Kangan Ghat, Patna City, Patna	590.00	5,000.00	1,00,000.00

3. Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting : Date -27.10.2026 Time 11.30 AM. BSTDC office, Sikh Heritage Bhawan, Daroga Prasad Rai Path, Patna-800001
4. Date of downloading of bid document : From – 20.10.2026 to 04.11.2026 up to 02.00 PM Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5. Last date and time for receipt of bids on eproc2 : Date– 04.11.2026 Time 3.00 PM.
6. Time and Date of opening of technical bids : Date– 05.11.2026 Time 4.00 PM. Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7. Time and Date of financial bids : To be Communicated later on
8. Place of opening of Bid : Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
9. Period of bids validity : 180 days
10. Officer inviting bids : General Manager (BSTDC)
11. For any information Sri Suman Kumar, Mobile No. 9431813305/ 8544418314 can be contacted.
Further details of works can be obtained from the office of General Manager. For clarification, regarding the E –tendering process, please contact e-Proc2.0, Helpdesk, mjunction services limited RJ Complex, 2nd Floor, Canara Bank Campus, Khajpura, Ashiana Road, P.S. - Shastri Nagar, Patna 800 014, Bihar, Toll Free Number: 1800 572 6571, Email Id: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**
PR. No. 014048 (B&C) 2026-27 सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ। General Manager (O&F) BSTDC

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING RECONSTRUCTION/STRENGTHENING ON PALWAL HASSANPUR ROAD VIA KUSHAK (ID 3534) RD 0.00 TO 4.40 KM AND RD 7.65 TO 7.78 KM IN PALWAL CONSTITUENCY IN PROVINCIAL DIVISION, PWD BANDR BR., PALWAL UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27 (PART-II) IN PALWAL DISTT. (UNDER HEAD-5054-MDR-GROUP-3) (WITHOUT GST).	19.10.2026 09.11.2026	1167.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R,JIND	CONSTRUCTION OF PHC AT VILLAGE RAJANA KALAN IN JIND DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 28.10.2026	345.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pwdeepdjind@gmail.com
3	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ANNUAL MAINTENANCE OF PLANTATION WORK IN CENTRAL-VERGE OF 4 LANING ON RAI-MALIKPUR (RAJASTHAN BORDER) - NANGAL CHAUDHARY - NARNAUL - MAHENDRAGARH DADRI ROAD KM 30.50 TO 34.86 AND KM 35.60 TO 84.82) (FORMERLY OLD NH 148-B)] IN MAHENDRAGARH DISTRICT (SH-17) (ROAD ID 2620 & 2594) (PHASE - 3) (KM. 59.712 TO 71.766) (3 MONTHS) (01.01.2027 TO 31.03.2027) AND ONE OTHER	19.10.2026 05.11.2026	12.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9717214202 zilesinghhort@gmail.com
4	PWD B&R, AMBALA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING WDG. AND STG. FOR VARIOUS 13 NOS. LINK ROADS (I.E. ROAD ID 1, 6, 49, 308, 310, 340, 392, 7786, 7791, 7796, 7798, 9243 AND 10534) UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.2, PWD BANDR BR., AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (SCSP SCHEME) (MULLANA CONSTITUENCY) (GROUP-1)	16.10.2026 27.10.2026	455.44 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, HANSI	DEVELOPMENT OF CHOWK FOR ENTRY AND EXIT OF BARWALA CITY ON INTERNAL CITY PORTION ROAD IN HISAR DISTRICT. (ROAD ID 11533) (AS DESIRED BY THE HON`BLE PWM, HARYANA) (WITHOUT GST).	17.10.2026 27.10.2026	307.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01663259688 xenpwdhansi@gmail.com
6	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REHABILITATION OF GOTHRA MINOR FROM RD 0 TO RD 39700 (TAIL)	16.10.2026 02.11.2026	560.70 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250297003 xenlwsdadri@gmail.com
7	PANCHAYATI RAJ,SONIPAT	CONSTRUCTION OF FREEDOM FIGHTER KAVI JAAT MEHAR SINGH BHAWAN AT VILLAGE KHARKHODA BLOCK KHARKHODA.	CLOSING DATE 27.10.2026	42.01 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416391006 prexeeng.snp@gmail.com
8	PANCHAYATI RAJ,SONIPAT	P AND L OF RCC PIPELINE FOR DIRTY WATER FROM PEER TO SONIPAT ROAD AT VILLAGE GARHI SARAI NUMBERDAR KHAN (GP)	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	37.78 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416391006 prexeeng.snp@gmail.com
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, NARWANA	RE-CONSTRUCTION OF WATERCOURSE CROSSING AT RD 24400 BHANA BHARAMNAN DRAIN	CLOSING DATE 23.10.2026	4.23 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9660864175 xen-wsnnw.irr@gov.in
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SIRSA	INTERNAL AND OUTER CLEARANCE OF SHEIKHUPURA DISTY. FROM RD. 0-82100-TAIL (RABI 2026-27) BUPP SECTION. + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 26.10.2026	15.09 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996665761 xensrs.swd1925@yahoo.com
11	MOTILAL NEHRU SCHOOL OF SPORTS, RAI, SONEPAT	CMC OF LAPTOPS PRINTERS AND DESKTOPS	19.10.2026 09.11.2026	4.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8708859410 mnssrai@rediffmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in 50405/HRY

SPECIAL DRIVE TO CLEAR PENDING CASES OF APPOINTMENT ON COMPASSIONATE GROUNDS
10TH NOVEMBER 2026
SPECIAL ADALAT
Special Adalat will be held on 10.11.2026 at 11.00 hrs. in DRM Office premises of Delhi, Lucknow, Moradabad, Firozpur, Ambala, Jammu & Northern Railway HQ office, Baroda House, New Delhi.
DISPOSAL OF PENDING CG CASES ON THE SPOT
You can submit your grievances regarding appointment on compassionate ground in two copies along with relevant papers to Senior Divisional Personnel Officer of respective Divisions and in case of HQs. Division to Dy. Chief Personnel Officer HQ-I latest by 31.10.2026
Note:- (i) Application regarding Compassionate Ground cases related to Workshops & Extra Divisional offices be sent to adjoining Division.
(ii) Old decided cases will not be entertained.

Dy. Chief Personnel Officer (HQ-I)
Northern Railway Headquarter
Baroda House, KG Marg, New Delhi-110001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager
Office, Northern Railway,
State Entry Road, New Delhi-110001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager
Office, Northern Railway,
Hazrat Ganj, Lucknow-226001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager
Office, Northern Railway,
Rail Vihar, Ambala Cantt,
Ambala-133001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager
Office, Northern Railway,
Near Railway Stadium,
Moradabad-244001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager
Office, Northern Railway,
Station Road, Firozpur Cantt.
Firozpur-152001

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer
Divisional Railway Manager Office,
Northern Railway,
Trikuta Nagar, Jammu-180004

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Always at your service
3657/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NHPC seeks ministry nod to chop over 23 lakh trees for hydel project in Arunachal

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, October 21

GOVERNMENT ENTERPRISE National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC) has sought clearance from the Union Environment Ministry to divert for non-forest purpose 3,278 hectares of high-conservation-value forest in the lower Himalayas region of Arunachal Pradesh for its Kamala hydroelectric project.

The project, with a proposed capacity of 1,720 MW, will harness waters of Kamala River, a right-bank tributary of Subansiri River, as per official documents.

The Union Environment Ministry's Forest Advisory Committee (FAC), which grants prior approval for non-forest work on forest land, will appraise the forest diversion proposal on October 23, as per the FAC's official agenda.

The diversion of the forest across Kra Daadi, Kurung Kumey and Kamle districts, if approved, will entail the felling of 23.4 lakh trees, the proposal documents show.

Out of 23,40,213 trees earmarked for the felling, 15.08 lakh are in the Hapoli forest division and 8.31 lakh, in Kra Daadi division.

Compensatory afforestation in lieu of the forest diversion has been proposed over 7,018 hectares across many districts of Madhya Pradesh, as per official documents.

Normally, when forest land is diverted for non-forest purposes, an equivalent patch of non-forest land must be found locally for afforestation.

Since Arunachal Pradesh already has a high forest cover, the Forest Conservation Act allows to fulfil the compensatory afforestation obligations on non-forest land in other states which have less forest cover.

However, the FCA says that if no equivalent non-forest land is available, then a plantation twice the size of the diverted forest land has to be raised on degraded land. The same will be the case for the afforestation programme proposed in Madhya Pradesh.

The Kamala project is one among a cascade of hydel projects planned in the Subansiri River basin.

The project was recommended for environmental clearance (EC) in January by the Environment Ministry's sectoral expert panel on river valley and hydroelectric projects with the condition that final EC will be granted only after in-principle forest clearance. The site inspection report by officials of the Environment Ministry's regional office in Shillong noted that the project site does not fall in any national park, wildlife sanctuary, biosphere reserve, or elephant corridor.

However, it added, the project "will undoubtedly affect the habitats of various wildlife. Moreover, the increased width of the submerged area will adversely affect the migration of wild animals from one bank to the other." With this observation, it sought a wildlife mitigation plan/biodiversity conservation plan.

Conceived as a run-of-the-river cum storage project, the Rs 2,400-crore Kamala hydel project involves a 216-metre-high concrete gravity dam equipped with approved flood moderation features.

The reservoir area and the dam top areas are expected to take up nearly 2,960.49 hectares of forest land.

The Kamala River valley is almost entirely hilly and mostly covered by dense forests. A total of 5,440 families in 126 villages will be affected due to the project, as per its Social Impact Assessment report.

Turmoil in MP environment body as chair seeks member secy suspension

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 21

A GROWING rift between senior officials of Madhya Pradesh's State Environment Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA) has spilt into the open, with chairman Shivnarayan Singh Chauhan seeking the immediate suspension of member secretary Harshal Pancholi, accusing him of "damaging the reputation of SEIAA and the state government".

Pancholi told *The Indian Express* he is ready to face any investigation.

Chauhan has accused the member secretary of bypassing the chairman's approval, selectively listing cases for environmental clearance and failing to act on a National Green Tribunal (NGT) order restricting mining without the authority's approval, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

In a four-page letter dated October 20 to Chief Secretary Ashok Barnwal, Chauhan alleged that "Pancholi is repeatedly committing serious irregularities and openly violating prescribed legal provisions".

The chairman warned that a "delay in taking disciplinary action against him is causing irreparable damage to the environment and creating a situation of disorder within SEIAA".



Shivnarayan Singh Chauhan



Harshal Pancholi

"Since he is the Member Secretary of SEIAA as well as an officer of the state government, the irregularities allegedly committed by him are damaging the reputation of SEIAA and the state government," Chauhan wrote. When contacted, Chauhan confirmed he sent the letter. "Whoever works against the law, we will take action against them."

Pancholi, when contacted, said, "As per the rules, it is the member secretary who drafts the agenda, prepares the minutes of the meeting and also helps in deciding the environmental clearances. The chairman has been doing all this in his own office, and the member secretaries have been a rubber stamp post. Now I have come in and brought transparency to the process, and he is seeking my suspension citing clerical errors."

Chauhan responded that he made the allegations based on proper documentation. "I am not making false allegations and have proper proof of every allegation," he claimed.

The dispute comes as around 500 cases are pending before SEIAA, according to the chairman's letter. Chauhan alleged that Pancholi "prepared the agendas for meetings under his administrative control without following the prescribed procedure."

He alleged that Pancholi "either does not understand the law or is deliberately disregarding it." "Although the agendas were required to be approved by the Chairperson, seven cases were included in the agenda of SEIAA's 966th meeting without the Chairperson's approval, allegedly in violation of the legal provisions," Chauhan claimed.

The dispute is not limited to the internal administration of the authority. One allegation concerns compliance with an NGT order dated February 3, 2026, which dealt with mining permissions issued by two executive officers without the required consideration and approval of SEIAA. The tribunal directed that the mining identified in the case should not proceed without SEIAA's approval.

Chauhan alleged that despite repeatedly writing to Pancholi to ensure compliance, the cases identified by the tribunal were not placed before SEIAA for consideration, because of which Pancholi "violated the NGT's order and did not comply with the Chairperson's requests."

He cited four letters sent on February 10, May 8, October 5 and October 13 this year, alleging that his directions had not been followed.

The chairman also referred to proceedings before the SC in a Writ Petition, in which the Union government submitted a counter-affidavit concerning deemed environmental clearances. Chauhan said he had asked for the relevant cases to be placed before SEIAA, but alleged that only one was included in the agenda.

The letter also points to delays in issuing formal environmental clearance letters.

Vummidi Ethiraj, instrumental in crafting historic 'sengol', dies

Press Trust of India
Chennai, October 21

LEADING JEWELLER Vummidi Ethiraj, who was instrumental in crafting the historic 'sengol', died here on Wednesday. He was 99.

"With deep sorrow, we inform you of the sad demise of our beloved Shri Vummidi Ethiraj Garu on 21st October 2026," his publicist said in a social media post.

Vummidi Ethiraj, born on November 25, 1926, was the patriarch of the Vummidi family, which owns the 125-year-old Vummidi Bangaru Jewellers. Ethiraj was involved in the creation of the 'sengol', a gold-plated silver sceptre that symbolised the transfer of power from British rule to independent India in 1947.

President Droupadi Murmu said: "I am deeply saddened by the passing of Shri Vummidi Ethiraj Ji, a distinguished craftsperson whose work became part of a defining moment in India's history. His craft in creating the Sengol has given him a lasting place in India's civilisational heritage..."

Prime Minister Narendra Modi wrote on X: "...[Ethiraj] will always be remembered for his efforts in crafting the historic sengol..."

Year after surrender, 26-yr-old Maoist kills self at govt rehab centre in Chhattisgarh

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, October 21

A 26-YEAR-OLD former Maoist cadre died by suicide at a rehabilitation centre run by the government, in Chhattisgarh's Bijapur district on Wednesday morning.

Police said he was a low-rung cadre who never had any serious offence registered against him.

The deceased, Narsu Boddu alias Naiti, was a resident of Kamkanar in Gangaloor area, which was a major ground for Maoist recruitment. Boddu's aunt, also a surrendered cadre, was housed in the same rehab centre along with 120 others.

A militia member for five-six years, Boddu had never handled a gun, sources said. He had surrendered last year. In July, he had come to the rehab centre voluntarily to seek benefits, including money, a mobile phone and training in agriculture and fish farming, under the policy. He was set to leave for home after the training in a week's time.

While the police have ruled out foul play and said investigations are on to find out the motive behind the extreme step, Boddu's brother Satish alleged foul play. "In 2025, he was brought (over to the centre) to surrender. In 15 days, he was sent back. Again, he was called this year for rehabilitation. Today, we got to know he is dead. He has a wife, children and an ageing father. He could not die like this. He was to be released...," he said.

Satish said he last chatted with his brother at 9pm on Tuesday. "He called me and asked about his family. He said he will call me in the morning. I was waiting to hear from him when I got a call from our aunt informing about his death," said Satish. This is the third death in the Naiti family due to suicide. "Boddu's mother died by suicide two years ago. His brother, too, had died in the same manner four to five years ago," said a police source, adding that in a preliminary check, nothing suspicious was found.

A magisterial inquiry has been ordered into the incident, Bijapur Superintendent of Police, Umesh Gupta, said. "We regularly counsel them (the former Maoists) and there are daily interactions. Also, we have sports activities for them. But we will monitor them better after this incident," he added.

Ladakh admn dissolves Kargil hill council, announces panchayat polls on November 21

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, October 21

THE UNION Territory administration on Wednesday dissolved the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council (LAHDC), Kargil, following the creation of six new districts under reorganisation. The administration has also notified 100 constituencies for the UT's eight hill councils.

The State Election Commission of Ladakh has also announced panchayat elections on November 21. According to an official release from Ladakh's Department of Information and Public Relations, the polling for panchayat elections will be held on November 21, and the filing of nominations closes on November 2.

The key decisions have come at a time when the Ladakh leaders were waiting for an invite for the next round of talks with the Union Home Ministry, expected on Thursday.

On Wednesday evening, the administration in Ladakh dissolved the LAHDC Kargil. "The body corporate known as LADAKH Autonomous Hill Development Council Kargil stands dissolved and de-constituted with immediate effect... and all elected or nominated members... shall, with immediate effect, cease to hold office or exercise any powers," reads the order.

The dissolution took place after the creation of six new districts in the Himalayan region. While three new districts — Sham, Nubra and Changthang — were created from Leh district, Drass, Zanskar and Sanko were created from the Kargil district.

ADVERTORIAL

Securing Every Family,
Strengthening Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh is expanding its social-security framework to provide greater financial stability and healthcare protection to workers, frontline personnel, pensioners and their families. From hike in Shikshamitras' honorarium to enhanced support for Anganwadi workers and mid-day meal cooks, the initiatives combine higher incomes with wider welfare coverage. With increased pensions, cashless healthcare and accident assistance, the focus is on extending financial protection to millions across the state.



Beyond the Paycheque: UP Builds a Wider Social-Security Net

From outsourced workers and frontline staff to pensioners and their families, welfare support expands across income, healthcare and financial protection

Relief for 1.28 Lakh Shikshamitras: 80% Honorarium Hike

- 80% Honorarium Hike: Monthly payment increased from ₹10,000 to ₹18,000.
- 1,27,841 Shikshamitras: Eligible for enhanced honorarium under Samagra Shiksha in 2026–27.
- ₹460.23 Crore Allocated: ₹230.11 crore each for September and October at the revised rate.
- Timely Disbursement: District-wise allocations issued to facilitate payments to eligible teachers.

Mid-day meal cooks: more income, more protection

- 3.53 Lakh mid-day meal cooks get a stronger welfare package
- Honorarium up from ₹2,000 to ₹3,000 per month
- Cashless healthcare up to ₹5 lakh, ₹2 lakh accident assistance
- Uniform allowance doubled from ₹500 to ₹1,000
- A combined approach of income enhancement + health + accident protection

3.5 lakh+ outsourced workers in the welfare framework

- Uttar Pradesh Corporation for Outsourcing Services (UPCOS) bringing wider welfare protection to outsourced workers & their families
- Around 3.5 lakh outsourced employees covered under the broader initiative.
- With families included, the potential reach is estimated at 17-20 lakh people.
- Focus shifts from worker-centric assistance to family-oriented social security.
- Employment-linked welfare is being strengthened with wider protection measures.

Anganwadi workers: stronger support for frontline workers

- 50% hike in monthly honorarium: Anganwadi workers' honorarium rises from ₹8,000 to ₹12,000.
- Helpers also receive enhanced support.
- Health insurance included in the expanded welfare measures.
- The initiative strengthens protection for workers delivering essential services at the grassroots.



₹1,500 monthly pension for 1.18 crore+ beneficiaries

- 50% increase in monthly pension: Support rises from ₹1,000 to ₹1,500, benefiting senior citizens, destitute women and persons with disabilities.
- Around 1.18 crore beneficiaries across the three categories.
- Higher recurring support provides greater financial assistance for everyday needs.

Healthcare becomes a key welfare pillar

- Cashless healthcare extended to teachers, PRD personnel, mid-day meal cooks, Anganwadi workers and helpers.
- Health insurance and cashless treatment aim to reduce the financial impact of medical emergencies.

Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

WEB EXCLUSIVE
The UN must recover Dag Hammarskjöld's sense of purpose — *Syed Munir Khasru*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
A person whose mind is not free, though he may not be in chains, is a slave. — *B R Ambedkar*

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IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Rubio visit prepares ground for reboot of ties

MARCO RUBIO'S three-day visit to Mumbai and Jamnagar comes amid unexpected turbulence in India's relations with the United States during President Donald Trump's second term. Hopefully, Rubio's visit has prepared the ground for rebooting relations in the remaining two years of Trump's term. For Delhi, Rubio's persona matters. He is both Secretary of State and National Security Adviser, a powerful combination last seen under Henry Kissinger in the 1970s. As a Senator, Rubio has long favoured closer ties with India. He is a possible Republican presidential candidate in 2028. India's political investment in the engagement with Rubio is a prudent bet for the long-term relationship with the US.

For the near term, Rubio has sent positive signals. He expects the long-pending trade deal to be concluded soon, and President Trump has confirmed the assessment. Pessimists in Delhi, and there are many, fear that Trump could still reverse course on tariffs over Russian oil purchases. Optimists see room to narrow differences on the issue as Trump seeks to recalibrate relations with Russia and change the earlier course on Ukraine. Rubio has said the Jamnagar facility has made India a "refining superpower" and has hinted at a more strategic energy collaboration between India and the US that goes beyond Indian purchases of American hydrocarbons. Reliance, which runs the Jamnagar refineries, and now buys Venezuelan crude under a US licence, is set to become a crucial node in the US-India energy alliance. Rubio also hinted at a possible Quad meeting on the margins of the East Asia Summit in November, and spoke of the work underway at the ministerial level. He refused to be drawn into a discussion on the current protests in India, arguing that they are an internal matter.

On H-1B visas, India also needs to pause and look within. Its own visa policy is highly restrictive; its political class is locked in a harsh public debate on foreign migrants. The government in Delhi has sensibly dissociated itself from the H-1B debate, which is an issue between US companies looking for foreign talent and the MAGA movement leading the backlash. Rubio said that the US is overhauling its immigration system. Once that is done, and the logic of market forces asserts itself, it is reasonable to expect Indian talent to fare better than most. It is also unfortunate that Delhi has made US relations with Pakistan a major issue in its engagement with Trump. India cannot claim the right to good relations with US adversaries like Iran and object when Washington does the same with Islamabad. Those familiar with the history of India-US ties will point out that the biggest advances in US-India ties, including the civil nuclear deal, came in the 2000s, when Washington had a very close military partnership with General Musharraf's Pakistan. India's relations with the US must be built on its own merits rather than in hyphenation with Pakistan. There is more than enough common ground to do that. India needs greater self-assurance in engaging the US.

From government in Bengal, only opposition

IF THERE is one thing that stands out in West Bengal's annual Durga Puja, it is its largesse as a public commons — the *sarbojonin* — where there is room for the devout, the argumentative, and the sceptic. And so, year after year, alongside the beat of the *dhak*, the crowds at the pandals, the food stalls that dot the festive perimeters, a constant has been book stalls, many set up by Left parties. The conviction that political differences need not extinguish cultural fellowship seems to have faltered this year. Across the state, reports of vandalism of these book stalls suggest a disturbing narrowing of that common ground.

The tension also echoes wider concerns about the BJP government's priorities since coming to power in May on the promise of change. In the five months since, its actions show the instincts of an opposition party on the street, drawn to the readily mobilised terrain of identity politics. It shows few signs of getting down to the harder work of governance. The disquieting spectacle of arrested TMC members being paraded through their erstwhile strongholds by police and paramilitary forces soon after the BJP came to power; the passage of the West Bengal Universities and Colleges (Administration and Regulation) (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and the controversial Anti-Goonda Bill 2026 raise questions about institutional autonomy and administrative overreach. Together, these developments evoke an older playbook in the state in which power travelled through patronage, muscle and systemic impunity — the culture the BJP promised to change.

While investigations are ongoing to identify the miscreants, at least two BJP leaders have come out in condemnation of the acts of vandalism, among them Finance Minister Swapan Dasgupta. His insistence that ideological differences cannot justify the destruction of books sits uneasily alongside Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari's suggestion that the Left sell books from its own offices. Bengal has urgent tasks before it: Creating jobs and strengthening public institutions. Its literary traditions and appetite for debate are its strengths. The government should address the structural failures that constrain the state, not erode what gives it distinction.

A king fit for a play

THE 2001 film *A Knight's Tale* is set in the (13)70s, so naturally its soundtrack is full of classic rock and funk hits from the (19)70s. But for all its anachronisms, it gets some things right about the reign of Edward III of England -- for instance, the Black Prince competing in disguise in a tournament, something his father, the king, is known to have done. This was part of Edward's project to live up to the chivalric ideal of kingship, which he did so well that Ian Mortimer titled his 2006 biography *The Perfect King*. It was one of the most consequential reigns in English history, from great victories in France to the Black Death. The poet Thomas Gray summed up the highs and lows of Edward's reign thus: "Amazement in his van, with Flight combin'd,/And Sorrow's faded form, and Solitude behind."

Such a king deserves a Shakespeare play, one might think. Arguably, there is one. Weighing in on a long-running debate over the authorship of the play *Edward III*, a forthcoming study using computerised linguistic analysis concludes that William Shakespeare was the principal author — and his collaborator was Christopher Marlowe.

As technology opens up new possibilities in historical research, it's an exciting time. But let's also take a moment to remember the more eccentric Shakespeare authorship theorists — whose takeaway from this might be that the Earl of Oxford wrote *Edward III*.

Let's recreate the UN — 81 years show why it's worth the effort



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

THE UNITED NATIONS (UN) celebrates its 81st birthday on Saturday, though with the Security Council (UNSC) deadlocked on who will lead the organisation as secretary-general in the New Year, celebrations are somewhat muted. The UN stands today at a precarious crossroads, frequently condemned as a relic of a bygone era in urgent need of reform, yet remaining undeniably central to the global agenda, while failing at its vital task, the maintenance of international peace and security.

Over its history, the UN system has constructed the normative architecture of international society and saved millions of lives. On the humanitarian front, specialised agencies have driven historic triumphs: Joint campaigns by UNICEF and the World Health Organisation nearly halved child mortality from 12 million in 1990 to 6.9 million by 2011, brought polio to the brink of eradication, and coordinated global responses to public health crises like Ebola and Covid. The UN High Commissioner for Refugees (the organisation I served from 1978 to 1989) assists over 35 million displaced people annually, while the World Food Programme regularly delivers vital relief to millions of people struck by catastrophic disasters.

This humanitarian impact is matched by an ambitious global development and environmental agenda. The Millennium Development Goals (2000–2015) halved extreme poverty worldwide, expanded access to primary education for millions, and significantly reduced maternal mortality, laying the groundwork for the 2015–2030 Sustainable Development Goals, even as these multilateral commitments now face severe challenges because of funding cuts under the second Trump administration. UN-brokered instruments ranging from the Montreal Protocol, which successfully phased out 99 per cent of ozone-depleting chlorofluorocarbons, to the Kyoto Protocol and the Paris Agreement, have redefined global environmental responsibility. From advancing women's rights at the landmark Beijing Conference to establishing the first unified international framework for migration (the 2018 Global Compact for Migration), the UN has expanded the boundaries of global social policy, though a backlash against these achievements has been mounting.

That brings us to peace and security: Through its peace-making and peacekeeping machinery, which I served from 1989 to 1996 and helped oversee from secretary-general Kofi Annan's office for another decade, the UN has brokered roughly 170 peace settlements, helping to defuse existential flashpoints from the Cuban Missile Crisis to the Iran-Iraq War, containing complex civil conflicts, and stabilising nations transitioning to freedom like Namibia, East Timor, and Mozambique. However, in recent years, the UN has seemed increasingly ineffectual, as wars have raged, unchecked by UN intervention, in Ukraine, Iran, Gaza, Libya and Yemen. Critics point to the UNSC's chronic paralysis and the apparent inability of recent secretaries-general to stand up for the principles of the UN Charter.

It is undeniable that the UNSC anachronistically reflects the geopolitical realities of 1945 and not those of 2025. The world has undergone a radical transformation over those eight decades. The collapse of European colonial empires spawned dozens of vibrant, independent nations, while new dynamic powers have emerged as drivers of regional growth and stability. Yet the composition of the Council's permanent membership looks like a war photo from 1945. Billions of people remain without permanent representation, while major nations and economic leaders are excluded from the primary decision-making organ of global security. The disconnect between actual relevance and formal authority creates a representational deficit, eroding confidence in the international rule of law and leading more and more states to view Council resolutions with cynicism.

> But reform must stop short of the point where the most powerful and influential member states might walk away, because that would end the UN

This crisis of legitimacy is further compounded by the veto power, which has transformed the UNSC into a stage for strategic obstruction. When individual permanent members use the mere threat of a veto to shield themselves or their allies from accountability during humanitarian catastrophes, wars or blatant violations of sovereign borders, the fundamental purpose of the Charter is subverted. When gridlock recurs in the Council, countries increasingly turn to smaller, self-selected coalitions, ad hoc regional alliances, or exclusive economic forums like the G20.

But the G20 cannot dispatch peacekeepers to crisis spots, and it does not enjoy the moral authority that comes from the UN's universal membership. Regional blocs and "mini-lateral" groupings, while useful for specific economic or defensive interests, lack the global inclusiveness and universal authority that only the UN possesses. A world without a functioning, effective UNSC would be a Thucydidean world where "the strong do what they can and the weak suffer what they must". In other words, where might is right, and smaller and developing nations possess virtually no institutional recourse or voice. The universal membership of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) and the binding legal authority of UNSC decisions under international law therefore remain irreplaceable public goods.

Everyone agrees the UN needs reform, but they don't agree on what that means. When the developed West speaks of reform, they mean budget cuts, merger of UN departments and organisations, and streamlining of mandates, staff numbers and costs; but when developing countries speak of reform, they call for greater inclusion, better representation and a definitive voice in determining the UN's priorities. Expanding permanent seats to include underrepresented regions and emerging powers, establishing clear norms to limit veto usage, and deepening formal accountability between the UNSC and the UNGA are steps that would restore the UN's credibility in much of the world. But reform must stop short of the point where the most powerful and influential member states might walk away, because that would end the UN.

The UN matters because global governance of international peace and security requires an anchor grounded in both universalism and broad legitimacy. At its best, the UN embodied the core idea of the post-war order: Multilateralism could function as a shock absorber, providing a permanent, continuous space where adversaries could meet, de-escalate tensions, and negotiate behind closed doors even during moments of extreme global confrontation. It is that UN we need to recreate, and 81 years is long enough to show us why it's worth doing.

The writer, an MP, served the UN from 1978 to 2007. He was India's candidate for UN secretary-general in 2006

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and the unresolved Pashtun question



BHOPINDER SINGH

DEAR EDITOR
I disagree
A fortnightly column in which we invite readers to tell us why, when they differ with the editorial positions or news coverage of 'The Indian Express'

> When a party becomes the principal vehicle for a region's political opposition, suppressing its mandate risks being perceived as suppressing the region itself

PAKISTAN'S HISTORY offers a recurring warning: When the state mistakes regional dissent for disloyalty and electoral opposition for a security threat, it risks turning political grievances into an existential crisis. A recent editorial in this newspaper ('The siege within Khyber Pakhtunkhwa', *IE*, October 17) focused on the political factors leading to the declaration of emergency and the displacement of the elected government in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP). It, however, does not touch upon the Pashtun question, one that predates Pakistan.

Abdul Ghaffar Khan's Khudai Khidmatgar movement represented an anti-colonial tradition that sat uneasily with the Muslim League's vision of nationhood. The 1947 referendum in the North-West Frontier Province, which excluded independence and a separate Pashtunistan from its options, left enduring grievances among sections of Pashtun political opinion. Pashtun nationalism was subsequently viewed through the lenses of separatism, Afghan interference and territorial insecurity.

The parallels with East Pakistan in 1970-71 are not exact, but they are sufficiently unsettling to warrant scrutiny. In December 1970, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's Awami League won an absolute majority in Pakistan's National Assembly. Instead of transferring power, the West Pakistani establishment (read: Military) treated the result as a threat. Negotiations collapsed, military repression followed, and civil war, Indian intervention and Bangladesh's independence became the natural consequences. The East Pakistan crisis reflected a structural contradiction: Bengalis constituted the demographic majority but remained marginalised within the military, bureaucracy and commanding institutions of the state. KP presents a different situation, but the danger is recognisable. The PTI secured a strong mandate in the province in 2024. Its confrontation with the federal government and powerful state institutions has deepened Pakistan's political crisis.

The question is whether emergency powers address a demonstrable security threat or neutralise a political constituency the establishment cannot defeat electorally. A genuine emergency must be necessary, proportionate, temporary and constitutionally accountable. When extraordinary powers circumvent the electorate, coercion replaces democratic consent. The comparison with 1971 is a warning.

Pashtun communities straddle the Pakistan-Afghanistan border, while disputes over the Durand Line have long complicated relations between Islamabad and Kabul. Afghanistan cannot simply be presumed to support Pashtun separatism. Nevertheless, when Pakistani Pashtuns experience political exclusion or coercive security policies, domestic grievances can acquire a cross-border dimension. Islamabad may interpret dissent as foreign interference, justifying further coercion. The resulting cycle is dangerous. Exclusion encourages external interest, external interest intensifies security anxieties, and those anxieties become grounds for further exclusion. Democratic accommodation is a stronger defence against foreign exploitation than suppressing legitimate grievances.

The PTI is a national party, not simply a Pashtun nationalist movement. Imran Khan's appeal extends beyond KP, and its voters do not collectively endorse separatism. Yet when a party becomes the principal vehicle for a region's political opposition, suppressing its mandate risks being perceived as suppressing the region itself. Pakistan faces genuine security challenges, including the Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan. These require effective action, but security concerns do not grant unlimited discretion to the centre. Provincial leaders, too, must demonstrate commitment to protecting citizens.

The ultimate test of Pakistani federalism is not how forcefully the centre compels KP to comply, but whether citizens believe their votes matter, their identity is secure, and their place in the federation rests on democratic consent. A state that refuses to hear its regions should not be surprised when, eventually, they stop speaking its political language and seek their own flag.

The writer is a retired lieutenant-general and former L-G of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Puducherry

Sir Syed, in his time, and for ours



TARIQ MANSOOR

> A multi-faceted personality whose work changed the course of history during the second half of the 19th century in India, his genius and methods were too individual to belong to a single school of thought

SINCE OCTOBER 17, students and alumni of Aligarh Muslim University all over the world have been celebrating the 209th birth anniversary of Sir Syed Ahmad Khan, whose "official description" is at times restricted to merely being the founder of AMU. A multi-faceted personality whose work changed the course of history during the second half of the 19th century in India, his genius and methods were too individual to belong to a single school of thought.

Our world stands at the crossroads between balancing the promises and perils of AI. Sir Syed faced a similar rupture. The disruption was Western science, locked inside foreign languages. He established the Scientific Society to translate works of science from English and other European languages into Urdu and Hindi.

Sir Syed's endurance in the history of India's social reforms lies in his application of education in conjugating two distinct but complementary goals — social progress and national integration. On January 27, 1883, in Patna, he elaborated on his mission: "It is the categorical verdict of all the nations and great seers of the world that national progress depends on education and training (of the people)... we should strive for a national system of education to educate our people in science and technology".

Read today, it could pass as a part of a charter for the digital age. While a machine can supply answers, only an educated mind can judge them. Sir Syed envisaged a social compact of Hindus and Muslims in his project . His concern was to liberate both communities from medieval thought and lead them towards reason, breadth of mind and progress. When colonial rule was injecting the social fabric with the venom of suspicion, Sir Syed answered through his deeds. When he founded a school at Ghazipur, he invited Raja Dev Narayan Singh to be its patron. Fellowship between the communities was part of MAO College's foundation. Sir Syed vehemently opposed cow sacrifice and asked Muslims to abandon it for the sake of friendly relations with the Hindus.

Some historians fault Sir Syed's remarks on the social order of his times. Others cite his perceived closeness to the colonial government. A verdict built on a few 19th-century quotations, stripped of their context, might jar with today's values. But he emphasised Muslim social-educational empowerment because Hindus were ahead of Muslims in taking up modern scientific education and social reforms. He criticised the obduracy of Muslims on this count as a "fatal shroud of complacent self-esteem".

PM Narendra Modi should be credited with rekindling the relevance of Sir Syed beyond the optics of politics. He quoted him while invoking the principles of "nation first' and "*sabka saath, sabka vikas, sabka vishwas*" at the centenary celebrations of AMU in 2020: "I would like to remind you of one thing said by Sir Syed. He had said, 'The first and foremost duty of one who is concerned about his country is to work for the welfare of all people, irrespective of their caste, creed or religion.'"

The writer is a former vice-chancellor of Aligarh Muslim University and a nominated Member of the Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council

40 YEARS AGO
October 22, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
Timber trader shot dead in Panchkula
Concern over neglect
Kaunda accuses

Trader killed in Panchkula

TERRORISTS STRUCK in Haryana, gunning down Anand Sarup Trehan, a timber merchant, in the busy market of Sector 7, Panchkula. Three bearded young men shot at Trehan from close range and escaped in his new white Maruti car (CHI-9033). Trehan, a prosperous businessman of Chandigarh, was building a house and had gone to purchase material from an electrical store in Sector 7. According to eyewitnesses, Trehan had just entered his car parked in front of the shop when the three assailants dragged him out. Trehan tried to run but was shot in the chest.

US to expel 55 Soviet diplomats

THE UNITED STATES, retaliating for the expulsion of five American diplomats on spy allegations from Moscow, has decided to expel 55 Soviet diplomats from the country, two US officials said. An announcement was expected from the State Department later. Some of the Soviets are assigned to the embassy in Washington and the others to the Soviet consulate in San Francisco.

Concern over environment

VASANT SATHE, Union Minister of Energy, expressed concern over the neglect of the environment in the country over the years, which has resulted in adverse consequences. He was speaking at a national seminar on "Environmental Pollution Control and Monitoring" organised by the Central Scientific Instruments Organisation.

OPEC agreement on quotas

OIL MINISTERS from the member nations of the Organisation of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) have reached an agreement on oil production quotas after 16 days of talks. The compromise agreement proposes a nominal increase in oil production of about 140,000 barrels a day.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

The military's blank check will cost Israelis dearly for decades.
— Haaretz, Israel

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The fork in the CEC protest road: Both Opposition and Government need to decide



VANDITA MISHRA

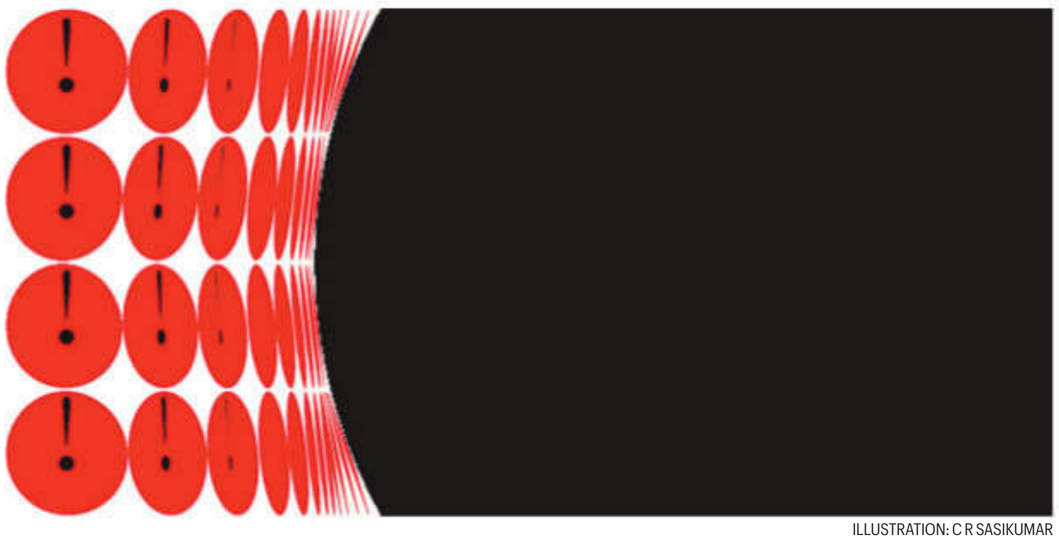


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

THE PROTESTS against the Chief Election Commissioner and his conduct of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls prise open a black box, shine the light on a vital institution. Coming close on the heels of the agitation against the NEET paper leaks, they are unlocking the public square, letting the hum and noise of democracy seep back in. For years, the ruling BJP has used its imposing electoral mandates to claim that the voices of those who have lost the elections don't matter, need not be heard. Opposition, both with a small and big "o", has been squeezed by an establishment that weaponises poll victories to conquer institutions and subdue countervailing forces.

But amid the recurring protest and crackdown, you also hear sounds of an impasse settling in. Politics is becoming unfrozen, but it seems headed into deadlock. It is running up against closures while opening spaces.

The players in this battle of unequals — the mighty government is wielding its strong arm against the so-far demoralised Congress-led opposition parties and civil-society groups steered by the half-formed Cockroach Janta Party — don't acknowledge each other except in apocalyptic terms. Neither concedes any space for manoeuvre to the opponent, nor recognises the possibility of common or middle ground. The essential staples of negotiation are missing.

Day after day, the government lets the police speak for it, or hurls "anarchist" and "foreign hand" at the other side. Congress and others — who are not always on the same page — have hit back with "regime change", which means a transition of power through elections, but also by short-circuiting them via the street. Bangladesh 2024 and Nepal 2025 framed the grievous toll of the second scenario in India's neighbourhood. But more than the Opposition's unwise use of a freighted term, what must worry both government and Opposition is this: The many stark images of protests being quelled by a repressive state could be wreaking long-term damage on people's trust in institutions and processes. They could sharpen the disconnect between the young and legislatures or parties.

In the near term, what makes the current deadlock more problematic is its timing: Parliamentary elections are still about two and a half years away. The stage is set, in the absence of a breakthrough, for a confrontation that could be long and enervating.

The government sets its face against a dialogue or compromise arguably because the Election Commission's (mis)conduct of the SIR, the disenfranchisement of large numbers of voters and question marks on free and fair elections add up to an issue that potentially cuts deep, much more than the matter of examination leaks. The CJP struck spectacular success in its very first outing, the NEET protests forced a minister to resign. That early triumph is coming in the way of any give and take in its second coming. It doesn't suit Congress to relent, either, because this momentum is so hard-won for a party that has suffered serial electoral defeats, and for Rahul Gandhi, painted into a corner for long by the well-resourced BJP machine.

The government's refusal to engage with protesters could also be stony because it calculates that, unlike the NEET issue, no great sparks have been struck on the ground, so far, by Rahul Gandhi's campaign of "vote *chori*", which predates the SIR and now folds it in. Travelling in UP in June, just as the sit-in over NEET was growing bigger at Jantar Mantar, it seemed clear that the issue affected many more than just those who took the exam. For large numbers of the young and not-so-young, the episode was symbolic of a larger closing of opportunities.

> The many stark images of protests being quelled by a repressive state could be wreaking long-term damage on people's trust in institutions and processes

On the other hand, while reporting on the elections in Bihar and West Bengal, where the ECI's rollout of the SIR had become controversial, it was evident that "vote *chori*" had not become the main or decisive issue. In an election filled with over-promising campaigns, Bihar saw voters return to Nitish Kumar, the chief minister who had delivered, undeterred by the fact that his political imagination had plateaued or that age and illness had taken a toll on him. In West Bengal, the large-scale and apparently targeted deletions of voters in the name of weeding out the "*ghuspaithiya*" could not make it a David-vs-Goliath contest between a helpless Didi and the mighty BJP-ECI. People's grievances accumulated over 15 years against the powerful and pervasive TMC network made it, more, an election in which Didi defeated Didi and the BJP was the beneficiary.

After a 12-year incumbency, the Modi government also faces rising discontents across states, even as cracks are beginning to show within the power phalanx in Delhi. The current protests count on a joining together of these several resentments — over a broken education system, inadequate productive and dignified employment, price rise sharpened by a distant war, corruption, a climate of fear for critics, opponents and minorities. Earlier, there were signs of these grievances gathering around the issue of NEET.

It is not just that, on the ground, "vote *chori*" does not seem as much of a lightning rod. It is also that, then and now, the anti-Modi sentiments are still punctuated by support for Modi, and by the force of the BJP's narratives. In UP, Chief Minister Yogi's still-touted successes on law and order, which is also a euphemism for Muslim-baiting, and the inability of his main opponent, Akhilesh Yadav, to cast a wider net across castes and communities, could come in the way of a consolidation of anti-incumbency.

Going ahead, then, the Congress-led Opposition must make a political judgement. Should they keep their demand focused on the steps the Modi government needs to take to ensure that elections are more free and more fair, beginning with recasting the appointment process of election commissioners? The problem, here, is that institutional reform, as worthy a goal as it is, cannot be easily or immediately packaged to the people as a victory. Should they widen the agenda, then, to include other discontents? They will make the stakes more picturesque, but may not gather around ECI/SIR/vote *chori* quite as readily.

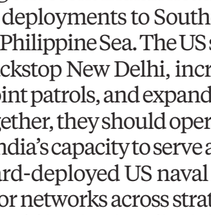
The government needs to ask if it should reach out to protestors and make specific amends, and perhaps nudge other institutions, especially the Court, to also address the concerns of accountability. Or should it ride out the protests, hoping that they will exhaust themselves, or hit their limits?

For both sides, the upcoming elections early next year in UP and Punjab, among other states, could bring a moment of reckoning. It needs to be seen whether the Opposition keeps up the clamour of "vote *chori*" if the AAP wins again in Punjab, or if the SP-Congress make significant gains against the BJP in UP.

On the other side, the BJP has invested enormous effort and resources in building its election machine and honing its focus on UP. Can it risk the shadow over the ECI clouding a much-coveted victory? It could take an election to loosen the impasse over elections eventually.

The writer is national opinion editor, The Indian Express. *vandita.mishra@expressindia.com*

Six steps to strengthen the India-US relationship



DAVID SANTORO

THE US-INDIA relationship is witnessing upheavals and drama like few others. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio's visit to India could not have come at a more opportune time. While Elon Musk's comments and volatile tariff blows have captured headlines and strained bilateral ties, defence and technology cooperation — driven by a shared imperative to counter China — has quietly anchored the India-US partnership. Even though delays plague the delivery of recent historic agreements — such as co-producing US jet engines in India and deploying multi-billion-dollar armed US drones — the underlying integration is solid and advancing. To further strengthen their partnership, both capitals should confront the anxieties that hinder deeper integration.

Washington worries that New Delhi is hesitant to compete with China beyond its land border, resisting commitments to crucial maritime corridors like the South China Sea. Conversely, New Delhi fears that the recent Trump-Xi summit could lead to a grand "G2" bargain, an anxiety fuelled by the US renaming Indo-Pacific Command back to Pacific Command. These concerns, however, are friction points, not dead ends. As US Under Secretary of War for Policy Elbridge Colby recently noted, defence cooperation between India and the US requires neither a formal treaty nor total alignment. By ditching "gauzy abstractions" for hard-nosed realism, both countries can bypass disagreements. New Delhi and Washington should accept that India will maintain its relationship with Russia, just as the US will navigate its partnership with Pakistan. By compartmentalising these friction points, both capitals can advance their broader, forward-looking alignment. Building on this baseline, India and the US should take six steps.

First, they should strengthen deterrence through a reciprocal presence. India should do more in the Pacific to support US leadership, building on recent Indian headway such as the Eastern Fleet's forward deployments to Southeast Asia and coordinated patrols in the Philippine Sea. The US should do more in the Indian Ocean to backstop New Delhi, increasing its naval presence, conducting joint patrols, and expanding access to regional logistics nodes. Together, they should operationalise existing logistics pacts, scale India's capacity to serve as a primary maintenance hub for forward-deployed US naval assets, and establish joint deep-sea sensor networks across strategic chokepoints.

Second, they should institutionalise joint military coordination to manage high-tech friction points. Doing so requires implementing secure communications and geospatial intelligence pacts to shift from ceremonial military exercises to real-time tactical data streaming. This should be matched by a joint framework to defend critical energy grids and satellite networks against cyberattacks. Cooperation should expand to a Joint Space Defence Command to co-develop small military satellites.

Third, they should explore reciprocal defence procurement pathways to better align Indian private firms with global defence acquisition loops under the Make in India initiative. Joint ventures, such as the domestic assembly of long-range drones and the co-production of jet engines, should serve as the baseline for future co-development of precision strike munitions and autonomous systems. Simultaneously, expanding venture capital pipelines under their defence acceleration ecosystem should commercialise dual-use startup innovations before they get bottlenecked in traditional military procurement.

Fourth, they should secure technological and resource supply chains to improve military readiness. By joining the US-led Pax Silica coalition, New Delhi should fortify its regulatory ecosystem to accelerate its domestic Semiconductor Mission, while Washington streamlines export controls to enable predictable transfers of trusted AI infrastructure. Both should execute their Bilateral Critical Minerals Framework, pairing public-private capital to build secure rare earth elements and lithium refining hubs while cutting through commercial and market-access barriers that frustrate private industry.

Fifth, they should anchor their partnership within mini-lateral networks to scale security dividends across the theatre. The bilateral relationship should breathe life into frameworks like the Quad and expand operational formats with regional partners like the Philippines. By integrating their bilateral logistics and surveillance capabilities into these broader groupings, both capitals can transition from talk to collective theatre defence.

Finally, New Delhi and Washington should leverage their powerful global diaspora and invest in cultivating a next-generation constituency. By funding bilateral fellowships and supporting cross-regional exchanges that include Indo-Pacific counterparts, both capitals can build a networked vanguard. These efforts should be anchored by expanded economic and commercial engagement, including streamlining professional mobility to provide a commercial foundation for the broader alliance.

The India-US partnership does not need to be frictionless to be formidable. By abandoning outdated expectations and leaning into a pragmatic, interest-driven alignment, both countries can construct a framework that is mutually beneficial.

The writer is president and CEO of Pacific Forum, based in Honolulu, Hawaii

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Respect the river

CLEANING THE Yamuna requires more than periodic drives and official announcements ('Involve people, focus on what ails Yamuna', *IE*, October 20). Untreated sewage, industrial discharge and solid waste must be addressed at their sources. Municipal bodies should ensure that sewage-treatment plants function efficiently and that industries comply with pollution standards. Citizens must avoid dumping waste and participate in neighbourhood-level monitoring.

K Sakunthala, Coimbatore

AI gatekeeping

CHINA'S CHANGING approach to artificial intelligence exports shows how technology has become an instrument of economic and strategic influence ('China's AI export order is a switch, not a wall', *IE*, October 20). Export restrictions can reshape global supply chains, but they also encourage countries to develop alternatives. India should invest in domestic chip design, computing infrastructure, research and skilled manpower rather than depend on foreign suppliers. Regulations and collaboration between industry, universities and government are equally necessary.

S M Jeeva, Chennai

Organised crime

THE LAWRENCE BISHNOI gang's shootings, killings and threats against prominent people expose a disturbing failure of law enforcement ('A shooting in Juhu, a warning for Mumbai', *IE*, October 20). Despite its leader's imprisonment, the gang continues to operate, raising serious questions about prison security and the government's ability to dismantle criminal networks. Reports of investigations into the gang's activities abroad, alongside allegations of links with Indian authorities, threaten the country's international reputation.

Tushar A Rahatgaonkar, Dombivali East

How to break the ration shop monopoly



RAHUL KUMAR SINGH, DEVESH ROY AND PARUL VARMA

INDIA RUNS the world's largest food-based safety net programme, in which six in 10 Indians draw subsidised cereals each month from one of 5 lakh fair-price shops (FPS). Until 2019, the entitlements were tied to the address on the card. A worker who left his village for a Punjab paddy field, a Delhi construction site, or a Surat textile mill could not draw his or her grain at destination. Poor workers, however, move constantly in search of wages and employment. Tying entitlements to geography was a non-trivial gap in the safety net. The 2020 lockdown made the cost of that gap brutally visible.

In 2019, the One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC) reform was designed to fix this anomaly. ONORC comprised two elements. Portability: With Aadhaar authentication, a beneficiary could collect her quota at any FPS in India. And divisibility: Entitlement could be split across two (in principle more) draws, lifting part of the grain at home and the rest from where the migrant stayed.

The reform's drafters anticipated the main benefit to accrue to long-distance migrant families. With Bihar as the case, the greatest utilisation of ONORC did not happen with migrants from the state in Delhi, Mumbai or comparatively rich destinations. It overwhelmingly took place in geographically proximate FPS. ONORC served as the instrument for the reallocation of bargaining power in favour of beneficiaries as their choices widened. Bihar, India's poorest and largest migrant-donor state, provides the perfect case to validate the relative weight of the two channels of ONORC effects. We employ a dataset of 891 million transactions from its AePDS portal since April 2022, with the IMPDS interstate dataset for cross-state use of ONORC.

> What One Nation One Ration Card has given the cardholder is freedom and thereby empowerment

Data shows that the bargaining-power effect far outstrips the comparatively long-distance migrant-needs effect. In February and March, 62 of every 100 Bihar transactions happened at a shop near the cardholder's assigned FPS. If entitlement compromises in price or quantity or in intangibles like quality of grain or service quality at assigned FPS were the driver for FPS migration, the migrated FPS would likely be in the vicinity (let's call it type 1 portability). If invoked by long-distance migrants, we call it type 2 portability. The decomposition of ONORC usage is revealing: 38 per cent at assigned FPS, 55 per cent at a different FPS in the same block, 4 per cent at a different block in the same district, 2 per cent in another district, and only 1 per cent in other states. Migration across FPS is likely happening to reallocate bargaining power between dealers and beneficiaries. The share of portable transactions has climbed roughly six percentage points a year since April 2022, evenly across Bihar but most in type 1 portability.

Before 2019, the dealer was a monopolist. The tied household had no bargaining power when short-changed in price, quantity, quality of grains or of service. This typically affected comparatively low-power, female-headed and lower-caste households. ONORC structurally changes the power relations. The cardholder can threaten exit, which hurts the dealer as the commission is tied to the volume of grain disbursed. The cardholder who switches disciplines dealers, which could result in better beneficiary outcomes. What ONORC has given the cardholder is freedom and thereby empowerment. Divisibility smoothens the allocation across members. Divisibility is, however, being used comparatively sparingly, perhaps due to lack of awareness, dealer incentives and other factors.

Yet ONORC has made that dealer-client relationship negotiable. Its import goes beyond addressing migrants' needs and preferences. The bargaining-power reallocation may be the largest welfare change PDS has seen in decades.

Singh is JSPS postdoctoral fellow, University of Tokyo and associated with Isaac Centre for Public Policy; Roy is with IFPRI and professor, Ashoka University; Varma is associate with ICPP

Big cats need protection beyond sanctuaries



V B MATHUR

THE WORLD'S seven big cats inhabit different continents and ecosystems, but their futures are increasingly interconnected. A puma in Brazil, a snow leopard in Asia and a tiger in central India's forests face the same challenge: Nature does not recognise administrative and political boundaries. Their survival will depend not only on protecting individual species and habitats, but also on sharing knowledge and building cooperation across borders.

This ecological reality gives the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) its purpose. Launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2023, it became a full-fledged treaty-based intergovernmental international organisation in 2025. Headquartered in India, it provides a common platform for conserving the tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar and puma.

Big cats need adequate prey, secure habitats and space to move. They also need the tolerance and participation of people living alongside them. Protected areas (PAs) are essential, but they are rarely large enough to contain their movement. Animals routinely enter community lands, farms, and infrastructure corridors. As apex predators, they signal the health of forests, grasslands and mountain systems that store carbon, regulate water and support livelihoods. Protecting these can strengthen climate resilience and safeguard ecological assets. India has earned credibility through Project Tiger, the recovery of the Asiatic lion and its experience with leopards, snow leopards and cheetahs. The IBCA enables India to share this experience while learning from others. Latin America offers lessons on jaguar corridors and puma coexistence; Africa brings experience from lion and cheetah landscapes.

The Alliance's proposed Big Cat Dashboard could become the instrument that converts cooperation into action. Today, population estimates, habitat-change maps, mortality data, conflict reports and conservation investments are often scattered across agencies and research projects. A well-designed Big Cat Dashboard could organise this information around four essentials: Population trends, emerging threats, conservation responses and the effectiveness of PAs and wider landscapes. It could warn governments of rising road and rail-induced mortality, retaliatory killing or habitat conversion before these pressures become crises. It could identify transboundary populations, guide the placement of wildlife crossings, reveal gaps in monitoring and help direct finance to landscapes where most needed.

> They also need the tolerance and participation of people living alongside them

Trust is critical. Countries must retain ownership of their data, and sensitive information on animal locations must be protected. The dashboard should accommodate different levels of national capacity. Countries with limited resources should receive training and technology. Indigenous knowledge and the experience of frontline staff must complement technological evidence.

The IBCA should focus on three priorities. First, establish common but flexible standards for monitoring populations, threats and outcomes. Second, build capacity through training, technical partnerships and finance. Third, connect big-cat conservation with infrastructure, climate and development planning so that critical habitats are considered before projects are approved.

If the IBCA can help countries convert knowledge into timely decisions and cooperation into measurable recovery, it will protect more than seven iconic species. It will show that conservation across borders is possible when science, policy and political commitment move together.

The writer is a former chairperson of India's National Biodiversity Authority and former director of the Wildlife Institute of India

Dry for a decade, Bihar hit by a new lethal high: Drugs and addicts

[FROM PAGE 1]

● The data also shows 16,691.81 kg of ganja seized in 2022, rising to 31,915.29 kg in 2025 — nearly double in three years (*see chart*). In fact, the number of "tablets" seized under the NDPS Act illustrates the dramatic uptick: 29,762 pieces in 2022 to 9.29 lakh pieces in the first five months of 2026 alone — from sedatives, opioid painkillers and anti-anxiety drugs procured illegally to counterfeit pills made using chemical powders and industrial machinery.

● The narcotics cell of Bihar Police's Special Task Force (STF), which was formed last April to deal with drug trafficking, seized Rs 52.32 crore worth of drugs and arrested 315 people until October 10, 2026. Of this, Rs 25.58 crore worth of drugs were seized this year.

● State data shows that just 11 juveniles were detained under the NDPS Act in seven years, from 2016 to 2023 — but 50 in 2024 alone, according to most recent data recorded.

Then there's that one figure that captures the human cost. A reply in Parliament, dated March 10 this year, by the Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment states that beneficiaries of de-addiction centres supported by it in Bihar rose from 1,487 in 2022-23 to 29,429 in 2024-25 — a nearly 20-fold rise.

So sprawling is the challenge that the response also needs to go beyond the police station.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Kundan Krishnan, Director General of Bihar Police's Special Branch and Operations, called for a coordinated effort to tackle the growing menace.

"Without community participation to build societal resistance against narcotics, mere police action will not suffice in the present situation. This is the lesson learnt from the Punjab experience. Only a community effort backed by the state government can contain the growing menace of narcotics and psychotropic substance addiction," he said.

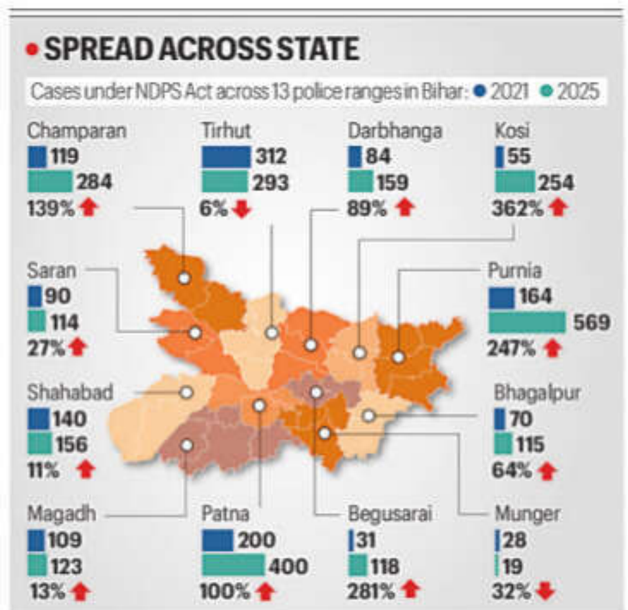
The state government has taken note. While the Special Task Force focuses specifically on organised narcotics trafficking, the government established another standalone branch, Prohibition and State Narcotics Control Bureau, in September 2025. This new bureau merged the Anti Narcotics Task Force (ANTF), which was set up in 2022, with the existing prohibition wing of the police.

A senior official said the situation is expected to improve with the Union Home Ministry's announcement of a campaign under the Centre's flagship Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan with 2029 as the target year. "Top officials are now holding regular review meetings to monitor progress," the official said.

"The real issue is not just the rise in numbers but the changing profile of the patients as well," Dr Rajesh Kumar, head of psychiatry at the Indira Gandhi Institute of Medical Sciences (IGIMS) in Patna, told *The Indian Express*.

"Previously, more of them were dependent on cannabis or other plant-based substances, but that ratio is shifting rapidly towards semi-synthetic and synthetic drugs, with many new patients coming in with heroin dependence," he said.

The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment did not respond to an emailed query from *The Indian Express* on the reason behind the spike in the number of beneficiaries of de-addiction centres supported by it under the Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan in Bihar.



● IN THE POLICE NET — FROM GANJA TO COCAINE

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 (Up to May)
GANJA	16,691.81 kg	9,755.918 kg	12,997.59 kg	31,915.299 kg	21,430.64 kg
CHARAS	179.997 kg	109.154 kg	277.491 kg	378.62 kg	54.448 kg
HEROIN*	62.045 kg	24.634 kg	36.261 kg	65.089 kg	51.929 kg
COCAINE	—	—	1.048 kg	0.03 kg	0.462 kg
MORPHINE	—	—	0.625 kg	2.415 kg	—
DODA	6,728.32 kg	18,667.9 kg	5,235.17 kg	2,377.907 kg	1,758.54 kg
OPIUM	181.05 kg	37.322 kg	10.757 kg	77.255 kg	59.351 kg
CHEMICAL DRUGS/ SYRUP	Bottle: 63,095 Tab: 29,762 Inj: 3,677	Bottle: 2,64,038 Tab: 2,96,966 Inj: 34,473	Bottle: 1,17,405 Tab: 90,150 Inj: 63,208	Bottle: 3,41,277 Tab: 6,43,041 Inj: 31,547	Bottle: 2,91,787 Tab: 9,29,137 Inj: 3,83,066

NOTE: DRUGS SEIZED UNDER NDPS ACT; *ALSO INCLUDES SMACK, BROWN SUGAR. SOURCE: COMPILED FROM BIHAR POLICE DATA

> **"Without community participation to build societal resistance against narcotics, mere police action will not suffice in the present situation. This is the lesson learnt from the Punjab experience. Only a community effort backed by the state government can contain the growing menace of narcotics and psychotropic substance addiction"**
>
> **KUNDAN KRISHNAN,** DIRECTOR GENERAL, SPECIAL BRANCH AND OPERATIONS, BIHAR POLICE

The roots: How a new market grew

It was on April 5, 2016, that Bihar imposed complete prohibition, presented as an effort to curb alcoholism and the social and economic harm tied to it. But as the police cracked down hard on the liquor trade, starting with the seizure of 21.26 lakh litres and 75,225 arrests in the first year alone, a "second, cheaper market" began to take root.

"Illegal liquor can cost Rs 1,000 to 1,200 a bottle, and the intoxication may last only a short while. Some users, once exposed to narcotics, begin to compare: for the same money, or a little more, a much smaller quantity of a drug can keep a person intoxicated far longer, and one session's liquor money can sometimes buy a drugs supply that lasts several days," a senior officer from the state police's narcotics cell said.

Consider this: A 750-ml bottle of an Indian whisky brand, which may retail for around Rs 650-750 in other states, sells for around Rs 1,500 in Bihar's black market. At the same time, the officer said, a packet of adulterated brown sugar, containing a fraction of a gram, can sell for Rs 300-500.

Many police officers and doctors believe the Covid lockdown marked a tipping point of sorts, accelerating a market that was already developing as it saw an unprecedented expansion into rural areas. "As the legal liquor market disappeared and demand for intoxicants did not, plant-based drugs such as ganja and *afeem* first emerged as alternatives in rural areas," a senior doctor in Patna said.

A key factor fuelling this switch was reverse migration, they said. "During the pandemic, daily-wage labourers and factory workers came home from Punjab, Haryana, Delhi-NCR, Mumbai and Gujarat. Some of them had already been exposed to harder substances, synthetic sedatives and semi-synthetic drugs. When they returned, some of those substances, contacts and knowledge came with them," said a senior police officer in Patna.

The spread: Border routes, changing menu

Geography is integral to the spreading narcotics map. Bihar borders Nepal and sits on major road and rail links to the Northeast, where established drug markets and supply routes exist. An officer at the Bihar Police HQ said the state is "naturally a route for certain narcotics, and the concern is that once supply passes through regularly and a void creates demand, some of it begins finding consumers here".

An ANTF officer said ganja, which remains one of the largest components of recorded seizures (*see chart*), arrives through Nepal, Tripura, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh, and part of it passes through Bihar to northern and western markets.

"High-quality *charas* comes mainly from Nepal and is largely moved to other states. Poppy husk reaches Bihar from Nepal and Jharkhand. It is also grown in some pockets of Bihar from where it is supplied to other parts of the state," the officer said. Officers say illegal poppy cultivation has been found in forest areas along the Bihar-Jharkhand border. Police also name Ara, Buxar, Rohtas and parts of Patna as places where this is more visible. "New hotspots are cropping up in Samastipur, Muzaffarpur and Vaishali, especially in the Raghopur region," a narcotics cell officer said.

The sharper change, however, is in drugs not measured in sacks. The use of pills and capsules, medicinal preparations, cough syrup and injection vials have all risen steeply. For instance, state records show, Bihar Police recovered 3,677 pharmaceutical injections in 2022 and 63,208 in 2024 — and 3,83,066 in just the first five months of 2026. "A strip of tablets or a small vial can travel in a pocket or bag without looking unusual, so detection often depends on information arriving first," an investigator said.

Heroin has climbed as well: police recorded 65.08 kg seized all through 2025 and 51.92 kg in the first five months of 2026 alone. Officers say heroin, smack and brown sugar are street names for forms of the same opioid market, and what reaches users is often heavily "cut". "Much of the supply is linked to the Northeast, with Assam figuring in the routes, and some consignments move through East Champaran, Kishanganj, Vaishali and Bhojpur. Parts of the network have now begun to terminate in Bihar," an officer said.

The range: 'Kota' & the 'death triangle'

Within the trade, officers and social workers say, a "new substance" has now begun to appear in Bihar: "kota". "The name appears to have originated from the word 'dose'. In local parlance, addicts and peddlers refer to a drug dose as a 'quota', and over time, the substance itself came to be known among users as 'kota'," a narcotics officer said.

Officers describe "kota" as a form of raw heroin, mainly inhaled with cigarettes. It resembles crumbly mustard seeds, pale or saffron-white, and is kept in soap-box-type containers because pressing damages it. A box typically holds around 10 to 12 grams, which in Bihar is broken into roughly 400 to 500 tiny vials. The boxes come ready-made from Myanmar into the Northeast and move onward by the Silchar (Assam) route, an officer said.

When the trade began to expand, a box cost around Rs 25,000-30,000 and each vial sold for Rs 100-150. As arrests and seizures rose, so did prices, and a box now costs around Rs 50,000 and a vial Rs 300-400. That, officers say, is why it attracts people without the capital normally needed for wholesale trafficking.

The wider geography runs back to the "Death Triangle", the term used to group Myanmar, Laos and Thailand in this context. Once known for opium and heroin, its economy has shifted increasingly to synthetic drugs, particularly methamphetamine or "Yaba" tablets from clandestine laboratories in Myanmar.

"High-grade heroin and methamphetamine enter India through porous stretches of the Mizoram and Manipur borders, as does kota, and traffickers use the Champhai-Aizawl-Silchar corridor to move consignments into Assam. A newer pipeline from Changlang in Arunachal Pradesh to Tinsukia in Assam is believed to bypass intensified checks," a senior officer in the police HQ said.

The pipeline: There's a Northeast connection

Couriers, who travel to Northeastern states, collect the boxes and return by train, are a key link at this juncture, officers say. A typical carrier handles five or six boxes, though police have intercepted as many as 20 at one time.

Women are increasingly part of the movement. Women police personnel have found specially stitched compartments in petticoats and blouses, which a quick frisking would not reveal. "Some women carry children, travel with friends or bring the whole family, so the journey looks ordinary. The quantities are small enough to slip past scanners, there is no metal signature for detectors, and sniffer dogs are of limited use in crowded trains. In such a scenario, we work mostly on experience and advance intelligence," said a woman officer from Muzaffarpur.

Many couriers start on commission or on money from a Bihar distributor, and after two or three successful consignments begin using their own, learn the chain and start recruiting friends. Police estimate that around 80 per cent of those arrested in "kota" cases have links to Vaishali, from where people go to the Northeast as labourers.

Traffickers have also learnt the law. "Some accused ask during interrogation which section has been applied, because they know the NDPS Act's punishment depends on whether the quantity is small, intermediate or commercial," an officer said. Under the Act, for instance, the "small" quantity threshold for ganja is 1 kg and the commercial mark is 20 kg.

Officers say consignments are now also divided among several carriers so that each carries less, as the quantity recovered from an individual can affect the legal outcome, including bail. "Locally, the material moves through direct contacts and through tea shops, paan and cigarette outlets and roadside sellers, in a loose chain rather than one large gang. A courier can become a financier, a financier a supplier, a supplier a recruiter. Some narcotics are altered after they enter Bihar," an STF officer said.

Investigators cite chalk powder, powdered sugar, caffeine powder, malted drinks and even dried animal dung as adulterants. "A person may not receive the same material that left the source, which can be dangerous. For example, diazepam, which is used to make weak heroin seem stronger, is incredibly lethal because it impacts breathing," an investigator said.

A small consolation, officers say, is that Bihar is not yet a major centre of manufacture. But they warn that the network is spreading. Patna, the consumer-dense urban centre, was among the top five districts on the state's NDPS cases list in every year from 2016 to 2025 — it recorded 389 cases in the first five months of 2026, against 372 in all of 2025. The other districts are not far behind (*see chart*).

The future: Young lured by cheap drugs

But more than all of the above, the police are most worried about cheap drugs reaching the economically marginalised, mainly juveniles, a concern social workers dealing with street children in Patna have raised repeatedly.

The closest broad measure of juvenile use is a national survey cited in a 2023 report of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Social Justice and Empowerment. It estimated 99,000 cannabis users among Bihar's 10-17-year-olds, 40,000 opioid users and 29,000 inhalant users, besides 8,000 sedative users.

Dr Kumar, from IGIMS in Patna, said dependence on semi-synthetic and synthetic drugs can set in far faster than what young users expect. "Young people may begin under peer pressure or out of curiosity, without understanding how difficult it can become to stop," he said.

Money, police say, also decides what is used. A young person with Rs 150-200 can afford only small quantities, making cheaper substances easier to access than black-market liquor. According to officers, roadside outlets are the usual points of first contact, where buyers may be offered "something new" for a nominal price. And, they warn, all it takes is a semi-synthetic drug such as kota, taken with a cigarette, to hook a user within a few trial doses.

(Tomorrow: Liquor to drugs, de-addiction centres scramble to cope)

EXPRESS special

Bihar MLC polls: Colleges flag 'fake' entries in Patna Teachers' constituency

Santosh Singh
Patna, October 21

AHEAD OF the key MLC polls, the electoral roll for the Patna Teachers' constituency has come under scrutiny over alleged fake voter entries, mostly originating from private colleges.

Among the complainants is the state's prestigious Patna Science College, which reported that five fake voters were enrolled under its name while three of its genuine faculty members were excluded from the list.

The Patna Teachers constituency comprises 11,719 voters across Patna, Nawada, and Nalanda districts.

Eight seats for Member of Legislative Council (MLC) — four Teachers and four Graduates constituencies — in Bihar will go to polls on October 23.

The alleged issues were flagged by several colleges to the Electoral Registration Office in Patna over the last six months:

Patna Science College: On October 13, the college wrote to Patna's Electoral Registration Office stating that five individuals listed as its teachers on the electoral roll were not associated with the institution.

The principal also requested the Electoral Registration Officer to enrol three genuine teachers as voters. None of the three has been included in the final list.

Patna Science College principal Alka Kumari told *The Indian Express*: "We had duly informed them about the wrong names on the list. The three genuine names we submitted were not added because they said the voters' list had been finalised."



On October 13, Patna Science College wrote to the ERO stating that individuals listed as teachers on the roll were not associated with the institution. RAHUL SHARMA

September 29 was the last date for making corrections in the rolls.

Sant Kabir Mahant Vidyanand Ayurvedic Pharmacy (Fatuha): This private institution was found locked twice during official government inspections. However, it has 49 "teachers" on the electoral roll for the constituency.

Another college in Fatuha with a similar name, Sant Kabir Mahanth Vidyanand College, submitted a written undertaking on August 18 stating that it has 17 teachers, 16 of whom are eligible voters. However, the electoral roll lists 33 teachers as voters from this college.

An official from the Patna registration office said: "On August 19, we wrote to the college principal noting that during inspections by local authorities on July 4 and July 21, the college was found closed. We asked the authorities concerned to take appropriate action against the institution." The official, however, could not explain why all the names from the college were retained on the electoral roll.

ST College of Education (Phulwari Sharif): On August 27, the college wrote to the Electoral Registration Office stating that none of the 32 people enrolled as voters under its name "currently work at the college, nor did they ever work here." All 32 names, though, remain on the final electoral roll.

Jagataran Kuwar Private ITI (Naubatpur): On April 2, the institute declared that all 20 names registered on the electoral roll as its teachers were "invalid" and that none was employed there. The final list reflects no corrections, and all 20 names were retained.

Awadhesh Prasad Mahavidyalaya (Masaurhi): On July 11, the college wrote to the Deputy Registration Office in Patna stating that only one of its teachers was eligible to vote. It declared that a voter list letter issued in its name on July 11 was fake and warranted legal action. The final list, however, features six voters from the college, none of whom are associated with it, while excluding the sole genuine teacher.

To register as a voter for the Bihar Legislative Council (MLC) elections, eligible citizens must apply under their specific constituency category. While Form 18, which is for Graduates constituencies, requires a degree from a recognised university and proof of residence, Form 19, for Teachers' constituencies, requires at least three years of teaching experience at an educational institution not lower in standard than a secondary school. MLC polls use physical ballot papers.

Patna divisional commissioner and electoral registration officer Rajesh Kumar told *The Indian Express*, "The final Teacher Electoral Roll was published on 30.12.25... All complaints/claims/objections received in office were sent to the DM concerned cum AERO for disposal under electoral registration rules. One writ petition filed in Patna High Court was disposed of with a direction to pass a reasoned order on the petition. All claims and objections have been disposed of by all DM cum AERO (Assistant Electoral Registration Officer) concerned after due verification with a copy of the checklist signed by SDO (sub divisional officer). So, the verification is based on a written report of SDOs concerned."

He pointed out that the colleges raised the matter after the electoral roll was already "frozen".

Another officer, however, said authorities in Patna should have prepared a check list well in advance like some other districts to avoid this issue.

SC stays CMRL probe against Pinarayi for a week, ex-CM can challenge FIR order

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

THE SUPREME Court on Wednesday set aside a Kerala High Court Division Bench order which rejected a plea by former chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter Veena, and son-in-law Mohammad Riyas seeking permission to appeal against a single-judge order directing registration of an FIR against them in the CMRL-Exalogic case.

A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also stayed the investigation in the FIR for seven days so that Vijayan and others could file an appeal against the October 9 single-bench order.

The SC noted that the FIR was registered on an HC order, and not based on Enforcement Directorate (ED) communication, and therefore could be challenged by the accused. The ED is probing allegations that Veena's firm, Exalogic Solutions, received illegal payments from Kochi-based Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited (CMRL) when the CPI(M) was in power in Keralam. The bench disagreed with the contention by the state that an ED communication under Section 66(2) of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) mandates registration of an FIR by the State under the terms of the judgment in Vijay Madanlal Choudhary vs Union of India, leaving the accused with no right of hearing at the FIR-registration stage.

"Our problem, you know, we read judgments like statutes. Vijay Madanlal Choudhary has been now conflated to become a mandate on the state... when 66(2) just says it will be intimation to the agency as per law. Now what is as per law is for the agency to decide. Nor does Choudhary address that issue nor is the PMLA being a super administrator, mandating everything everywhere," Justice Bagchi said orally.

In its order, the SC said, "We are unable to agree to such contention advanced before us. This is not a case where on receipt of communication under Section 66(2) PMLA, the State had registered a case on its own. On the contrary, the registration of FIR and commencement of investigation was pursuant to a judicial order passed by the constitutional court."

"While passing such order, the single judge had inter alia observed that the materials in the communication by the ED disclosed a cognisable offence and therefore it was obligatory for the State to register an FIR. If the petitioners are not permitted to assail such finding of fact in the appellate proceeding, the same shall stare at their face in an independent proceeding assailing the FIR as per law," the bench added. The bench said that, unlike Section 156(3) of the Criminal Procedure Code, Section 175(4) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) requires the involvement of a public servant or his superior "in the process of taking a decision to issue direction for registration of FIR". "We have referred to Section 175(4) BNSS not in reference to the merits of the case before us, but to elucidate the expansive jurisdiction envisaged in the new Code with regard to a potential accused prior to registration of FIR and nothing more," the bench added.

"We also...observe that the single judge has not only directed registration of the FIR, which is the mandate in Vijay Madanlal Choudhary but also commencement of the investigation and submission of final report. Commencement of investigation and taking the same to its logical conclusion under the Prevention of Corruption Act would require due compliance of other statutory requirements under the special law...These facts clearly make out a prima facie case of locus for the petitioners to seek leave to appeal against the impugned judgment," the Supreme Court further said.

The Supreme Court set aside the High Court order and permitted the petitioners to pursue the appeal before a division bench. "We make it clear that our observations are limited to the issue at hand— that is the locus of the petitioners to prefer the appeal and not an expression or opinion on merits...To enable them to file the appeal, we direct that the investigation in the FIR shall remain stayed for 7 days. This, however, shall not be an opinion on the interim relief which the division bench will be entitled to fashion independently in accordance with law," it added.

Earlier, addressing the arguments by senior Advocate Siddharth Luthra for Vijayan, Justice Mohana said the HC could have considered granting leave to appeal against the HC order. Justice Bagchi commented that it needs to be decided whether 66(2) is a mandate to register FIR.

2 days after killing of 3 Meitei men, protesters clash with the police in Manipur

Press Trust of India
Imphal, October 21

A LARGE number of protesters demonstrating against the recent killing of three Meitei men in Manipur clashed with the police outside a sports complex in Imphal on Wednesday when Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh was attending an event inside, an officer said.

Militants ambushed 14 Meitei men, killing three of them, when they were collecting firewood in Sunurok hills in Kangpokpi district on October 19.

Women protesters attempted to storm the Khuman Lampak Sports Complex, where the CM and state Home Minister Govindas Konthoujam were attending the first Manipur Poomsae Taekwondo Championship. Delegates from South Korea were participating in the event.

The protesters asserted that the CM and Home Minister cannot attend a sports event when innocent people were being killed. Police fired several rounds of tear gas shells to disperse the demonstrators, leading to minor injuries to three people. At Khabeisoi in Imphal East district, protesters burnt effigies of Rajya Sabha MP A Sharda Devi and Konthoujam in another demonstration against the killings.

Several Meira Paibi (woman activists) also gathered at the residence of Sharda Devi at Brahmapur in Imphal East district to question her "silence" on the killings. They later left the place after Devi assured them, through a video call, that their demands would be conveyed to the government.

Finance influencer dies in Chennai, family claims cyberbullying

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 21

A FINANCIAL consultant and influencer was found dead near Muttukadu, outside Chennai Monday night.

V Harish from Puducherry ran 'Finance with Harish' and had built an audience of more than a million people with social media content on finance and investments over five years.

In September, his established accounts were blocked. A new channel he launched was also taken down, according to the police.

Police are investigating his death by suicide and his family's allegations that another influencer subjected him to sustained online harassment. He had faced public accusations that he offered financial advice and investment-related services without required registration.

His father, J Vinayagam, alleged in a police complaint that accusations formed part of a campaign of cyberbullying, defamatory posts and threats that caused his son severe mental distress. The complaint named Jason Samuel, another social media influencer, who had published videos and posts on October 18 allegedly accusing Harish of misleading the public.

Vinayagam said, before his death, Harish recorded a video blaming Samuel for his decision saying Samuel had threatened to have his social media accounts blocked and prevent him from opening new ones.

Samuel denied the allegations in a social media post. He said he had questioned Harish's credentials and his authorisation to provide financial advice.

No suicide note was recovered. Harish's body was taken to Chengalpattu Government Hospital for an autopsy.

Months after two dead at Pune MIDC plant, CEO held

Pune: Pimpri-Chinchwad police have arrested Harsha Kadam, CEO and managing director of engineering company Schaeffler India, months after two workers died of asphyxia and three others fell ill following a carbon dioxide leak at the company's plant in the Talegaon MIDC industrial cluster in June.

Kadam (60) is the eighth person to be arrested in the case, police said. Senior Inspector Vijayanand Patil of Talegaon MIDC police station confirmed Kadam was arrested on Tuesday.

According to officials the leak occurred at Schaeffler India Ltd's premises on June 9, when staff from Usha Fire Safety Equipment Pvt Ltd, Fernotech Engineers Pvt Ltd and company personnel, were carrying out maintenance work on fire safety cylinders. ENS

Attack on Tiger Shroff: 2 women took pistol from Delhi, finds probe

Pragynesh & Manish Sahu
New Delhi, Lucknow, Oct 21

RADHA AND her friend Babita worked at showrooms in Haryana's Sonipat before taking a train to Mumbai last week, allegedly carrying a bag containing a pistol to be handed over to a "boy". Police suspect this gun, which was allegedly handed over on Saturday, was used in the firing at Bollywood actor Tiger Shroff's car on Sunday evening.

On Tuesday, the Delhi Police Special Cell (New Delhi Range) arrested Radha (23) and Babita (22), along with Kunal (21) and Sumit (19), in connection with a weapon supply module linked to the firing. Radha and Babita were arrested at New Delhi Railway Station, and Kunal and Sumit in Sonipat, an officer said.

In Mumbai, meanwhile, the two alleged shooters, Phool Singh (18) and Rehan Rahisuddin (18); and Hrithik Mahto (22), who allegedly rode the bike on which they fled the scene, were remanded Wednesday by a local court in police custody until October 31. The Mumbai Police also arrested Ankit, from Sonipat in connection with the attack. A Sonipat Police officer said Mumbai Police had informed them of the arrest, and that Haryana Police helped identify the accused's residence. A local court granted Mumbai Police Ankit's custody on a three-day transit remand.

According to a Delhi Police officer, Radha moved to Sonipat a few years ago from Sitapur in UP, after getting married. Around the same time, Babita arrived in Sonipat from UP's Azamgarh, the officer said, adding that both lived in the Kharkhoda area and "developed a friendship".

"Radha's husband worked in one of the factories in Sonipat. She took up a security guard's job at a showroom," said the officer. Babita found work at another showroom as a receptionist-cum-guard, working a 12-hour shift to send money to her parents, the officer said.

According to police, Radha came in touch with Kunal, an alleged associate of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, two months ago. "Kunal lived nearby. He met Radha in August after getting out of jail. He allegedly told her that he was now working for Lawrence Bishnoi's main man Anil Pandit," said an officer. US-based Pandit had claimed responsibility for the firing at Shroff in a purported audio clip in which he indicated that it was linked to the Lawrence Bishnoi gang.

Kunal, police said, was introduced to Pandit by a friend and allegedly began communicating with him through an encrypted messaging application. On Pandit's directions, Kunal allegedly collected a pistol and 20 rounds of ammunition from Amritsar, the officer said.

Police said Kunal disclosed his activities to Radha and "persuaded her" to travel to Mumbai with the weapon. Kunal allegedly told her that all she had to do was hand it over to a "boy" and return, promising her Rs 12,000 for the job, said a police officer."Radha told him that she won't be able to do it alone and



The four accused were arrested by the Delhi Police Tuesday.

roped in her friend, Babita. The duo were promised the same amount of money and a part of it was paid," said the officer.

On October 15, according to police, Kunal took Radha and Babita to New Delhi Railway Station, with the pistol in Radha's bag. During the journey, Kunal allegedly remained in contact with them, relaying instructions from Pandit, the officer said.

"The two women reached Dadar in Mumbai on October 17 and checked into a hotel. Around 11 am, a boy collected the bag from Radha near the hotel," the officer said.

On October 18, Radha and Babita left for Delhi aboard the Dadar-Haridwar Express, the officer said. On the same day, around 7 pm, five rounds were fired at Shroff's car in Juhu.

Following the incident, police said, Pandit allegedly contacted Kunal and told him that the three men involved in the shooting were stranded in Mumbai, asking him to arrange their escape. The three were arrested in Kota (Rajasthan) on Monday.

In the villages of the two women from UP, the news has left residents "astonished".

"Since morning, Babita has been the only topic of discussion. She had left her home in this village to find work in Sonipat," said Atul Rai, the head of Kothiyar, around 25 km from the Azamgarh district headquarters.

Rai said a police team visited the village on Wednesday morning and recorded statements of Babita's family members, including her father, Ram Jatan, a farmer. Babita had no known criminal record before her name surfaced in the case, he said.

According to villagers, Babita moved to Sonipat two years ago after relatives working there told her that packaging jobs offered a decent monthly income. The youngest of three sisters, she last visited Kothiyar in June to attend a wedding. Both her elder sisters are married, while her two brothers work in other states.

In Sitapur's Nahwaiya village, Radha's arrest has provoked similar disbelief.

Former village head Naresh Chandra Mishra said Radha married local resident Sunil Kumar in 2016. They have a son. While Delhi Police said Radha was with her husband in Sonipat, Mishra said she had left him earlier following a family dispute. Radha's father Prakash works locally, Mishra said.

A few years later, Radha left the village in search of employment. Residents were told that she had moved to Delhi, where she was working in a private job. She has three brothers and a sister. "Her family maintains that she has been falsely implicated in the case," Mishra said.

Radha last visited Nahwaiya in April to attend a family function. Police said she has no criminal background.

(WITH ENS IN MUMBAI, CHANDIGARH)



Union Home Minister Amit Shah pays homage at the National Police Memorial in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

Ensure India is free of drugs by Dec 2029: Shah to police forces

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 21

REITERATING THAT narcotics threaten future generations and provide financial support to organisations with anti-national intentions, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Wednesday called on police forces across the country to ensure the drug menace is eliminated by 2029 end.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has set a deadline of December 31, 2029, to make India drug-free. Shah described the target as a major national priority. "Drug abuse and trafficking undermine the future of coming generations, place an unnecessary burden on the economy and often provide financial support to organisations with anti-national intentions," he said, while paying homage to police martyrs at the National Police Memorial in Delhi on Police Commemoration Day (October 21).

Shah also flagged off a motorcycle rally themed 'Fight Against Drugs' involving about 90 police riders from several states and union territories, Central Armed Police Forces and other central police organisations.

2026 is an extremely significant year for the Indian police, Shah pointed out, adding that the country has eliminated decades of naxalism by March 31, 2026. He credited Chhattisgarh Police, the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF), the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) and CoBRA for their role in combating insurgency.

More than 3,600 security personnel and approximately 13,700 civilians had been killed in violence associated with Naxalism between 1981 and March 2026, the minister said.

"There are numerous examples across the country of police personnel demonstrating extraordinary patience, restraint, discipline, courage and dedication, thereby strengthening the nation's internal security," Shah said.

Police personnel constitute both the first and the last line of defence for internal security, Shah asserted, expressing special gratitude to all personnel of the CAPF deployed along borders and entrusted with security responsibilities.

Police Commemoration Day is observed annually on October 21 to honour the 10 CRPF personnel killed in a 1959 ambush by Chinese troops at Hot Springs, Ladakh, as well as all police personnel who sacrificed their lives in the line of duty.

EXPRESS special

ASI begins fresh probe at Kashipur — a site believed to have Mahabharata link

Divya A
New Delhi, October 21

A 90-ACRE mound near Uttarakhand's Rudrapur is the Archaeological Survey of India's latest subject of probe owing to its connection with the Mahabharata as well as Chinese scholar Xuanzang. The excavation in Kashipur started this week and is expected to go on until March, ASI officials said.

According to mythology and local legend, this site was the training ground and residence of sage Dronacharya from the Mahabharata, and the Pandavas are said to have built the Drona Sagar Lake as '*guru dakshina*' (an offering) to him, for imparting battle skills to them.

Excavations at Kashipur – also identified as Govisana by Xuanzang who had visited the place in the 6th century – have been conducted by ASI across multiple phases since 1939, uncovering Gupta-to-early-medieval temple complexes, the 90-acre mound near Drona Sagar and rich multi-period artifacts.

"While excavations have been conducted here in the preceding decades also, the idea this time is to find scientific evidence of objects retrieved here earlier, and also dig deeper to uncover proper cultural sequencing," Mohan Joshi, Superintending Archaeologist of ASI's Dehradun circle, tells The Indian Express.

As per ASI, Kashipur is identified by Alexander Cunningham with Kiu-pi-shwang-na (or Govisana) of Xuanzang. Cunningham, a British Army engineer who founded and served as the first Director-General of the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), traced the remains of a large structure at Bhim-Gaja, the highest place at the site. The ASI conducted excavations here in the years 1939-40, 1965-66 and 1970-71 in order to reveal the details of the structure traced by Cunningham.

Excavations revealed a substantial part of the plan of the temple built in three different phases. Initially, the temple appears to have started as a soil-brick-built high platform surmounted possibly by a sanctum during the Gupta period, but later, two encircling walls probably in the 6th-7th century AD, were laid around it.



As per ASI, Alexander Cunningham with Kiu-pi-shwang-na of Xuanzang identified Kashipur

Since the excavation was aimed at obtaining the detailed plan of the temple, no attempt was made to reveal the complete cultural sequence of the site. However, as per ASI records, pottery collected from the site revealed that it remained under occupation from the Painted Grey Ware period to the early medieval period.

This Painted Grey Ware culture is associated with early advanced civilisations of northern India, especially the Mahabharata era. In the 1950s, noted archaeologist and ASI chief B B Lal excavated Hastinapur (near Meerut), where he famously discovered Painted Grey Ware, and associated this with the sites and chronology of the Mahabharata.

Furthermore, pottery dating back to the Kushan, Gupta, and Medieval periods has also been recovered at this site, implying that the region remained continuously inhabited for thousands of years, with human activity persisting without interruption.

However, the recent excavations by ASI's Dehradun Circle have unearthed brick structures and a circular formation, generating renewed interest in the region's archaeological narrative, officials say.

Joshi adds, "Once the excavations for this season are complete, we will assess the need to extend it further." In later stages, the site can be developed for both tourism and research purposes.

Missionary school principal attacked by masked men inside office in Jharkhand

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, October 21

THE PRINCIPAL of a missionary school in Jharkhand's Khunti district was allegedly attacked by three masked men on Tuesday night and found unconscious the next morning with serious head injuries, a church official said.

Father Benedict Barla alias Benny, principal of St Michael School, was found unconscious and bleeding on school premises on Wednesday morning.

Bisu Benjamin, Vicar General of the Khunti Diocese, told *The Indian Express,* "From the CCTV footage, it appears that three people wearing masks entered on a bike. It seems they may have entered the office and attacked the principal when he came across them. They appear to have used whatever they could find there to hit him".

Barla was taken to Khunti Sadar Hospital for initial treatment and later shifted to Pulse Hospital in Ranchi.

Benjamin said the school was closed on Tuesday for a festival and the person who usually stays with Barla had left to attend his mother's funeral."The attackers may have known Barla was alone," Benjamin said,"We do not want to speculate about who could be behind this...We do not want rumours to spread and create divisions in society" .

Khunti Superintendent of Police Rishav Garg said police received the attack's information around 9 am on Wednesday. Asked about the weapon used, the SP said the police did not yet have clear information. While Khunti MP and other people visited the hospital on Wednesday, Adivasi groups and Christian organisations took to the streets to protest.

• FOUR TIMES IN FOUR YEARS, RAJESH T AND THARA'S CHILDREN WERE TAKEN AWAY BY OFFICIALS OVER 'NEGLECT', BUT RETURNED DUE TO PRESSURE FROM PARENTS AND CONSTRAINTS OF LAW

A toddler's hunger death in Keralam, and family's welfare file open since 2022

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, Oct 21

BY THE time Rahul, 2, was brought to government hospital at Harippad in Alappuzha on October 18, he had been hungry for hours. The doctors said he had died of "starvation-induced anaemia". The postmortem said his stomach was "empty".

Keralam's expansive social welfare umbrella that, at different times of his short life, brushed against Rahul included the ICDS (Integrated Child Development Services), the panchayat, the Juvenile Justice Committee, the District Child Welfare Committee (CWC) and the Health Department. However, Rahul, who at death was 7 kg, almost half the normal weight of a toddler his age, fell through the loopholes.

The Keralam Women and Child Welfare Department has announced now that Rahul's parents Rajesh T, an autorickshaw driver, and Thara would lose custody of their remaining five children, the eldest 10 and the youngest a newborn, delivered the day before Rahul's death. One of Rahul's siblings died two years ago, in circumstances not much different from him — making it seven children born to Thara in 10 years, since she got married at the age of 19.

With the children now in different homes and Thara to be housed at a shelter with the newborn, Rajesh denies that he and his wife were guilty of neglect. "We did not deny food to the children. I have financial issues, but I ensured they were well-fed. Rahul had some cardiac issues and he died of milk aspiration. He was fine until previous night," he said, adding: "An astrologer had told there would be a death at home."

ICDS District Programme Officer, Maya Panicker, said that Rahul's four eldest siblings, all girls, are now at a care home. "The eldest has not been to school this entire academic year. She and her 7-year-old sister will receive special classes at the care centre for this year. The younger girls, 5 and 3, will be enrolled in anganwadis, and Thara and baby will be shifted to state-run women's shelter Mahila Mandiram."

A source said that the 10- and 7-year-old are also underweight. The house they lived in, Rajesh's family home, was found to be dilapidated and squalid, having not seen repairs in years as it was a disputed property.

A neighbour, Bindu, told *The Indian Express:* "The children were often not given any food. The 10-year-old daughter would do most of the chores, including getting water from a well, and looking after her younger siblings."

Keralam's social welfare network for women and children is considered the best among all states, with statistics such as 99.9% deliveries in institutions, infant mortality rate of 5, immunisation coverage of 95%, and stunting percentage at 20% among children.

In Rahul's case too, officials said, there were repeated interventions since at least 2022, after complaints of neglect, but the parents kept pressuring that the children be handed back. They also managed to escape the radar, officials said, by frequently moving houses.



Women and Child Development Minister Bindhu Krishna (second from right) at Rajesh T and Thara's village in Karthikappally

Over the years, they were under the care of three different anganwadis in Alappuzha, who tracked them and supplied provisions for them and their pregnant mother. Officials believe the provisions did not reach the children in adequate amounts.

In 2022, after finding that the children, who numbered four at the time, were not being looked after, the ICDS authorities and the CWC shifted them to a state-run care home. However, Rajesh approached the CWC seeking their return, and officials said they had no option but to give them back. "Under the juvenile justice law, a child should be returned to his / her parents if they are alive. This is a loophole which leaves children vulnerable if parents are irresponsible," an official said.

In 2024, as per an ICDS report which has now emerged, a complaint was received from neighbours that a 3-year-old and an 18-month-old had been left on their own at home by the couple. After the panchayat stepped in, the eldest girls, then 8 and 5, were moved into a children's home, while the younger children were placed in government-run Shishu Vihar, meant for vulnerable toddlers.

The 8- and 5-year-old attended school while they were at the shelter for about 18 months. But after the school broke for vacation, the parents sought their custody. An ICDS officer said the children did not come back after the vacation.

Rajesh and Thara did not get any documents made for the children either, including Aadhaar, which complicated their access to public services, sources said.

In the beginning of 2026, the family moved back to Karthikappally. Officials said their precarious situation was immediately apparent to local panchayat officials.

Finally, in August, the children were shifted to Gandhi Bhavan, a care facility at Pathanapuram in Kollam. However, Thara soon arrived there, climbed onto the terrace and threatened to jump off if the children were not handed to her – a tactic, officials said, she had tried before. Officials were careful not to agitate her as she was pregnant, and gave in.

Panchayat president Ullasan P said that early this month, a team of officials, ASHA workers and panchayat members again went to the couple asking them to hand over the children to a child protection panel. "Thara again threatened to end her life. We even got a new house sanctioned for the family under the state government's LIFE Mission for the homeless," Ullasan said.

On October 18, one of the first to discover Rahul unresponsive was Bindu. "The previous day, Rajesh and the children had been at hospital for Thara's delivery. They returned at night, and on Sunday morning, Rajesh called me up saying Rahul was not waking up. I rushed to their house and found the baby motionless," the neighbour said.

Women and Child Development Minister Bindhu Krishna, who visited Rajesh and Thara's four children at the care centre Tuesday, told the media that her department would identify other children living in similar circumstances and ensure they got help.

She also promised "a criminal case" against Rajesh, and a probe separately into their other child who died. "There will be strong action against parents who evade their responsibility," Krishna said.

RUSSIA FREES RETIRED U.S. TEACHER AS A GESTURE OF GOODWILL

Putin agrees to resume 3-way peace talks with Ukraine, US

Kremlin says talks at technical level could take place in Abu Dhabi in Nov

Reuters
St Petersburg, October 21



Russian President Vladimir Putin (left) with US special envoy Steve Witkoff (second right) at the Konstantin Palace in Strelnya, St Petersburg, on Wednesday. AP

RUSSIAN PRESIDENT Vladimir Putin has agreed to resume US-mediated peace talks with Ukraine as soon as next month, the Kremlin said on Wednesday, after Putin met US envoy Steve Witkoff in Washington's latest push to stop Europe's bloodiest conflict since World War Two.

The negotiations in a grand imperial palace in St Petersburg, the ninth time that Witkoff has met Putin in person, began with a goodwill gesture from Russia - the release of Stephen Hubbard, a retired US school teacher held in Russia whom US President Trump had asked the Kremlin chief to release.

Wednesday's encounter unfolded amid concerns in Kyiv and among its allies that the US is backing away from Ukraine, at times holding back real-time intelligence on Russian attacks and hobbling Ukraine's military communications.

The latest talks also came more than two years since Trump promised in his successful election campaign to end the Ukraine war within 24 hours.

The Kremlin said the new 3-way peace talks, which would be at a technical level, could take place in Abu Dhabi and would be focused on how to guarantee the security of Ukraine and Russia once the war ended. They could begin sometime on or after November 10, it said.

The Kremlin was less upbeat, however, about the outcome of talks Witkoff had held a day earlier in Oslo with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, the leaders of Finland and Norway, and European and NATO representatives. Witkoff told Putin the talks had been characterised by "some degree of momentum" and a US official said Ukraine had brought new ideas and proposals.

"These nuances, so to speak, do not entirely satisfy us," Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov told reporters after the St Petersburg meeting, which lasted nearly three hours.

Ukraine and Russia remain far apart when it comes to the terms of any possible peace deal, though Trump has recently intensified pressure on Ukraine to strike some kind of a deal. He said on Tuesday it was time for Ukraine to end the war or face "a very bad thing."

Putin also used Wednesday's talks to offer to help Trump deal with Iran, saying Russia had a decades-long relationship with Tehran which it has repeatedly offered to leverage to address US concerns about Iran's nuclear programme. Putin told Witkoff it was possible and necessary to get a deal with Tehran, the Kremlin said.

Russia could also supply vast quantities of fertiliser to the US to help farmers, the Russian president told Witkoff.

A potential meeting in China next month with Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping was also discussed. The Kremlin said Beijing was already preparing what it said would be the first meeting of its kind in history.

Who is Stephen Hubbard?



- A retired US teacher Hubbard, 74, who grew up in Michigan and served in the US Air Force and National Guard.
- He earned a Master's degree in English and taught the language in Japan for 25 years before moving to Cyprus.
- Moved to eastern Ukraine In 2014, Hubbard settled in Izyum region with a Ukrainian partner.
- Russian state media said he was detained in April 2022, after Russia captured Izyum region.
- A Moscow court convicted Hubbard in October 2024 after a closed trial, sentencing him to six years and 10 months in prison.
- Russian prosecutors said Hubbard joined a Ukrainian territorial defence unit. His lawyer said Hubbard denied the allegations.
- The US designated Hubbard as wrongfully detained in January 2025. The State Department said Russia had refused US officials consular access.

REUTERS

PROTESTS RAGE ON ACROSS EUROPE



PROTESTERS REACT as police spray water from a cannon after they try to block the police advance during an anti-government student demonstration in Tirana, Albania on Wednesday. Clashes continued for an eighth day amid demands over education and corruption. REUTERS

Macron criticises Trump and others for linking Muslim migrants with riots

Associated Press
Paris, October 21

FRENCH PRESIDENT Emmanuel Macron on Wednesday blamed "foreign leaders," including those "on the other side of the Atlantic," for trying to exploit France's tense social climate for their own political agenda.

Protests over soaring living costs have led to widespread rioting and looting. US President Donald Trump has used the violence to rally his political supporters, making unsubstantiated claims that Muslim migrants are responsible for the unrest.

Trump has urged Macron to "close your borders and take control before it is too late!"

Macron responded by saying there "has been foreign manipulation of information in the aftermath" of the looting in Paris and other French cities last weekend. "And that has led to comments that are as unacceptable as they are stupid, from many people, including foreign leaders," he said.

Asked by a reporter if he was referring to Trump, Macron replied: "Among others."

Macron added: "We've seen AI-generated images depicting scenes that never actually happened in France. We've had people claiming that we were invaded by hordes of migrants and Islamists, which is completely false." He did not specify which AI-generated images he was referring to, nor how he knew the content was false.

> **"There has been foreign manipulation of information in the aftermath... that has led to comments that are as unacceptable as they are stupid, from many people, including foreign leaders"**
>
> **EMMANUEL MACRON**, FRENCH PRESIDENT

"The fact is, all the people who are speaking ill of our country right now are people who don't love our country," Macron said. "So those people really bother me."

"When I see leaders who are in middle of election campaigns...who sometimes naively repeat AI-generated content or spread narratives that certain circles are clearly trying to promote about what happened in France — they're using our country for their own political campaigns," said Macron.

Students and teachers take to Athens streets over rising costs

Associated Press
Athens, October 21

THOUSANDS OF students and teachers marched through the streets of the Greek capital of Athens Wednesday, calling for affordable student housing and more state investment in education, as protests that have swept Europe spread further.

Similar protests were being held in several cities in Greece, including Thessaloniki in the north and the city of Patras.

The rising cost of living, including increased fuel costs, and anger over the state of schools and lack of affordable housing for students have been fuelling protests across Europe.

Engineering student Panagiotis Moschonas, 20, criticised the conservative government for not taking any measures to help students cope with the high cost of living. "It says it is allegedly helping students, with a rent subsidy of 120 euros ($135) per month. That isn't even enough for half a rent, and it's also given at the end of the year."

Teachers declared a strike for Wednesday, although some schools were open.

"Today we are striking because this situation can't continue for our families, with the high costs, with us struggling to make it to the end of the month, with the situation in schools which is deteriorating exponentially year after year," said teacher Ioannis Rompas.

Egypt to defend Saudi, but rules out strikes on Yemen

Reuters
October 21



Egyptian President Abdel Fattah al-Sisi. Reuters

EGYPTIAN PRESIDENT Abdel Fattah al-Sisi said Egypt's military support for Saudi Arabia would be limited to defending the kingdom's territory and borders and would not include an attack on Yemen, the presidency said on Wednesday, as the Iran-allied Houthis intensify attacks on the kingdom.

Sisi's comments came as Egyptian Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty and intelligence chief Hassan Rashad met Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman in Riyadh, Saudi state news agency *SPA* said.

Abdelatty delivered a written message from Sisi to King Salman, and the two sides discussed bilateral ties and regional developments, SPA said.

Any Egyptian military backing for Saudi Arabia could mark a significant escalation in the broader Middle East conflict, which has threatened global energy supplies and pushed oil prices higher since the US and Israel attacked Iran in February.

Egypt would also defend the territory of any other Arab country if asked, Sisi said, but its military effort would not extend beyond Egyptian territory or that of an Arab state whose security and stability Cairo was seeking to protect.

On Monday, Egypt's parliament delayed until October 26 a vote on authorizing the armed forces to support Saudi Arabia if requested, lawmakers said.

Egypt and Saudi Arabia are close strategic and economic partners. Saudi Arabia and other Gulf states, including the United Arab Emirates, provided Egypt with billions of dollars in aid, central bank deposits and investments after the 2013 military overthrow of Islamist President Mohamed Mursi. Sisi became president a year later.

Egypt, a regional military power, previously joined the Saudi-led coalition that intervened in Yemen in 2015 in support of the government against the Houthis.

Khamenei meets Ghalibaf, reviews status of conflict

Tehran: Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei has met parliament speaker Mohammed Bagher Ghalibaf and reviewed developments in the US-Israeli war, state broadcaster *IRIB* reported Wednesday.

Khamenei, who senior sources have said suffered facial disfigurement and injuries in an airstrike, has not been seen since he was appointed supreme leader. REUTERS

Over 300,000 visas revoked: US State Dept

Washington: President Donald Trump's administration has revoked over 300,000 US visas during his second term, the State Department said Tuesday as the federal government continues its sweeping immigration crackdown.

The number showed an acceleration in the pace of visa revocations in recent weeks. In announcing latest number on X, State Department spokesman Tommy Pigott said the Trump administration "has revoked more visas at a faster pace than any administration in history."

He said the administration had "zero tolerance for foreigners on visas who break law, commit fraud, or undermine national security." REUTERS

Turkey, Qatar, Indonesia and Pak sign defence pact

Reuters
Ankara, October 21

TURKEY, QATAR, Pakistan, and Indonesia signed an agreement on Wednesday to boost defence cooperation and strengthen defensive capabilities, the Turkish Defence Ministry said. In a statement, the ministry said the countries signed the "Badr Memorandum of Understanding" in Doha as a sign of their desire to further deepen cooperation and develop partnerships.

"The agreement holds substantial economic importance," it said, adding the accord sought to foster cooperation in military production, boost military capabilities, and help collaboration in technical military training, research and development.

"By leveraging the unique military production capabilities of each country, the initiative will facilitate cooperation and integration, enhance defense industrial capacities, and enable the fulfillment of the needs of allied and friendly nations," it added.

Turkey, which has NATO's second-largest army and a robust defence industry, has been helping Gulf nations, including Qatar, where it has a military base, bolster their defences amid the Iran war.

In August, it signed a mutual defence pact with nuclear-armed Pakistan and Saudi Arabia, under which an attack on one party constitutes an attack on all.

11 dead, 30 hurt as bus overturns in Pak's Punjab

Lahore: At least 11 passengers were killed, and over 30 others sustained injuries when a speeding bus hit a divider and overturned in Pakistan's Punjab province on Wednesday, an official said.

The bus was travelling from Karachi to Punjab's Dera Ghazi Khan district when the accident occurred in Rajanpur, about 500 kilometres from Lahore.

A spokesperson for Pakistan's national emergency response service Rescue 1122 said the accident occurred on a section of the highway where construction work was underway.

The spokesperson, citing witnesses, said overspeeding was believed to have caused the accident. PTI

Dhaka yet to get Saudi reply on execution of its 2 citizens

Reuters
Dhaka, October 21

SAUDI ARABIA has not yet responded to Dhaka's queries about the execution of two Bangladeshi nationals, which was carried out without notifying Bangladeshi authorities, foreign ministry spokesperson Shahidul Karim said on Tuesday.

State Minister for Foreign Affairs Shama Obaed Islam said earlier this week that Dhaka has sought clarification on the circumstances of the executions, which were carried out on October 14

The government has asked for copies of the court verdicts, details about the offenses and an explanation of why Bangladesh's diplomatic mission was not informed, she added.

The Saudi embassy in Dhaka did not immediately respond to a request for comment

Saudi Arabia's interior ministry said the two men were executed after being convicted for committing indecent acts inside a mosque in the holy city of Makkah, Saudi media reported

Islam said the government would decide on next steps after receiving the case details and documents and discussing the matter with Saudi authorities.

Saudi Arabia is Bangladesh's largest overseas labour market and home to an estimated 3.5 million Bangladeshi workers who send home major remittances, making migrant welfare a key bilateral issue.

BRIEFLY

AUSTRALIA

Lawmaker loses both legs in vehicle attack as suspect appears in court



Helen Haines, an independent member of the lower house. FILE

AUSTRALIAN LAWMAKER Helen Haines has had both legs amputated after being rammed by a car outside her electoral office, her husband said on Wednesday, as the man accused of the attack appeared in court. Doctors amputated Haines' left leg after the alleged attacker struck her twice with his car in Wangaratta, northeast of Melbourne, on Monday, Phil Haines said. They worked for days to save her right leg but were ultimately unsuccessful, he told a press conference in Melbourne. Brendan Nugent, a 43-year-old resident of town of Tarrawingee within Haines' electorate, was charged with three offences: dangerous driving causing serious injury, intentionally causing serious injury, and causing harm to a public official. REUTERS

LIBYA

Masked men try to storm financial oversight body

MASKED MEN in military uniform tried to storm the headquarters of Libya's financial oversight agency on Wednesday, in what the country's UN mission called an "unacceptable" attempt to install a senior employee by force. Footage posted on social media showed a group of men in beige fatigues and hats at the gate of the Tripoli offices of the Audit Bureau, which is charged with safeguarding public funds. It was not clear who was behind the attempt to storm the building and the Audit Bureau made no immediate comment. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Granddaughter of assassinated RFK dies at 42

KYLE FRANCIS Kennedy, the granddaughter of assassinated presidential candidate Robert F. Kennedy and his wife Ethel Kennedy, has died. She was 42. An advocate for education reform and disability rights, Kennedy lived most of her life in Massachusetts. She died on Sept. 21, according to the town clerk in Westwood, Massachusetts, where she lived, and an obituary published by a funeral home. A cause of death wasn't immediately announced. She was the niece of US Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F Kennedy Jr. AP

EUROPEAN AND ASIAN CYBER AGENCIES URGE USERS TO UPDATE OR TAKE SITES OFFLINE IMMEDIATELY TILL A PATCH IS APPLIED

Govt sites go dark after AI-discovered flaw sparks security scramble

Reuters
October 21

GOVERNMENT WEBSITES in Europe and elsewhere went offline on Wednesday after the disclosure of critical vulnerabilities in a widely used programming language sent website operators around the world scrambling to protect their systems.

Developers of PHP programming language Wednesday released urgent new fixes to vulnerabilities that had quietly been lurking in their software for years until they were uncovered using AI, saying all users were "encouraged to update immediately."

With tech firms warning that some hackers were already exploiting the flaws, government agencies across Europe were among those that took sites offline as a precaution.

Because a fix is now public and artificial intelligence tools are able to reverse engineer the bug with little effort, experts said they were bracing for a wave of intrusions as hackers jumped to get ahead of fixes.

AI was powering a "race to exploit," said Costin Raiu, co-founder of cybersecurity research and incident response firm TLP:Black. He said the next step was the "mass compromise of every vulnerable web server on the internet."

PHP — a language that dates back to the early 1990s and initially stood for "Personal Home Page" — underpins huge parts of the public-facing web and is baked into WordPress, Drupal, Joomla and Magento sites, meaning that any critical vulnerability potentially has enormous knock-on consequences.



The unavailable Dutch govt website on Wednesday. REUTERS

"All servers using any version of PHP released in the last 20 years will be vulnerable," said Tiffany Farriss, the interim chief executive of the Drupal Association. "This issue impacts the majority of the Internet."

Cybersecurity agencies in Europe, Australia, Japan and Britain have urged PHP users to update immediately or take websites offline until patches can be applied.

The Dutch cybersecurity agency itself went offline, saying it had done so as a precaution because of the vulnerabilities. The operator of the online encyclopedia Wikipedia also said it had taken down an unspecified number of systems until they could be safely patched.

Even some world leaders, who don't typically get involved with software updates, weighed in. Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi in a post on X said website owners should "check whether your live site uses PHP and prepare to apply the new fix." The flaw in PHP was discovered using artificial intelligence, Alphabet-owned cybersecurity company Wiz said.

The vulnerabilities remained hidden in the PHP codebase for more than a decade and would have been extraordinarily complicated for a human hacker to have taken advantage of, the post said. "Pre-AI, this manual work would be difficult to implement and even harder to scale," it said. "With AI this is no longer a barrier."

Wiz said its research relied on Wiz Atlas, its autonomous AI vulnerability research tool, as well as Google's Gemini 4 Argon and OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Sol. Wiz said it coordinated with the PHP team, OpenAI, and the cybersecurity company Calif on the discovery of the vulnerability and patch verification.

The company said it also partnered with Google Cloud, Cloudflare, Amazon's AWS, Microsoft , WordPress.com operator Automattic, and other companies.

MINUTES OF MPC'S OCTOBER 5-7 MEETING

'Further rate hikes to hinge on growth-inflation outlook'

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 21

MPC had hiked repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% in last meet. EXPRESS

AFTER UNANIMOUSLY voting to increase the policy repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.50%, the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) has signalled that rate cuts are off the table in the near-term as inflationary pressures mount.

The pace and extent of further tightening would depend on the evolving growth-inflation outlook, said the minutes of the MPC meeting held on October 6.

The decision comes amid rising crude oil prices, weather-related disruptions to food supplies, a deficient monsoon and rupee depreciation, with the RBI projecting retail inflation at 5.2% for 2026-27, up from its earlier forecast of 5%.

While some MPC members cautioned that aggressive rate hikes could weigh on consumption and private investment, others argued that pre-emptive action was necessary to contain inflation expectations and preserve credibility of the inflation-targeting framework.

The MPC also changed its stance to calibrated tightening in October policy review.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the duration and extent of the rate hiking cycle would be contingent on the actual growth-inflation developments and outlook, especially that of underlying inflation, broadening of price pressures, second round effects of supply shock, and the impact of demand impulses.

"Nevertheless, I feel it is appropriate to change the stance to calibrated tightening, essentially signalling that rate cuts are off the table in the near-term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving circumstances and the outlook," he said, as per the minutes.

Inflation outlook

Inflationary pressures are building up. Headline CPI is projected to touch the upper tolerance band in Q3, and remain significantly above 5% in the next two quarters, the governor said.

According to Saugata Bhattacharya, an MPC Member, since the August 2026 review, global financial conditions have tightened significantly. Energy prices have again risen. El Niño led weather disruptions have resulted in an increase in prices of many agricultural commodities, particularly of edible oils, sugar and, to an extent, cereals.

Most major central banks, responding to global macro-financial conditions, have adjusted their policy rates upwards. Benchmark yields have risen sharply across multiple G20 countries, and research reports suggest this is partly a result of rising term premia now sought by investors, he said.

The inflationary outlook remains challenging due to a combination of factors, including deficient monsoon, rising crude oil prices, precious metals prices remaining at elevated levels, and exchange rate depreciation, leading to a revision of the forecast for headline inflation for 2026-27, MPC Member Nagesh Kumar said. While inflation is driven largely by supply-side factors and does not show any signs of overheating of the economy nor of generalisation, it is important to manage inflationary expectations, Kumar said.

Drop cautiousness bias, 'Act in a pre-emptive manner'

Ram Singh, another MPC Member, said expectations of significant rate increases can undermine demand not only in interest rate-sensitive sectors such as vehicles, real estate, and discretionary spending, but also drag on recent momentum in private investment. "Coming on the heels of stress on the farm sector due to below-normal rains and El Niño, rising input costs and global uncertainty, significant rate hikes would hurt profit margins and the sustainability of capex plans of large and small firms," Singh said.

"The inflation outlook merits greater attention, given supply side pressures from crude and food prices are unlikely to relent quickly. With demand holding strong and in the wake of strong growth in monetary and credit aggregates, the interplay of both supply and demand factors could ratchet up inflation pressures significantly in the period ahead. Therefore, I feel it is better to set aside the "cautiousness bias" and act in a pre-emptive manner at this juncture rather than wait and watch," said Indranil Bhattacharyya, Member, MPC.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Data of over 3,800 SBI customers leaked

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, October 21

THE STATE Bank of India (SBI), the country's largest public sector lender, has confirmed that personal data of some of its customers was exposed on the dark web, including their mobile numbers, addresses and loan details.

"The bank has experienced an incident involving the loss of certain data," the bank said in a stock filing Wednesday.

The exposed information, according to the filing, also included customers' dates of birth, names, gender, email addresses, branch and Customer Information File (CIF) identifiers, lead IDs, and metadata associated with loan/lead records and other related files.

SBI said that during a preliminary analysis of the incident, it reviewed close to 3,75,000 records available on the dark web, of which 3,897 customer records containing Personally Identifiable Information (PII) were identified.

It is unclear if the bank has informed impacted customers about the breach. SBI did not respond to a request for comment. The disclosure comes amid increasing cybersecurity risks faced by institutions in critical sectors, with concerns compounded by the ability of artificial intelligence (AI) systems to further exploit security loopholes.

Last week, the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (Cert-In), under the IT Ministry, revealed that AI models had gained unauthorised access to confidential information held by some Indian organisations. Though the agency did not mention impacted firms, it is understood that the targets were largely in the financial sector.

According to SBI's notification, it received an alert concerning the suspected exposure on October 16 from its Threat Intelligence Service Provider, Defence Cyber Agency, and Cert-In. In its notification, the bank said that a detailed investigation was required to establish the authenticity and scope of the exposed data, determine the potential source and extent of the exposure, and assess the associated risks to customers and the bank.

"A detailed assessment is currently underway and appropriate remedial and preventive measures are being implemented as required," it said.

"The bank promptly activated its cyber incident response and containment protocols. Additionally, an independent CERT-In-empanelled cybersecurity agency was engaged to conduct a comprehensive assessment and investigate the nature and extent of the alleged compromise," SBI said.

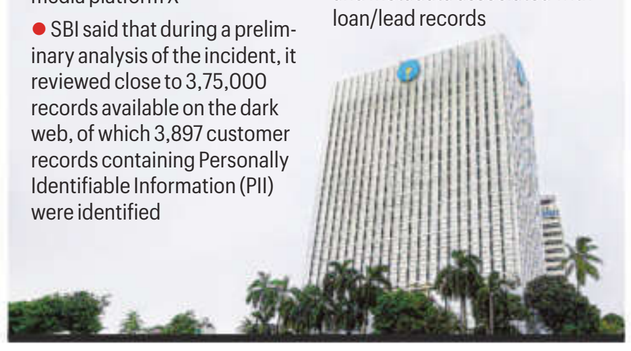
The incident did not have "any material impact" on its core business operations, financial performance or business continuity, it said.

The incident came to light through an account on social media platform X, where a group claimed to possess 3,75,000 entries in CSV format (plain-text file) and 2,722 PDF documents associated with SBI.

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, SBI could be penalised for being unable to employ reasonable security standards, leading to the breach. However, large parts of the law are yet to come into force.

• Data Breach

- **3,75,000 entries** in CSV format (plain-text file) and 2,722 PDF documents, associated with SBI, were claimed to be in possession of a group, something that came to light through an account on social media platform X
- SBI said that during a preliminary analysis of the incident, it reviewed close to 3,75,000 records available on the dark web, of which 3,897 customer records containing Personally Identifiable Information (PII) were identified
- The exposed information included customers' mobile numbers, addresses, loan details, dates of birth, names, gender, email addresses, branch and customer information file identifiers, lead IDs, and metadata associated with loan/lead records



Core sector growth hits series high of 7.9% in Sept

New Delhi: The output of India's nine core industries grew 7.9% year-on-year in September, the quickest rise in the current series, supported by a favourable base effect and a largely broad-based improvement in performance.

Output growth is not only the highest in the current Index of Core Industries (ICI) series, which has data since April 2024, but it is also the highest since October 2023, taking into account the old series.

Barring electricity and cement, seven of the nine sectors under the ICI saw better performance in September compared to August, data released by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade on Wednesday showed.

The August growth print for nine core industries was revised sharply higher to 5.9% from the provisional 4.8%. Core sector output grew 3.1% in September 2025. Sequentially, the overall index fell 1.7% in September. FE

QIB QUOTA SUBSCRIBED 9.42 TIMES, RETAIL 0.73 TIMES

Jio IPO subscribed 3X on Day 1

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, October 21

JIO PLATFORMS' initial public offering (IPO) was fully subscribed on the opening day of the issue with qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) showing strong demand.

The overall issue has been subscribed 3.16 times, while the QIB portion has received bids worth 9.42 times the shares reserved for the category, according to stock exchange data. In comparison, the retail investor segment has been subscribed 0.73 times and the employee quota 1.37 times.

The portion set apart from RIL shareholders was subscribed 1.46 times and the non-institutional investor category was sold 1.68 times. While the total number of shares on offer were 19.75 crore, there was demand for 62.36 crore shares, exchange data showed.

The figures indicate that institutional investors are driving demand for the issue, while participation from retail investors and eligible employees remains below the shares available in their respective categories. The institutional response is significant, given the scale of the offering. The company, which operates in the telecom and digital services sectors, is the digital and telecom arm of Reliance Industries Ltd.

The proposed IPO was expected to raise around Rs 30,000 crore, making it one of the country's largest public offerings. The issue has attracted attention because of Jio's position in India's telecommunications market and its expanding digital ecosystem.

The relatively low subscription level of the retail investors quota suggests that retail participation has not kept pace with institutional demand at this stage. Given the size of the offering, the retail segment remains an important category to watch as the subscription process progresses. Retail response normally comes on the last day of the issue, analysts said.

At least 35% of the net issue was reserved for retail individual investors. Jio Platforms has reserved shares worth up to Rs 500 crore for eligible employees. RIL has encouraged employee participation, including outreach to its workforce and the early release of October salaries to provide employees with funds ahead of the IPO. The employee quota is therefore another segment to monitor as investors assess the overall response to the public issue. Jio Platforms' IPO aims to raise approximately Rs 30,213 crore at the upper end of its price band of Rs 1,065 to Rs 1,119 per share.

The issue comprises 27 crore fresh equity shares. The company plans to use Rs 27,500 crore of the proceeds to repay debt, with the remaining funds intended for general corporate purposes, subject to the stated limits.

The IPO has drawn unprecedented institutional interest, with demand for its Rs 8,110-crore anchor book exceeding 30 times the amount on offer and aggregate institutional demand touching nearly Rs 2.5 lakh crore. The strong response from global asset managers, sovereign wealth funds, domestic mutual funds, insurers and pension funds came ahead of the October 21 opening of the IPO of Reliance group's telecom and digital services arm. The issue will close on October 23.

The overall response will depend on how demand develops across categories during the remaining bidding period.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

eMudhra's digital certificate security code compromised

New Delhi: Indian digital certification authority eMudhra has revealed that private keys associated with its certificates have been compromised, which verify trusted digital assets and ensure secure online data transmission, according to an advisory from the cybersecurity watchdog Cert-In. eMudhra issues certificates for digital signatures that are used for several online transactions by all kinds of business entities. PKI consists of several components, including public and private keys, for digital assets in mathematical codes used for encryption, digital certificates issued to websites. PTI

Let exchange rate move as first line of defence: IMF official

Mumbai: India should allow the dollar-rupee exchange rate to move as the first line of defence amid the ongoing oil shock, an IMF official said on Wednesday. "Our advice to countries is to use the exchange rate as first line of defence amid ongoing shocks," Krishna Srinivasan, director of the Asia and Pacific Department at the IMF said at a media briefing in Mumbai. "We would advise india to let exchange rate move," Srinivasan said. REUTERS

Eternal profit nearly doubles to Rs 125 cr in Q2

New Delhi: Eternal, the parent entity of Zomato and Blinkit, on Wednesday reported a consolidated net profit of Rs 125 crore for the September quarter, nearly doubling from Rs 65 crore a year ago, on robust revenue growth. The company's revenue from operations stood at Rs 24,138 crore in the second quarter of the ongoing financial year, up from Rs 13,590 crore on a year-on-year basis, according to a regulatory filing. PTI

2 HDFC Bank executives leaked confidential info

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, October 21

AN INTERNAL investigation by HDFC Bank has found evidence that two senior executives disclosed confidential business strategies and potentially market-sensitive information to outsiders, adding to the governance challenges confronting India's largest private sector lender by market value.

According to the people familiar with the matter, as cited by *Bloomberg*, the executives oversee key businesses and functions at the bank. The investigation began after some senior leaders raised concerns about possible information leaks. The bank is continuing to examine whether the information disclosed was misused.

The findings were communicated with the senior management, including some board members, earlier this year, said the report. Both executives have since been formally informed of the findings. It remains unclear what disciplinary action, if any, will follow. An HDFC Bank spokesperson said the bank is committed to upholding the highest standards of ethics and governance as outlined in its Code of Conduct. "We take any report of potential violations seriously. In line with our policies, an internal review into this matter is currently underway to gather and evaluate all relevant facts," he said.

"To protect the integrity of the process and the privacy of all parties involved, we do not comment on active internal reviews. Appropriate action will be taken based on the findings, once the review is complete," the bank said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Regulation, skill gaps hitting AI adoption in Europe: Report

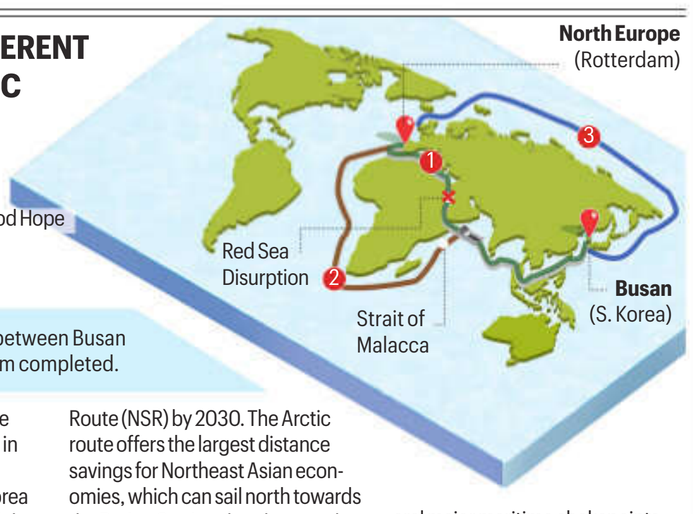
Bengaluru: Regulatory hurdles, funding shortages and gaps in workforce skillsets are prompting European startups to consider relocating, risking a mass exit of the region's most promising new ventures, an Amazon Web Services executive said on Wednesday.

Europe has struggled to narrow the gap with the US and China in the AI race due to tighter regulations and energy constraints. The region has produced few frontier AI models of its own and is instead dependent on the likes of OpenAI and Anthropic. "European businesses are telling us that they could spend as much as 40 cents to every euro on regulatory compliance instead of technology. Imagine if that was reinvested in technology," AWS EMEA Managing Director Tanuja Randery asked. REUTERS

• CHARTING A DIFFERENT COURSE VIA ARCTIC

1. Suez Canal Route
2. **Red Sea Disruption:** around the Cape of Good Hope
3. Northern Sea Route (Russia Arctic Coast)

October 11, 2026 | Trial voyage between Busan and Rotterdam completed.



The highly-seasonal Arctic route may see more than usual traffic in the days to come. Disruption in West Asia has nudged South Korea to diversify its trade routes. A trial voyage between Busan and Rotterdam was completed on October 11, with Seoul now targeting regular services along the Northern Sea Route (NSR) by 2030. The Arctic route offers the largest distance savings for Northeast Asian economies, which can sail north towards the Bering Strait rather than south through Malacca and Suez. For South Korea, the route could substantially shorten journeys to Northern Europe and bypass several major maritime chokepoints, providing a pressure valve during periods of disruption rather than a replacement for established Asia-Europe shipping corridors.

SOURCES: OXFORD ECONOMICS, TRADEPRISM

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
73,709.69	22,811.35	₹1,44,105	₹94.47
-143.21	-77.60	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
-0.19%	-0.34%	₹2,06,783	$115.55

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 20, 2026

• THE MOVE WILL GIVE CONSUMERS A CHOICE OF ELECTRICITY SUPPLIER & INTRODUCE COMPETITION IN A SECTOR DOMINATED BY STATE-OWNED UTILITIES

Why nod to 1st private power distributor in Gurugram & Nuh is triggering concerns

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, October 21

The Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission (HERC) has granted a 25-year parallel electricity distribution licence to a private company, Eleven Power Private Limited, for Gurugram and Nuh districts.

Once the licence takes effect, Eleven Power will become the first private player to enter Haryana's electricity distribution sector, which has so far been dominated by two state-owned distribution companies (DISCOMs) — Uttar Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (UHBVN) and Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (DHBVN).

This will also become the second such instance of parallel electricity distribution licensing in India outside Mumbai, where Tata Power Company Limited (TPCL), BEST (Brihanmumbai Electric Supply and Transport Undertaking) and Adani Electricity Mumbai Limited operate as distribution licensees in overlapping areas of the city.

The move is expected to give consumers a choice of electricity supplier and introduce competition in a sector traditionally dominated by state-owned utilities.

However, it has drawn strong opposition from existing DISCOMs and their employees. The state government, too, has opposed the order and said it will challenge it. But what is a parallel license? Why has it become so contentious?

IMPACT ON DISCOMS

Eleven Power was granted the licence under Section 14 of the Electricity Act, 2003, that empowers the appropriate electricity regulatory commission to grant licences to two or more entities to distribute electricity through their own distribution networks within the same geographical area.

Anoop Singh, founder and coordinator of the Centre for Energy Regulation and Energy Analytics Lab at IIT Kanpur, said while retail supply competition would provide choice to the consumers, adoption of parallel licensing could increase the cost towards electricity delivery infrastructure for the power system as a whole due to duplication of infrastructure and division of consumers between two licensees.



Eleven Power will become the first private player to enter Haryana's electricity distribution sector. REUTERS

"The new licensee will have to establish its own distribution network, while the existing licensee will continue to maintain its infrastructure. With consumers split between the two DISCOMs, the cost of building and maintaining the networks will be spread across a smaller consumer base for each licensee, potentially increasing the cost of electricity delivery for both sets of consumers," Singh told *The Indian Express*. "This may impact consumer tariff unless the impact is offset by significant improvement in operational and financial performance of incumbent DISCOM, and significant cost advantage to the new licensee," he added. Another concern, Singh said, is the mismatch between the fixed costs incurred by DISCOMs and the fixed charges they recover from consumers through electricity bills. While a substantial portion of a DISCOM's expenditure remains fixed, irrespective of the volume of electricity sold, most of its revenue depends on how much electricity consumers use. Although electricity bills comprise a fixed charge and a variable component linked to consumption, the fixed charge is often insufficient to cover the utility's fixed costs. A DISCOM's fixed costs include capacity payments to thermal power generators, transmission costs, employee salaries, and infrastructure maintenance. These expenses have to be paid on a lumpsum basis, irrespective of DISCOM's energy sales.

CROSS-SUBSIDY CONCERNS

Another point of contention was the potential impact of the parallel licence on DHBVNL's finances and the state's cross-subsidy mechanism, under which revenue from commercial and industrial consumers helps subsidise electricity supplied to households and farmers. DHBVNL estimated that even if 2.5% of existing electricity sales shifted to Eleven Power, the utility could suffer a revenue loss of Rs 424.12 crore in 2027-28. The estimated loss could rise to Rs 1,898.75 crore if 20% of sales shifted, and Rs 4,272.19 crore if the share reached 45%.

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• HISTORY

May 1968: When radical protests gripped France

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, October 21

AFTER WEEKS of protests in France against poor school conditions and the high cost of living, Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu called for "partial curfews" in some major cities on Monday evening.

Protesters have invoked the transformative protests of "Mai 1968" (May 1968), which similarly began as protests against poor university conditions and government repression, and snowballed into a general strike by millions of workers. The 1968 protests very nearly brought down the government of President Charles de Gaulle, led by conservative Prime Minister Georges Pompidou.

A nation revolts

Two decades after World War II, France's higher education system was struggling to accommodate a rapidly growing student population. According to historian John Merriman, university enrolment expanded faster than institutional capacity — from 192,000 in 1958-59 to 478,000 in 1967-68 — squeezing access to already overstretched facilities and resources.

Access to higher education also remained deeply unequal: only 2% of university students in 1964 were children of workers and peasants. Compounding the problem was institutional rigidity, characterised by outdated rules and convoluted bureaucracy. A university degree did not guarantee steady employment for graduates, especially those studying humanities.


WIKIMEDIA COMMONS
'Night of the Barricades'.

Student protests began at the University of Nanterre, west of Paris, before spreading to the Sorbonne and the Latin Quarter, where clashes with police intensified the unrest. The Sorbonne was closed on May 2, and police entered the campus the following day to evacuate students, escalating tensions.

On the night of May 10-11, dubbed the "Night of the Barricades", thousands of high school and university students took to the streets of Paris and erected barricades of cobblestones, overturned cars, iron grates and construction materials. Police responded with batons and tear gas. The clashes left several injured and led to hundreds of arrests.

Workers unite

The police response helped generate public sympathy for the students and prompted trade unions to call a general strike in solidarity, even as workers mobilised over their own grievances. By May 20, an estimated 10 million workers had joined the strikes, bringing much of France to a standstill. Negotiations between the government, employers and trade unions produced the Grenelle agreements, which provided for substantial wage increases and stronger trade union rights, although they were not formally signed. Although the political upheaval didn't immediately dislodge de Gaulle — his party won a commanding majority in the June 1968 elections — he resigned April 1969 following the defeat of a referendum on constitutional reforms.

The protests nevertheless brought changes to university administration and expanded opportunities for student participation. But as Merriman observed, greater access to higher education did not resolve the underlying problems of inadequate funding, institutional inequality and uncertain employment prospects for graduates.



• GLOBAL

Israel polls: Netanyahu down, but far from out

Israel votes on October 27. Although it seems unlikely that the incumbent Netanyahu will secure a majority, the Opposition has failed to stand united



EXPERT EXPLAINS
PROF TAMAR HERMANN
SENIOR RESEARCH FELLOW AT THE ISRAEL DEMOCRACY INSTITUTE

FACING CONFLICTS on multiple fronts, Israel heads to the polls on October 27. These are the first elections in the country since the October 7, 2023 Hamas attack which Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was reportedly warned about. Since then, Israel has launched a war on Gaza, sparking a massive humanitarian crisis, and opened fronts against Iran and Lebanon.

The race looks tight. Netanyahu's conservative Likud party — which has completed a four-year term along with a far-right and religiously conservative coalition — is trailing in the opinion polls as he appears no closer to ending the wars he has started.

Still, Netanyahu is a master of the political comeback, someone known for forging unlikely alliances. So what could happen in the elections? Answering everything you need to know is **Professor Tamar Hermann**, a senior research fellow at the Israel Democracy Institute and the academic director of the Viterbi Family Center for Public Opinion and Policy Research. Hermann spoke to **Moinuddin Ahmad**.

What are the key issues for voters?

A poll conducted by the Israel Democracy Institute in August found that the top issues were security and foreign relations. People voted very closely on issues such as the economy and the cost of living. The interesting thing here is that before the October 7 attacks, people were only interested in the economy and cost of living; even political parties were talking about it.

As we approach elections, all the political parties agree on national security, but differ on violence in the West Bank. The current government and its allies are soft on the violent settlers in the West Bank, but if the government changes, I am sure that the security forces will be tougher on these settlers. Overall, security is the top agenda in Israel.

Netanyahu has always managed to keep his right-wing coalition together. Given issues like post-war security and October 7 accountability, do you think he will be able to get the 61-seat majority with current allies?

According to the polls, it seems very difficult that Netanyahu will get even close to 61 seats in the 120-member Knesset. However, he is the only one among the current politicians who is capable of holding his block together. Netanyahu is a highly capable politician... he remains a political marvel with an unbroken grip on Israeli politics.

He has survived so far despite not being able to deliver any of the promises he made at the beginning of the war: He failed to topple the Iranian regime, he couldn't dismantle Hezbollah in Lebanon, and Hamas is still operating in Gaza. Yet, he stays the frontrunner for the post of Prime Minister.

Does the opposition have a cohesive policy alternative, or are they still bound by an 'anyone-but-Bibi' coalition dynamic?

Yes, that's the main issue. They all mention the [military] draft of the ultra-orthodox Jews as a unifying factor [they support the draft]. However, they diverge on the issue of partnering with the Arabs. There seems no unity in contesting the elections as a unit, taking the Arab parties together. Recently, they met at the home of Yair Lapid and issued a document which says nothing. It only says: "We commit ourselves not to cannibalise each other," which is what they have been doing for quite some time. All the talk of opposition unity is just empty rhetoric.

Ultra-orthodox Jews are exempt from the military draft, but Netanyahu's Likud faces pressure to end this arrangement. How damaging is this issue to the alliance between Likud and ultra-orthodox parties?

The ultra-orthodox parties — mainly Yahadut HaTorah (or United Torah Judaism) — expected a Netanyahu government to capitulate to their demands [for exemption]. From their perspective, he didn't deliver [since no final call has been taken on the issue]. So, a key Yahadut HaTorah Knesset member said that they will not hesitate in joining the (Gadi) Eisenkot-led alliance, which means that they actually threatened Netanyahu. But threatening now is of no avail, because the government cannot presently pass any law in this regard until the new government is formed. Also, it looks very unlikely that ultra-orthodox parties will actually join the Eisenkot camp.

What is the mood among Arab citizens? Is there despair over marginalisation, or pragmatic demand for leaders who can deliver on local socio-economic issues?

There are both kinds of advocacy. Some would say, like actually Ra'am [an Arab party] says: "This country is a Jewish country; willing or not, we should make the best out of participating in the political process." The purists say, "Well, never mind, we have no impact, so why would we bother?" In the past elections, it was 50-52%. A year ago, it seemed their participation might be as low as 30%, but now it appears to be between 52% and 55%.

If the results produce another stalemate without a clear majority for either bloc, what structural changes or alternative political alignments might emerge to break Israel's cycle of repeated elections?

Structural changes will not be made in the foreseeable future. There could be four possible outcomes —

FIRST, if Netanyahu wins, with the help of smaller parties, then there will be no need for new elections.

THE SECOND OPTION is that the Change Bloc [the Naftali Bennet-led alliance] will have the majority. I don't see it happening.

THE THIRD OPTION is that the Netanyahu government will work as a caretaker government, and there will be re-elections.

THE LAST OPTION is that we will have a minority government by the Change Bloc, in which case I believe at least one Haredi party will join them. If that happens, the two Haredi parties will compete, as the Haredi party on the Change side may have to concede some of its demands.

Reports say Netanyahu was warned about the October 7 attacks. Is this an election issue?

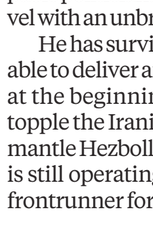
It is, because it works against Netanyahu. But it will not make much impact. The opposition parties were already saying that the Netanyahu government failed in stopping the attack. At the same time people are asking why such reports are coming just before the elections. And secondly, they will tell you that he did not do a preemptive strike on Gaza because it could have impacted a peace treaty with Saudi Arabia, something that is supported in Israel across the political spectrum.

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• FIVE LEADERS, ONE ELECTION

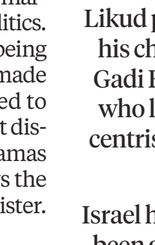
A look at the leaders of the five key parties heading into one of Israel's most consequential elections.

BENJAMIN NETANYAHU
(Prime Minister), Likud Party



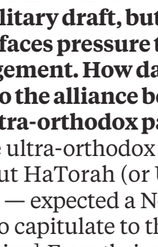
Israel's longest-serving prime minister and Likud leader is seeking another term after decades at the centre of Israeli politics. Supporters cite his security and economic record and close ties with US President Donald Trump. Critics blame his government for failures preceding the October 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks and question his handling of the wars that followed.

GADI EISENKOT
(Former military chief), Yashar Party



Eisenkot leads the centrist Yashar and is Netanyahu's main challenger. After resigning from Netanyahu's war cabinet, he has positioned himself as a moderate alternative while maintaining a hard line on security. His party's performance will determine whether he can assemble a coalition and become Israel's first prime minister of Mizrahi (North Africa and Middle East) descent.

NAFTALI BENNETT
(Former PM), Beyachad Party



The right-wing former PM is contesting the polls through Beyachad, a joint ticket with centrist **Yair Lapid**. He opposes Palestinian independence and supports West Bank settlements, but has clashed with Netanyahu over security and the legal system. Having led a coalition that included left-wing and Arab parties in 2021, he could play a role in determining the next government.

ITAMAR BEN-GVIR
(National security minister), Otzma Yehudit Party



Israel's far-right national security minister leads Otzma Yehudit, which pushed Netanyahu's coalition further to the right. Ben-Gvir has backed the 'voluntary' emigration of Palestinians from Gaza and building Jewish settlements there. A strong showing could strengthen his influence over a potential Netanyahu-led government.

MANSOUR ABBAS
(Knesset member), Ra'am Party



The Palestinian Arab politician leads Ra'am, an Islamist party that became the first Arab-led party to join an Israeli governing coalition in 2021. Abbas has focused on crime and public services in Arab communities in his campaign, rather than the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. Ra'am's seat count could make it a potential partner in a post-election coalition.

Coalition politics

Polling shows a tight race between PM Netanyahu, of the nationalist Likud party, and his chief rival, Gadi Eisenkot, who leads the centrist Yashar.

•

Israel has always been governed by coalitions. No single party has ever won a majority in the 120-member parliament, or Knesset.

• CULTURE

Mate: How a South American drink became a footballing favourite

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, October 21

A LITTLE-KNOWN bitter, caffeinated drink of South American origin, meant to be consumed in a shared group setting, has come into the spotlight after footballer Erling Haaland was snapped with it.

Mate (*pronounced mah-teh*), also sometimes known as Paraguay tea, has become synonymous with South American footballers and is rapidly gaining a fanbase among their European counterparts. It is made by steeping chopped and dried leaves of the South American yerba mate plant in warm water. Part of its allure is the vessel in which the drink is consumed, which is traditionally carved from a calabaza gourd. The vessel's rim is usually made of steel, while the mug features leather and wood imprints. Mate is consumed using a silver straw called bombilla.

Origins of mate

The drink's origins are widely attributed to the indigenous Guaraní, a group whose origins date back to 500 CE, according to the BBC. Today, people of Guarani descent live in parts of Paraguay, southern Brazil and Northwest Argentina.

"The drink has deep cultural, social and economic roots," said Raul Romero of the National Yerba Mate Institute in Argentina, told *The New York Times*. "It has its origins in aboriginal communities that populated this region of America before the colonisation process. Yerba mate consumption is extremely important to people."

The Guarani people used yerba mate leaves as a beverage, a reverential object and a form of currency. They believed the leaves provided nutrition and suppressed appetite. Yerba mate consumption was popularised by Spanish colonisers (or conquistadors) in the late 1500s-early 1600s. Years later, Jesuit missionaries popularised its cultivation.

Mate styles diverge across Paraguay, Uruguay, Argentina and Brazil. In Argentina, the drink is made of leaves aged for two years and small twigs. The Uruguayan variant contains fewer twigs and powdered leaves for a stronger flavour.

Communal ritual

- Consumption of mate is a communal affair. The same person must serve a round of mate to all participants.
- The ceremony itself enjoys a near-sacred status, wherein the act of pouring and sharing the drink is considered an act of love and dedication.


In his X post, Erling Haaland is seen holding a 'calabaza' with a 'bombilla' (straw).

The drink's appeal

Despite being caffeine-rich, mate contains less caffeine than coffee and more than black tea. It is known to have vitamins and minerals that help to suppress appetite. "Players who drink mate tend to be better hydrated because they drink more fluids," Jose Blesa, head of sports science at the Swiss football club FC Basel, told *The New York Times*. "It contains caffeine, which has proven benefits in improving athletic performance by boosting stamina, energy and even mental focus. It also has antioxidants that can help strengthen the immune system by fighting free radicals."

Mate occupies a special status in Argentina, with the Argentinian government in 2013 declaring it the "national infusion". Lionel Messi and his team transported 240 kg of the leaves to Qatar during their World Cup-winning campaign in 2022. But the team's choice of leaves proved controversial — they were Uruguayan leaves processed in Brazil. While the Argentina players laughed off the controversy, Argentine brand Cachamai became the team's official sponsor in the 2024 Copa America.

Mate's influence is no longer confined to South America. French players Antoine Griezmann and Paul Pogba have posted themselves drinking the tea on their social media. English player Eric Dier joked about how players from Europe were pretending to be South American by drinking mate, while acknowledging that he, too, was a fan.

• LAW & ORDER

Crime and punishment: Recalling Coimbatore serial blasts, at centre of parole row

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 21

THE TAMILAGA Vettri Kazhagam-led Tamil Nadu government's decision to grant 60 days' parole to five life convicts in the 1998 Coimbatore serial bombings has drawn the BJP's demands for its reversal, reopening a debate shaped by decades of grief, punishment and political conflict.

The attacks, which killed 58 people and targeted BJP leader L K Advani's election rally, had been preceded by communal violence and police firing less than three months earlier, in which 18 Muslims were killed.

The two episodes form a connected history of communal polarisation, policing failures and a terrorist conspiracy that transformed everyday life in Coimbatore.

Communal violence in 1997

Coimbatore's communal tensions had been deepening since the early 1980s. Provocative speeches by Hindu right-wing leaders, counter-mobilisation by Muslim groups, and retaliatory killings gradually hardened divisions. The Babri Masjid demolition in 1992 intensified an already dangerous atmosphere.

On November 29, 1997, traffic constable R Selvaraj was murdered by cadres of Al-Umma, a Islamic extremist organisation founded by S A Basha in 1993 in Coimbatore. Selvaraj's killing triggered anger within the police ranks. Some personnel abandoned duty, creating a security vacuum in which Hindu militants attacked Muslims and their businesses.

Eighteen Muslims were killed during the ensuing communal violence and police firing. Shops were looted, property destroyed, and families traumatised before the Army and central forces restored order.

These deaths were subsequently invoked by extremists to mobilise support for retaliation. Photographs and recordings of the victims circulated. The suffering of civilians became material for a conspiracy against other civilians.

The February 1998 serial blasts

On February 14, 1998, bombs exploded across Coimbatore as crowds gathered for Advani's election meeting at R S Puram. His flight was delayed, and he had not reached the venue when the explosions began.

The targets extended beyond the rally's vicinity: commercial establishments, transport facilities, a BJP election office, and the government hospital were among the places struck. Explosives were concealed in cars, two-wheelers, bags, and a pineapple cart.

The eventual death toll associated with the blasts was 58, with more than 200 injured. Several unexploded devices were recovered. One car near the rally venue contained approximately 70 kg of explosives; dismantling it required days of preparation.

Investigators identified Al-Umma as the organisation behind the attacks, for which it was subsequently banned.

The Commission

The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)-led Tamil Nadu government under Chief Minister M Karunanidhi had set up a one-man inquiry commission under Justice P R Gokulakrishnan, a former Acting Chief Justice of the Madras High Court, to investigate the communal violence in November-December 1997. On February 22, 1998, it was asked to examine the bombings and the circumstances preceding them.

Its findings concerned different episodes and should be read separately.

In an initial report tabled in November 1998, the commission justified police firing as necessary to contain violence in November-December 1997. But it faulted policemen who refused duty after Selvaraj's murder, despite their commissioner's directions, and recommended disciplinary action.

For the serial bombings, the commission subsequently identified retaliation for the earlier Muslim deaths as the conspiracy's motive. Its final report in 2000 criticised failures of vigilance that allowed Al-Umma to execute the bombings.

Aftermath of the violence

Fear persisted in Coimbatore after the streets reopened. Ahead of the November 1998 anniversary, security plans included 4,000 additional personnel, 30 siren-fitted jeeps supplementing 12 existing vehicles, 17 checkposts, and 32 police pickets. Peace committees were also formed.

For Muslim neighbourhoods such as Kottaimedu, Ukkadam, and Al-Ameen Colony, insecurity included repeated searches and collective suspicion. Residents who opposed the bombings could nevertheless feel that their condemnation would not be believed.

There were also acts of solidarity. Hospitals admitted victims, doctors worked through personal grief, and residents supported bomb-disposal teams.

Karunanidhi's government faced accusations of police complacency and failure to act on intelligence warnings. The BJP and its ally, Jayalalithaa's All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), made the bombings an indictment of the administration. Muslims also questioned the government's failure to protect them during the earlier violence.

The DMK-led alliance suffered in the subsequent 1998 parliamentary election, winning only nine of the state's 39 Lok Sabha seats.

Basha's parole

In 2007, a special court convicted 158 people and sentenced 43, including S A Basha and Mohammed Ansari, to life imprisonment. Basha died at 84 in December 2024, having obtained parole during his final years. After Basha's death, the lawyer Prabhu Balasubramanian mentioned how Basha once told him things had spiralled beyond his control before he could stop it. Balasubramanian, who knew the Al-Umma founder, also described Basha's remorse and his desire to see his grandchildren.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Guddi Agrawal,W/O-Sh.Rishi Kumar Agrawal,R/O-E 275,EAST OF KAILASH, South East Delhi-110065, have changed my name to Rajkumari Agrawal for all purpose. 0040884659-1

I Murari Lal S/O, Late Makhan Lal R/o C-4/25 Yamuna Vihar, Delhi 110053 have changed my name to Murari Lal Goyal for all future purposes. 0040884643-1

I,Mohd Naseem S/o Mohd Ismyle R/o Z-58-A, DDA-Flats,New Ranjeet Nagar, Delhi-110008,that Mohd Naseem and Mohammad Naseem both are same person. 0040884660-3

I,Sachidanand Chaurasia @ Sachi Danand,S/o-Hari Shankar Chaurasia,R/o.E-2, Chaurasia Bhawan,Harkesh Nagar,Okhla,Delhi-110020, declare that Sachidanand Chaurasia and Sachi Danand both names are same and one person. 0040884659-10

I, Vipan Lata W/o Girish Chandra Sahu, R/o Main Chauraha, Sahu Market, Ganj Road, Sahawar, Kasganj, U.P. - 207245, have changed my name to PIVINLATA for all future purposes. 0071067008-1

I,Mangto Ahmed,S/O-Dolat Ali R/o A-98/1,Gali No-5,Guru Nanak Nagar, Bhagirathi Vihar Phase-2,Delhi-110094,Have Changed My Name To MANGTA AHMED.Permanently. 0040884661-6

I,ZARINA IQBAL,W/o-Mohammed Asif Hussain,R/o.S-153/10A,2nd Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1,Jamia Nagar,Okhla,New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to ZARINA for all purposes. 0040884659-3

I Santosh W/O, Murari Lal Goyal R/o C-4/25 Yamuna Vihar, Delhi 110053 have changed my name to Santosh Goyal for all future purposes. 0040884644-1

I, V Parvatha Vardhani alias Parvatha Vardhani Venkataraman W/o Rahul Chandrakant Khot R/o L1/284 B, DDA LIG Flats, Kalkaji, South Delhi-110019 have changed my name to Parvatha Vardhani Venkataraman 0071067012-1

I,Naved S/O Shareef Ahmed R/o H NO.C-139,C-140, Gali No-16, Subhash Vihar, Ghonda Extn. Delhi-110053, Have Changed My Name To NAVED ANSARI. Permanently. 0040884660-5

I Anil Kumar Alegh S/O N.D Alegh R/O AC 138, Shalimar Bagh Delhi 88 have changed my name from Anil Kumar Alagh to Anil Kumar Alegh for all future purposes. 0040884522-1

I,REETESH KUMAR BHARTIYA, S/O-RAMESH CHANDRA SRIVASTAVA,R/o.G-8009, Tower-17,River-Heights,Sehani Khurd,Rajnagar Extension, Ghaziabad(UP)-201017,declare that my name is,wrongly mentioned as,RITESH KUMAR BHARTI in my DL No.UP35 20070080489 issued from,RTO Ghaziabad.That the actual name of mine is REETESH KUMAR BHARTIYA,which may be amended accordingly. 0040884663-2

I, SONAM YADAV, R/o HNo.16,17, Gali no 12, Wazirabad Village Near Shiv Mandir, Burari, Delhi, hereby declare that SONAM YADAV and SONOM YADAV are one and the same person. 0130070494-2

I No 15419690 k Hav Dhillirao Naidu Dummu residing of vi - pudijaganndhapuram po - Reyapadu Di - srikakulam , Andhrapradesh-532218 .My father Name and date of birth is wrongly mentioned in my service documents . I have changed my father's name from Ram murty to Dummu Rammurthy DOB is 01/01/1960 vide affidavit date 09/10/26 before notary public Delhi 0040884661-8

I, Ajay s/o Vinod Kumar r/o C-106, Back Side, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to AJAY SOBTI. 0040884547-1

I, Kanika Rastogi,W/o Nimish Rastogi,R/o B-245 (D) Shastri Nagar Meerut (U.P.)-250004 have changed my name to Kanika Jindal for all purposes. 0040884659-5

I, Manpreet Kaur Siddhu / Manpreet Kaur w/o Maninder Pal Siddhu r/o 1336, Arun Vihar, Sector-37, NOIDA, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201301 have changed my name to MANPREET SIDDHU. 0040884547-3

I,Yesh Pal Malik,S/o Thamburam Malik,R/o B2-1102, Uniworld Garden-2, Sector-47,Gurugram(Haryana)-122018,have changed my name to Yash Paul Malik for all Purposes. 0040884661-1

I,A.K.A. Basir alias Abdul Basir alias Basir Abdul Khabir Ahmed,son of Khabir Ahmed,resident of,c/o-Khabir Ahmed,Villa No.M-6,Shalimar Garden Bay,IIM Road Lucknow,Lucknow,Lucknow,Utar Pradesh-226013,have changed my name to,Abdul Khabir Ahmed Basir,vide affidavit dated 19.10.2026 at District Court,Gurugram. 0040884660-7

I,SIDDARTH KUMAR S/o Kewal Krishan Kumar R/o E-202 First Floor,Double Storey, Ramesh Nagar,Delhi-110015 have changed my name to SIDDHARTH KUMAR. 0040884666-1

I Sapana Samania W/o Sh. Krishan Kumar R/o T-2035 A, Pillanji Kotla Mubarak Pur, New Delhi-03 is also known as Sapna Samania. Both names are of one and the same person.My name correct spelling is Sapana Samania. 0040884523-1

I, Kishan S/o Ram Prakash R/o Khasra No. 105/17, Gali No. 114, B-Block, Phase-9, Sant Nagar, Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed my name to KISHAN PRAKASH for all future purposes. 0071066979-1

I,K.S.L. PRIYANKA,D/O K.S.V RAO,R/O FLAT.NO-19,MANZIL APARTMENT,PLOT NO-7, DWARKA, SECTOR-9,DWARKA, NEW DELHI-110077,inform that SHAKUNTALA LAKSHMI PRIYANKA KANDUKURI & K.S.L. PRIYANKA,both names are same person. 0040884661-10

I, Sumbul Ameer, W/o Adil Ameer, R/o 641, 4th Floor, Zakir Nagar, Jamia Nagar, Okhla South East Delhi-110025, have change my name to SUMBUL, for all purposes. 0040884659-7

I, RAKESH CHANDRA, S/o Yogeshwar Prasad, R/o H.No.-88B, Shakti Khand-1. Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, hereby declare that I have changed my name from RAKESH CHANDRA GHANSELA to RAKESH CHANDRA. Henceforth. I shall be known as RAKESH CHANDRA for all purposes 0071066999-1

I,Vishvjeet Kumar Tripathi,S/o-Bhupender Tripathi,R/o-Plot-No.-B-34,Gayatri Puram,Pallav Puram Phase 2,Modipuram, Meerut(Uttar Pradesh)-250110, Have Changed My Name To Vishvjeet Tripathi for All Purposes. 0040884661-3

I,REKHA,W/O-ANUJ KUMAR TOMAR,R/o-Plot No.588,Flat No.2004,Sector-1,Vaishali,Ghaziabad(U.P.)-201010,have changed my minor son name from SAXAM SINGH to SAKSHAM KUMAR TOMAR all future purposes. 0040884666-2

I SIYA D/O SH. NISHANT KUMAR R/O G-22, BETA-2, GREATER NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR-201308, UTTAR PRADESH HAVE CHANGED MY NAME SIYA TO SIYA RUHELLA FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0071066986-1

I,Roopa,W/o Mr.Ramphal Singh,R/o 2236/2, SHADI Khampur, West Patel Nagar, New Delhi-110008, have changed my name to Roopa Devi Singh. 0040884660-2

I hitherto known as,Vardaan Sadana,S/o-Sanjeev Sadana,R/o.G-5/173,Rohini sector 16,North West Delhi,Delhi-110089,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vardaan Kumar. 0040884659-9

I Sonali W/o Vishal Satija R/o 42/4, Ashok Nagar, New Delhi-110018 have changed my name to Sonali Satija. 0040884661-4

I,Gajendra Singh Yadav S/o Lejam Singh R/o 743A, Shambhoo Nagar Shikohabad Firozabad(U.P) have changed my name to Gajendra Singh for all future purposes. 0040884569-1

I, Rishibha Jain Gupta W/o Mr. Abhishek Gupta R/o S -110, Ground Floor Greater Kailash-1, New Delhi-110048 my previous name was Rishibha Jain, now my name is Rishibha Jain Gupta my name in all Government and other papers would be read and written in future as Rishibha Jain Gupta. 0071067002-1

I,Aftara W/O Naved Ansari,R/o H NO.C-139,C-140,Gali No-16, Subhash Vihar, Ghonda Extn.Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name To AFTARA ANSARI. Permanently. 0040884661-5

I BISHAN SARUP YADAV/ BISHAN SARUP S/o - DHARAM PAL R/o - H.NO.-810,SECTOR-10A,GURGAON,H:R-122001 have changed my name to LAL SINGH 0040884659-2

I, Neeraj Chib W/o Praveen Chib R/o RZC-5, West Sagarpur Nangal Raya, Delhi -110046, have changed my name to Neerja Chib permanently. 0040884536-1

I, Vinod Kumar S/o Hari Singh R/o-248, Bazar Lain No.2, Narendranagar, Garhwal, Uttrakhand have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Baghel. 0071066988-1

I,Mohammad Hanif S/o,Karimuddin R/o-2253/B-7/B-2, Guru-Nanak Nagar, Shadi-Khampur,New Ranjeet Nagar, Delhi-110008,that Haneef Ansari and Mohammad Hanif both are same person. 0040884660-4

I,JASKIRAT SINGH S/O MAHINDER PAL SINGH R/O C-46 SECOND-FLOOR C-BLOCK GANESH NAGAR DELHI-110018.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JASKIRAT SINGH KHANNA. 0040884663-1

I hitherto known as Hajee Begum W/o Syed Sajjad Ali Khan residing at #23/1, Anjaneya Temple Street, Austin Town, Bangalore South, Viveknagar, Bangalore, Karnataka-560047, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Hafizunnisa Begum. 0071066974-1

I,Anita Aggarwal,W/o-Parveen Kumar,R/o-6840,Near Everest Multiplex, Bass Sitab Rai Mohalla,Rewari,(Haryana)-123401,Have Change My Name to Anita For All Purposes. 0040884661-2

I Mohan vats s/o Banarasi dass vats R/O wz 49-c Palam Village near water tank Delhi-110045 have change my Name to Mohan Lal vats All purpose 0040884659-8

I, Rahul Chandrakant Khot alias Rahul Khot alias Rahul C Khot S/o Chandrakant Bhagwan Khot R/o L1/284 B, DDA LIG Flats, Kalkaji, South Delhi-110019 have changed my name to Rahul Chandrakant Khot 0071067013-1

I,hitherto known as MOHINI,W/O-BHUSHAN BHARDWAJ,R/O-30,East Part of Outer Ring Road, Badli,North West Delhi,Delhi-110042,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MOHINI BHARDWAJ. 0040884661-7

I,Sanjeev Kumar,S/o-Late Radhey Shyam Sharma,R/o.E-61,6th-Floor Raheja Atlantis Sector-31,Gurgaon(HR)-122001,have changed my name to Sanjeev Kumar Bhardwaj for all purposes. 0040884659-4

I, Trilok Singh Sahagal / Trilok Singh s/o Harsha Singh r/o 19/40-B, GF, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-110018 have changed my name to TRILOK SINGH SEHGAL 0040884547-2

I, Des Raj Dogra S/o Sadhru Ram R/o Akalpur, Lower Muthi, Jammu have changed my name to Des Raj for all purposes. 0071066990-1

I Obiban Singh alias Vikas Kumar S/o Shri Krishan R/o,5/71 ,Friends Enclave Sector-5, Sultanpuri C Block, North West Delhi, Delhi-110086 have change my name Vikas Kumar 0071067017-1

I, JAYANT S/o PARVATI NANDAN, R/o 26068, Tower-I, 14th Avenue, Gaur City-2, Sector-16C, Greater Noida West, G.B.Nagar, U.P.- 201301, have changed my name from JAYANT to JAYANT MAURYA for all future purposes. 0071066976-1

I hitherto known as AWADH AHIRWAR,S/o ARVIND AHIRWAR,R/o-31/10-A, Gali No.4,Bhikam Singh Colony,Vishwas Nagar,Shahdara, Delhi-110032,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as AWADH CHAUDHARY 0040884660-6

I hitherto known as Amardeep Garg S/O Manoj Kumar Garg R/O A-84,A-Block,Jhilmil Colony,Delhi-110095,have changed the name of my minor daughter Krishvi Garg aged 7 years and she shall hereafter be known as Srividya Garg. 0040884662-1

I,Gopal aggarwal,s/o Sunder Lal r/o-wz-30C, sadh Nagar,Street.no-1,Palam colony,new Delhi-110045,inform that Gopal Dass And Gopal aggarwal, both names are same person correct name gopal aggarwal for all,future purpose. 0040884661-9

I,Manpreet Kaur Anand,W/o-Harpreet Singh Anand,H.No.-C-8,Ground Floor Rajouri Garden Delhi - 110027 Have Changed My Name to Manpreet Kaur for all Purposes. 0040884659-6

I, Maninder Pal Singh Siddhu s/o Surinder Singh Siddhu r/o 1336, Arun Vihar, Sector-37, NOIDA, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201301 have changed my name to MANINDER PAL SIDDHU. 0040884547-4

I,No-10406709K,Hav Monu Kumar Gupta,R/O-Jamune Daltonganji,Palamu, Jharkhand-822101.In my service record the name and D o B of my father has as been wrongly mentioned as Bramh Dew Sahu,02-03-1966 instead of Brahma Deo Sahu,04-07-1965 and the D o B of my mother has been wrongly mentioned as 20-11-1967 instead of 12-01-1970 as Aadhaar cards. It needs corrections, vide affidavit No-IN -JK-568269408411 94Y,dated 19th October 2026 0020522273-1

I, Isha D/o Ekta Nath R/o-C2/101C, Lawrence Road, Keshavpuram, Delhi have changed my name to Isha Nath for all purposes. 0071066997-1

I,ABDUL HAFIZ,S/O-JAMILUDDIN,R/O-165 D-Block Bank colony Road,mandoli Extn,Delhi-110093,declare that name of my minor Daughter has,been wrongly written as,KHUSHBOO in her,Ladli Yojana record,The Actual name of my minor Daughter is,MUSKAN,Which may be amended accordingly. 0040884660-8

I,Aman Kumar Chauhan,S/o-Sh.Ramveer Singh,R/o-Flat No.94-C,DDA LIG Flats, School Road,Rampura,North West Delhi,Delhi-110035,declare that my father's name is wrongly written in my marksheet as Rambir Singh Chauhan instead of Ramveer Singh. 0040884660-1

I Kaushal Kishor Singh Chauhan, S/o Narendra Singh Chauhan, R/o B-1180B, Gali No.16, Second Pusta, Sonia Vihar, Delhi-110094, changed my name as Kaushal Kishor Singh. 0130070531-1

LOST & FOUND

Lost my Original Transfer Letter of my Plot-No.B-45, Housing Sector-C-8,Tronica City,Loni, Ghaziabad,U.P. Finder may Contact-Rajesh Kumar Poorwar,S/o-Omkar Prasad Poorwar,R/o-15/257, Civil Lines, Kanpur-20800(U.P.) 0040884660-9

We, Ashish Soni, Shalini S.Bhagat and Anjali Soni,R/o-C-105,South Extension-II,New Delhi,have lost the Original Sale Deeddated-27th March,1957 of our said Property.If found please contact us at-92050-57345. 0040884575-1

I, Rahul Kaushik S/o Late Shri Prakash Chander Kaushik R/o 97-H D.I.Z Area B.K.S.Marg Near Bangla Sahib Gurdwara Sector-4 New Delhi -110001 have lost my original property documets Property No.4736-B part (new) Flat no 108, first floor, 23, EMCA house, Ansari road, darya ganj, new Delhi.Finder Kindly contact this number 8882963390. 0071066919-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT MR. SURAJ PAL SINGH, WHO HAS APPLIED FOR A LOAN FROM LIC HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED (LICHFL), HAS REPORTED THE DEATH OF MRS. SAROJ WATI MITTAL, WHO EXPIRED ON 21.01.2013, AND HER HUSBAND LATE MR. GYAN PARKASH MITTAL ALIAS MR. GIAN PARKASH MITTAL ALSO EXPIRED ON 21.12.2003. THE LOAN PERTAINS TO RESIDENTIAL HOUSE BEARING MPL. NO. XVII/3072-2-A/1-A, AREA MEASURING 110 SQ. YDS. APPROX., OUT OF KHASRA NO. 382/46, SITUATED AT GALI NO. 10, RANJIT NAGAR, NEW DELHI. IT IS FURTHER INFORMED THAT THE SELLERS, NAMELY (1) MR. SATYA PARKASH MITTAL, (2) MR. JAI PARKASH MITTAL AND (3) MR. YASH PRAKSAH MITTAL, DO NOT POSSESS THE DEATH CERTIFICATE AND SURVIVING MEMBER CERTIFICATE OF THE ABOVE-NAMED DECEASED PERSON AND HAVE STATED THAT THERE ARE NO OTHER LEGAL HEIRS IN RESPECT OF THE AFORESAID PROPERTY.
IF ANY OTHER CLAIMENT HAS ANY RIGHT IN THE AFORESAID PROPERTY. HE/SHE SHOULD INFORM & GIVE INTIMATION TO THE UNDERSIGNED WITHIN 15 DAYS FROM THE DATE OF ISSUE OF THIS NOTICE.

Sd/-
BIPLAB KUMAR MUKHERJEE
Advocate
Off. 3657/6, Narang Colony, Tri Nagar, Delhi-110035

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT SHRI VIPIN CHAWLA AND SMT. PRERNA KAPOOR, WHO HAVE APPLIED FOR A LOAN FROM LIC HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED (LICHFL), HAVE REPORTED THAT SMT. RAM KALI DEVI EXPIRED ON 19.05.2015. THE LOAN PERTAINS TO RESIDENTIAL PLOT NO. 79-L, MEASURING 200 SQ. YDS., SITUATED IN THE RESIDENTIAL COLONY KNOWN AS NEW COLONY, WITHIN THE LIMITS OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION (MC), GURUGRAM, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT GURUGRAM, HARYANA. IT IS FURTHER INFORMED THAT THE TITLE TO THE AFORESAID PROPERTY IS DERIVED THROUGH A REGISTERED FAMILY WILL DATED 10.06.2009, EXECUTED IN FAVOUR OF (1) SHRI VIJAY KUMAR GUPTA AND (2) SHRI ARUN KUMAR GUPTA. IT HAS BEEN STATED THAT THERE ARE NO OTHER CLAIMANTS IN RESPECT OF THE AFORESAID PROPERTY.
IF ANY OTHER CLAIMENT HAS ANY RIGHT IN THE AFORESAID PROPERTY. HE/SHE SHOULD INFORM & GIVE INTIMATION TO THE UNDERSIGNED WITHIN 15 DAYS FROM THE DATE OF ISSUE OF THIS NOTICE.

Sd/-
BIPLAB KUMAR MUKHERJEE
Advocate
Off. 3657/6, Narang Colony, Tri Nagar, Delhi-110035

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, DEEPAK MUNJAL S/o SHRI O.P. MUNJAL R/o D-44, JHILMIL COLONY, DELHI-110095, have lost the original GPA executed by Shri Jitender Kumar Chawla S/o Sh. Ved Prakash Chawla in favour of Shri Deepak Munjal S/o Sh. O.P. Munjal duly registered as Doc. No.33681, in Addl. Book No.4, Vol.No.8488, at pages 34 to 35, dated 31/07/2003, in the office of Sub-Registrar IV, Seelampur, Delhi and original WILL, related to my Shop Pvt. No.7, on Ground Floor, part of Property No. C-84, situated at Jhilmil Colony, Delhi-110095. I have lodged a complaint in this regard vide LR No.733712/2026, dated 19/10/2026, P.S. Vivek Vihar/ e-Police Station, Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is informed to the public at large that my client Mr. Sanjeev Goel and Mrs. Nisha Goel are purchasing the Entire Third floor with roof rights of the property No.A-130, Madhuban, New Delhi-110092 wherein plots' Original Perpetual lease deed dated 04.12.1978 in favour of Mr. Pran Nath; Original Conveyance deed dated 22.10.2009 in favour of Mr. Pran Nath and Original Sale deed dated 28.06.2010 executed by of Mr. Pran Nath in favour of Sh. I.P.S.Bhatia, Sh. Vijay Manchanda and Sh. Ankur Verma are untraceable. The FIR/ Lost report to this effect has already been lodged dated 13.10.2026 with LR No.718094/2026. That Entire Third floor with the roof rights of the said property will be mortgaged in SBI RACPC Karkardooma Delhi. If any person/s has/have any right, title, interest, claim or demand of any nature whatsoever with respect to the above stated property, he/she is hereby required to make the same known in writing along with the documentary proof thereof to the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication hereof post expiration Any claims(s) or objection(s) if raised or received shall be treated as null & void and such claims."
Brijesh Tiwari (Advocate) No. K-67B, Tehsil Building, Delhi High Court, Courts Chamber Near Tis Hazari, Delhi **(M) : 9999990868**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all concerned that my client Sh. Ajit Pal Singh Arora, S/o. Late Sh. Narender Singh Arora & Smt. Rashmeet Kaur, W/o. Sh. Ajit Pal Singh Arora, both R/o. Flat No. 38, 3rd Floor, Dhudial Apartments, Pitam Pura, Delhi - 110034, that my clients' Daughter Ms. Sanya Arora has been behaving in a manner contrary to family norms & disobedient and disrespectful towards my clients. my clients hereby formally disowns and debars their daughter; Ms. Sanya Arora, from all of my clients' self-acquired and inherited movable and immovable properties, with immediate effect. Any person deals with Ms. Sanya Arora, in any capacity including, but not limited to, financial transactions or any act committed by their daughter, shall do so at their own risk and responsibility. Neither my clients nor his properties shall be held liable for any of their acts, debts, or liabilities, whether existing now or arising in the future.
PANKAJ SINGHAL (ADVOCATE)
Chamber at - Y-23, Civil Wings, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi - 110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from Mr. Umesh Verma who intends to purchase Entire Third Floor, Property Bearing No. ER-16, area admeasuring 400 Sq. yds., out of Khasra No. 1647 to 1649, situated at Abadi of Colony Inderpuri, New Delhi-110012 who is the owner through Partition Deed dated 06.11.2025 execute by Mr. Umesh Verma, Mr. Mahesh Verma, Mrs. Shanti Verma & Mr. Tarunam Verma vide Document No. 2025/8/I/7074, Volume No. 4270, Book No. 1, Page No. 1-26, in the SRO New Delhi Sarojni Nagar. THAT ORIGINAL/ Photocopies of prelor chain documents are misplaced and not traceable i.e. 1) CTC of Order dated 23.03.1990, 2) Death Certificate of Mr. Bidhi Singh Tanwar died on 09.07.1991, 3) Relinquishment Deed dated 02.08.1991 executed by Mrs. Sushma Rani, Mrs. Kamlesh Rani, Mrs. Geeta Rani and Mrs. Anju Bala in favour of Mrs. Angoori Devi, Mr. Sunil Kumar and Mr. Narinder Kumar, Document No. 5913, 4) Sale Deed dated 21.09.1993 executed in favour of Mr. Inderjeet Verma, Document No. 8928, SRO Delhi, on 11.11.1993, 5) Sale Deed dated 11.02.1994 executed by Mrs. Angoori Devi, Mr. Sunil Kumar & Mr. Narinder Kumar in favour of Mr. Inderjeet Verma, Document No. 1223, in the SRO Delhi, on 11.02.1994, 6) Regd. Will dated 04.09.1999 executed by Mr. Inderjeet Verma in favour Mr. Umesh Verma, Mr. Mahesh Verma & Mr. Yogesh Verma and Mr. Tarunam Verma, Document No. 641, SRO Delhi, on 04.09.1999, 7) Death Certificate of late Mr. Yogesh Verma, 8) Death Certificate of late Mr. Inderjeet Verma died on 29.07.2017, 9) Death Certificate of late Mr. Ujjwal Raj Verma died on 11.11.2023.
That, online F.I.R. has been lodged through Mr. Umesh Verma on 17.10.2026, vide ER No.728605/2006/PS. Inder Puri, New Delhi Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 10 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/ institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.
Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block D, Jangpura Extn. New Delhi-110014, 8810391672

I, **Selvaraj Valarmathi**, wife of **Sanjeev Satyanarayan** was allotted a plot by Yamuna Expressway Development Authority bearing allotment number YEA004323, **Plot No.502, Pocket F, Sector 20** in the name of Valarmathi and Agreement to lease is executed in the name of **S. Valarmathi.** My full name is **Selvaraj Valarmathi.**
I declare that **Valarmathi, S. Valarmathi** and **Selvaraj Valarmathi** refer to one and the same person.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the general public that my client **(1) PREM NAGI S/O MADAN LAL NAGI R/O 3-A BAGGCHI NO.3 SIDHARTH BASTI NEW DELHI-110014 AND (2) VEENA NAGI W/O PREM NAGI R/O 3-A BAGGCHI NO.3 SIDHARTH BASTI NEW DELHI-110014** have disowned and debarred their **SON** namely **SHOBHIT NAGI** from severing all their relations and all their moveable and immovable properties and also severed all their relations with him due to him being disobedient and disloyal towards my client. My client shall not be responsible for any acts or deeds done by them, anyone dealing with them shall be at their risk and consequences.
Firoz Ahmed (Advocate)
Chamber No 619, Patiala House Court, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

General Public is hereby informed that I RAJA BADAMI S/O LATE SH. A.S. BADAMI R/O 19/24, FIRST FLOOR, OLD RAJINDER NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110060, owner of SECOND FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, BUILT ON FREE HOLD PROPERTY NO. R-481, AREA MEASURING 197 SQ. YDS., SITUATED AT NEW RAJINDER NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110060, WITH ONE CAR PARKING SPACE IN STILT PARKING and the original documents detail given below:- **a.** GPA EXECUTED BY JASBINDER KAUR IN FAVOUR OF H.S. BHALLA, DULY ATTESTED BY CONSULATE GENERAL OF INDIA, DATED 08/04/2009, AND DULY AUTHENTICATED BY COLLECTOR OF STAMPS, DELHI, ON DATED 22/05/2009. **b.** GPA EXECUTED BY JASBINDER KAUR IN FAVOUR OF H.S. BHALLA, DULY ATTESTED BY CONSULATE GENERAL OF INDIA, DATED 04/08/2005, AND DULY AUTHENTICATED BY COLLECTOR OF STAMPS, DELHI, ON DATED 24/08/2005. **c.** COPY OF SUBSTITUTION LETTER NO. L&DO/PS1/406, DATED 02/06/1992, ISSUED BY DY. L&DO, have been misplaced by me and it is not traceable so far. If any person find the said documents please inform to me and contact at **9999263761.**

COURT NOTICE

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI
Notice Under Order V Rule 20 Code of Civil Procedure
Case No. FAO (COMM) 3/2026
Appeal Against order dated 19.07.2023
Passed By Ms. Neelam Singh, District Judge (CommercialCourt-02), South-East, Saket Courts, New Delhi
In Case No Misc. DJ 1157/23
SIDDHARTHA JINDAL
....Appellant/s
Vs
VIKRAM SINGH CHEEMA & ANR.
...Respondent/s
Notice to R-1
VIKRAM SINGH CHEEMA, S/O SHRI H.P.S CHEEMA,
PROPRIETOR OF M/S ZAAR
OFFICE ADDRESS:
C-10, SHOP NO. 8-9, SOUTH EXTENSION PART-II, NEW DELHI-110049
EMAIL: kks@kksoni.com
ALSO AT:
HOUSE NO. 200, HARGOBIND ENCLAVE, VIKAS MARG, DELHI-110092
PH.NO. 9899414866

Whereas the above noted appellant has presented an appeal under **Section 13(1A) of The Commercial Courts Act, 2015 R/w Section 340, 341 and Section 195 of the CRPC** which was listed before the Court on **05.01.2026** and the Court ordered issuance of notice to you. And whereas it has been proved to the satisfaction of the Court that you cannot be served in the ordinary manner. Notice is hereby issued that if you wish to defend the above mentioned appeal you may cause an appearance to be entered on your behalf either in person or through an advocate duly appointed by you for the purpose before the **Joint Registrar (Judicial) on 17.11.2026 at 11:00 A.M.**

If no appearance is made on your behalf, by yourself, your pleader or someone by law authorized to act for you in the said appeal on the aforementioned date, no further notice of the subsequent date of hearing of the said appeal will be given and the same will be heard and determined exparte in your absence.
Given under my hand and seal of this Court, this the **05th day of October 2026**

Seal
Sd/-
Assistant/ Registrar
For Registrar General

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"IMPORTANT"

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

First corrigendum to Tender notice no. JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-227
CORRIGENDUM No. 1
Tender Notice by Divisional Railway Manager (Works), Jhansi North Central Railway, Jhansi Number-JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-227 is to be opened on 09.11.2026 the following amendment is made in it.
Published e-Tender notice number : JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-207
Modified e-Tender notice number : JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-227
All other terms and conditions of the above e-tender notice will remain unchanged. **2337/26 (C)**
North central railways www.ncrindianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

उत्तर प्रदेश मेडिकल कौंसिल
5, सर्वपल्ली मॉल एवेन्यू रोड, लखनऊ।
सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि कार्यालय द्वारा जारी MBBS रजिस्ट्रेशन संख्या 41520 (6 माह) के लिये तत्काल प्रभाव से निलम्बित किया जाता है।
रजिस्ट्रार

UJVN Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJAWAL" Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road Dehradun 248006
Telephone: 0135 – 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: ujvnl.uk.gov.in

पत्र सं0: 981 दिनांक: 21 / 10 / 2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M- SHP), UJVN Ltd., Dharchula Pithoragarh, invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:
Tender No: 03/EE(E&M-SHP)/Dharchula/2026-27 : Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of 250KVA (320-480/ 415+-1%V) copper wound servo voltage stabilizer (servo) for 2x2.5MW Suringad Stage-II SHP in District Pithoragarh, Uttrakhand
Estimated cost : Rs. 23,27,500.00 /-, **Excluding GST**
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 21.10.2026
Last date for submission of tender:- 16.11.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "ujvnl.uk.gov.in".

Executive Engineer(E&M-SHP), Dharchula, Pithoragarh

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

राष्ट्रीय बौदधिक दिव्यांगजन सशक्तिकरण संस्थान (दिव्यांगजन)
NATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR THE EMPOWERMENT OF PERSONS WITH INTELLECTUAL DISABILITIES (DIVYANGJAN), SECUNDERABAD
दिव्यांगजन सशक्तिकरण विभाग, सामाजिक न्याय और अधिकारिता मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (Divyangjan)
Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Govt. of India
मनोविकास नगर, सिकंदराबाद / Manovikas Nagar, Secunderabad - 500 009

ISO 9001 Registered

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE NO.04/2026

NIEPID invites applications from eligible candidates for various positions against **regular vacancies as detailed below:**:

S. No.	Name of the post	No. of posts	Category
01	Lecturer in Rehabilitation Psychology, Level-10	01	EWS-PWD
02	Lecturer in Special Education, Level-10	01	ST
03	Rehabilitation Officer, Level-6	01	UR
04	Vocational Instructor, Level-6	01	UR

NIEPID also invite applications from eligible candidates for various contractual posts including Cross Disability Early Intervention Centre (CDEIC) at NIEPID, Secunderabad and its Regional Centre located at Noida and its Composite Regional Centres at Davangere- Karnataka, Nellore- Andhra Pradesh and Rajnandgaon – Chhattisgarh

For complete details and to download application forms, please visit Institute's website www.niepid.nic.in. Last date for submission of applications for regular position and for contractual (including CDEIC) is 07/12/2026. Any modifications/corrigendum in the above notification will be published on Institute's website only.

DIRECTOR

GUJARAT ENERGY TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
Registered & Corporate Office: Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Race Course, Vadodara – 390 007
website: www.getcogujarat.com

TENDER NOTICE NO. ACE (P&C):TN - 16: 2026-2027

[A] PROCUREMENT: Tender No. **(1) E-3126:** 132/33 kV 50 MVA Power Transformer.

[B] SUBSTATION: E-521: - Work of 400 kV & 220 kV Feeder Bays on EPC basis excluding civil work at 400 kV Soja S/s.

Above tenders are available on website **www.getcogujarat.com** (for view and download only) & **tender.nprocure.com** (For view, download and online tender submissions).

Note : Bidders are requested to be in touch with our websites till opening of these tenders.

Date: 22/10/2026 **Additional Chief Engineer (Procurement & Contracts)**

GANESH HOUSING LIMITED

(Formerly known as Ganesh Housing Corporation Limited)
[CIN: L45200GJ1991PLC015817]
Regd.Office : Ganesh Corporate House, 100 Feet Hebatpur-Thaltej Road, Nr. Sola Bridge, Off. S.G. Highway, Ahmedabad - 380 054
(P): +91 79 6160 8888 (W): www.ganeshhousing.com (E): secretarial@ganeshhousing.com

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL AHMEDABAD BENCH, AHMEDABAD

C.A. (CAA)/ 39 (AHM) 2026
In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 read with Sections 52 and 66 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013
and
In the matter of Scheme of Arrangement
between
Gatil Properties Private Limited ("Transferor Company")
and
Ganesh Housing Limited ("Transferee Company")
and
their respective shareholders

GANESH HOUSING LIMITED,
a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, and having its registered office at Ganesh Corporate House, 100 Feet Hebatpur – Thaltej Road, Near Sola Bridge, Off S.G. Highway, Ahmedabad – 380 054, Gujarat, India.
CIN: L45200GJ1991PLC015817

...APPLICANT NO. 2 / TRANSFEREE COMPANY

NOTICE AND ADVERTISEMENT OF NOTICE OF THE MEETING OF THE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS (WHICH CONSIST OF PUBLIC SHAREHOLDERS)

Notice is hereby given that by an order dated October 7, 2026, read with corrigendum order dated October 9, 2026 ("**Orders**"), the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Ahmedabad Bench ("**Hon'ble Tribunal**") has directed convening of the meeting of the equity shareholders of Ganesh Housing Limited (hereinafter

कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियंता
लोक निर्माण विभाग, राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संभाग, कोण्डागांव (छ०ग०)

Email-eenhkgn01@gmail.com

ज्ञापन क्रः 2119/व.ले.ति/2026-27 कोण्डागांव, दिनांकः 15/10/2026

सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्नलिखित निर्माण कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन (Online) निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैः-

क्र.	नि.आ.सू.क्र. एवं दिनांक	सिस्टम आई.डी. क्र.	अनुमानित लागत (GST छोड़कर) (राशि लाख में)	कार्य का नाम
1	04/EE/NH/ KGN /2026-27	2026_MoRTH_ 930527_1	1278.72	SHORT TERM MAINTE-NANCE CONTRACT (STMC) OF ROAD FROM KM. 81.500 to KM 180.000 (RAIPUR TO JAGDALPUR ROAD) TOTAL LENGTH 94.700 KM. OF NH-30 IN THE STATE OF CHHATTISGARH
2	05/EE/NH/ KGN /2026-27	2026_MoRTH_ 930528_1	917.46	SHORT TERM MAINTE-NANCE CONTRACT (STMC) OF ROAD FROM KM. 180.000 to KM 254.000 (RAIPUR TO JAGDALPUR ROAD) TOTAL LENGTH-74.00 KM. OF NH-30 IN THE STATE OF CHHATTISGARH

निविदा डाउनलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 13.11.2026 सायं 05:30 बजे तक है।

उपरोक्त निर्माण कार्यों की निविदा की सामान्य शर्तें, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञप्ति, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी सड़क परिवहन एवं राजमार्ग मंत्रालय (MoRTH) के ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट वेब पोर्टल https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app से डाउनलोड की जा सकती है।

कार्यपालन अभियंता।
लो.नि.वि. राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग संभाग
कोण्डागांव

NO 262704096/3

TENDER NOTICE

STATE INSTITUTE OF HOTEL MANAGEMENT

TITILAGARH ROAD, BALANGIR - 767001 (ODISHA)

NIT No.1103/SIHM/2026-27/E-TENDER Date: 16.10.2026

Sealed tenders are invited under the Two-Bid System from reputed firms/ agencies/companies/OEMs/authorized dealers/authorized distributors/ authorized channel partners having valid registrations and licenses for the Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, and Comprehensive On-site Warranty Support of an Enterprise Tower Server, Full HD (FHD)Monitor along with Windows Server 2022 Standard Operating System, Microsift SQL Server 2022 Standard Edition, and Server Antivirus (2-Year Subscription) for the State Institute of Hotel Management, Balangir.

The Last date for submission of E-Tender Documents is: 16.11.2026 by 05.00 P.M.

Interested parties may kindly visit the below mentioned website for further details:
www.tenderwizard.com/SIHM or www.sihmbalangir.org

Sd/-
Principal

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.

(भारत सरकार का नवरत्न उपक्रम) (A NAVRATNA UNDERTAKING OF GOVT. OF INDIA)

CONCOR Bhawan, C-3 Mathura Road, Opposite Apollo Hospital, New Delhi – 110 076

Open Tender Notice (e-Tendering mode only)

Online Open **E-bids** are invited through two packet Open tendering system for Supply of 48 modules of sub-assemblies for 25T axle load BLSS wagons. The complete bid document can only be downloaded from the website (**www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL**) during the tender sale period and the intending bidders should submit the document sale price of ₹ 1000.00 inclusive of all taxes and duties through e-payment at the time of making online request.

Bid Reference	CON/T/BLSS/Sub-Assembly Set/e-105696 /2026
Tendered Quantity	48 modules of sub-assemblies for BLSS wagon (As per "Schedule of Requirement" Clause 1.6 of of Section-II)
Bid Security (Earnest Money) Deposit	₹ 10,00,000/- (Ten Lakhs Only)
Cost of Document (Non-refundable)	₹ 1,000 through online payment gateway to CONCOR
Tender Processing fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3,540.00 (including GST @18%) Through online payment gateway to CONCOR.
Pre-Bid Meeting	Through Video Conference on 30.10.2026 at 11:30 hrs IST. For sharing the link, please send mail on EMAIL ID: -wagonmfg@concorindia.com upto 10:00 hrs of 30.10.2026 (IST)
Period of Tender Sale (online)	22.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs to 17.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date and time of Submission of Bid	17.11.2026 at 16:00 hrs.
Date and time of opening of Bid	18.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Place of Opening & Communication Address	GGM/P&S/AREA-III, Container Corporation of India Ltd, NSIC, MDBP Building, 3rdFloor, Okhla Industrial Estate, Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station, New Delhi-110020 Email: wagonmfg@concorindia.com

For Qualification Criteria, Experience with respect to nature of work etc please refer to detailed tender notice available on website **tenderwizard.com/CCIL, concorindia.co.in & eprocure.gov.in.** Further, Corrigendum/ Addendum to this tender, if any, will be published on said websites only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.

GGM/P&S/Area-III

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
भवन निर्माण विभाग
भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या-1,राँची

अति अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रण शुद्धि सूचना

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक–3257(अनु०) दिनांक–07.10.2026, पी०आर०संख्या–391301 Building(2026-27):D द्वारा आमंत्रित VERY SHORT TERM E-QUOTATION INVITATION NOTICE (FOR RATE PURPOSE ONLY) Quotation Reference No: BCD/Bld. Div. No.- 1 --- 19/2026-27 को अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
भवन निर्माण विभाग
भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या–1,राँची

PR 392146 Building(26-27).D

Office Of The Superintending Engineer
Civil Circle P.W.D. Haridwar

Website- http://pwd.uk.gov.in E-mail: sepharpwduk@gmail.com

Letter No. 2792/06C-Civil Circle/26 Dated: 21/10/2026

National Competitive Bidding (E-Tendering)

On behalf of **"Governor of Uttarakhand"**, Superintending Engineer, Civil Circle, PWD, Haridwar invites item rate bid through E-tendering under Two Bid system. All information related to tender will be available from 22.10.2026 and onwards on website **http://www.uktenders.gov.in**.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Earnest Money (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Tender (Rs.)	Time of Completion of work (Months)	Validity of Tender (Days)	Category of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Strengthening work of motor road from Bahadrabad Rohalki Tiraha to Alipur Sukrasa Pathri Ambuwala under Kumbh Mela Infrastructure Development 2027.	9.15	5000.00 + 18% GST	02 Months	90 Days	Registered in 'A' or above Category in Road works in Central Govt/ State Govt/any Govt undertaknng.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



MAJOR SAJJAN SINGH GAHLAWAT, SC
9 MADRAS (TRAVANCORE)

All ranks of TRAVANCORE TERRORS pay homage to Major SS Gahlawat, SC who made the supreme sacrifice while fighting terrorists in Surankote (J&K) on this day in 1997. We salute his brave deeds on the 29th anniversary of his martyrdom. You will always remain a source of inspiration for all of us.

Commanding Officer & All Ranks 9 MADRAS (TRAVANCORE)

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



SH RAVINDER SINGH, ASSISTANT COMMANDANT 41 BN BSF 16.08.1970 – 22.10.1999



CONSTABLE/ DRIVER BABU LAL 41 BN BSF 15.09.1969 – 22.10.1999



CONSTABLE FAROOQ AHMAD 41 BN BSF 08.11.1971 – 22.10.1999

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant officer Sh. Ravinder Singh, Assistant Commandant, Constable/Driver Babu Lal and Constable Farooq Ahmad on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED Blast in Srinagar area, J&K and later succumbed to their injuries at 92 base hospital.



HC/RO MUKESH LAL MEENA 193 BN BSF 01.07.1975 – 22.10.2013

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable/Radio Operator Mukesh Lal Meena on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in Counterpart firing in area of BOP Chinaz, R S Pura (Jammu) and later succumbed to his injuries.



CONSTABLE S S RAYAPPA 161 BN BSF 01.06.1968 – 22.10.2002

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable S S Rayappa on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in area of Dobasipara, Tura (Meghalaya) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



HEAD CONSTABLE MUKESH CHAND 16 BN BSF 14.03.1975 – 22.10.2019

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Mukesh Chand on his Balidan Diwas. On 16th Oct 2019, he sustained fatal injuries while on operational duty in area of BOP SP Ommen, Jammu and later succumbed to his injuries at Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Narayana Super Speciality hospital, Katra on 22 Oct 2019.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Head Constable Ajit Singh 38 Bn 25-4-1951 To 22-10-1996

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Ajit Singh of 38 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while countering an attack by insurgents in Assam on 22 October 1996. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DIRECTORATE OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT, MADHYA PRADESH

NARMADA ROAD, NEAR RAMPUR PETROL PUMP, JABALPUR-482001

e-mail: spiu.dsdmp@gmail.com, web site:- mpskills.gov.in

Phone No.- 0761-2666522

No. DSD/Tools/2026-27/5415 **Jabalpur, Date-15.10.2026**

INVITATION FOR BIDS

The Director, Skill Development, Narmada Road, Near Rampur petrol pump, Jabalpur M.P. invites Online bids (Two bid system) from Manufacturers or Authorized dealers for supply of Tools of various Trades for Industrial Training Institutes of Madhya Pradesh as below:

S. No.	Description	Earnest Money Deposit	Bid Document Price
01	Tools	INR 2100000/- (RsTwenty one lakh only)	INR 2500/- + Processing Fees

2. Kindly go through **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** for online e-tenders as per key dates as follows: -

S.No.	Particulars	Date & Time
1.	Bid Published Date	19.10.2026 16.00 PM
2.	Bid Document Download/Sale Start Date	19.10.2026 16.00 PM
3.	Pre bid Meeting at Directorate of Skill Development, M.P.,Bhopal Camp office, Gas ITI Building, 4th Floor, Govindpura Bhopal, M.P. 462023	23.10.2026 13.00 PM
4.	Bid Submission Start Date	02.11.2026 16.00 PM
5.	Bid Submission End Date	11.11.2026 16.00 PM
6.	Bid Opening Of The Technical Bids	12.11.2026 16.00 PM

Tender document and other details are available at the websites **https://www.mptenders.gov.in**

3 Cost of Tender {(Rs. 2500/-+Processing fee) Non refundable} is to be paid online only on **http:\\www.mptenders.gov.in**

4. The Manufacturers or their Authorized Dealers shall submit their Earnest Money Deposit is On-line to **https://www.mptenders.gov.in**

5. All Corrigendum/Amendments/Changes if any will only be issued and made available only on **https://www.mptenders.gov.in**

Sd/-
Director
Skill Development,
Madhya Pradesh Jabalpur

G-20380/26

बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिहारशरीफ

अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या – 01 SBD / 2026-27
(राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा)

(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट **www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in** पर)

1. कार्य का विवरण –

यूप सं.	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू० में)	अग्रधन की राशि (लाख रू० में) (ऑन लाईन अथवा फिजिकल / मैनुअल मोड में भुगतेय)	परिमाण – विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू० में	बेल्ट्रॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू० में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	पैमार सिंचाई योजनान्तर्गत बायीं मुख्य नहर के विभिन्न बिन्दुओं पर तटबंध सुदृढीकरण तथा आवश्यक नहर संरचनाओं के जीर्णोद्धार / मरम्मति का कार्य।	279.45813	5.59000	10000.00	5900.00	03 माह

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि : दिनांक –15.10.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि : दिनांक – 28.10.2026 से दिनांक – 04.11.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
4. प्री–बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि : दिनांक– 31.10.2026 को 3.00 बजे अपराह्न में, मुख्य अभियंता, सिंचाई सृजन, जल संसाधन विभाग, नालन्दा, बिहारशरीफ के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक – 06.11.2026, समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
6. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी । (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. निविदा खोलने का स्थान : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर ।
8. निविदा की वैधता अवधि : 120 दिन
9. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिहारशरीफ। मो०न०: 7463889411
10. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं wrd.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है ।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिहारशरीफ

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.013923 (WRD) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

North Eastern Railway

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work. **S.No.01 Name of work:** 25 KV Electrification Work in connection with Provision of shunt signal at NDJ instead of stop board for L/3 and up starter for line-04 to make it common loop & Provision of one dock goods shed running line (CSL 750 m) and shunting neck (CSL-750 m). **Tender reference no:** SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T40 **Approx. Cost (in Rs.):** 27577244.66 **Earnest Money:** Rs.551600/- **Cost of tender documents (in Rs):** Nil **E-Tender closing date and Time:** 12.11.2026 up to 14:45 Hrs. **Completion period:** 09 Months • Open E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 14:45 Hrs on date 12.11.2026 • For full details and submission of bid, kindly visit the Official website of Indian Railway i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr.DEE/TRD
Varanasi

CPRO/Elect-232

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.

Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
M.278	CE / MM	11 KV Polymer Composite Pin Insulators

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites **www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in**

DIPR/3188/Tender/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	RCNK-OPN-HCC-LHB-2026
Name of Work and its location	Tender for "Provision of High-Capacity Coupler & Feeder Cables in LHB Non-AC Coaches as per scope of work at RCNK/SNP".
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 73,50,939/- including GST (Rs. Seventy-Three Lakh Fifty Thousand Nine Hundred Thirty Nine Only)
Earnest Money	Rs 1,47,000.00/-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 12:00 hrs on 07/11/2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No. RCNK-OPN-HCC-LHB-2026 Dated: 16/10/2026 3652/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF CHEMICALS, CONSUMABLES AND REFERENCE MATERIAL FOR SMOOTH FUNCTIONING OF HIGH END EQUIPMENT (HEE) AT STATE FOOD LABORATORY, HARYANA, CHANDIGARH FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS	16.10.2026 06.11.2026	4,00,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	0172-478822 hmsctenders@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50363/HRY

Govt. of Bihar

Department of Environment, Forest & Climate change.

Patna Zoo Management and Development Society

TENDER NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

(Through e-Procurement mode only at https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

Short Notice Tender No: 11/e-PROC/PZMDS/2026-27

Online Bids are invited from Registered Indian firms/ artist firms/ agencies/ suppliers for the Installation of Selfie Points at different locations in the Zoo.

Sl. No.	Scope of work	Cost of tender document (In Rupees) (Online Mode) (Non-Refundable)	Tender processing Fee (Non-Refundable) (in Rupees)	Earnest Money Deposit (In Rupees) Online	Period
1	2	3	4	5	6
01.	Installation of Selfie Points at different locations in the Zoo.	Rs. 1,000/-	As per e-proc fees	Rs. 50,000/-	FY 2026-27

Tender Schedule/Programme:

Sl. No.	Activity	Date/Time : Duration
1.	Online Sale/Download date of Tender documents	From 21.10.2026 to 30.10.2026 (Upto 04:00 P.M.) (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
2.	Bid-clarification date and time	24.10.2026 - 4:00 P.M. (In the office of the Patna Zoo Management and Development Society situated at the Office of Director, Patna Zoo)
3.	Date/Time for Submission/ Uploading of offer/Bid	Till 30.10.2026 up to 5.00 P.M. (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
4.	Date & time for Opening of Technical Bid.	31.10.2026 at 3:00 P.M. (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) (In the office of the Director, Patna Zoo -cum-Secretary, Patna Zoo Management and Development Society)
5.	Contact Person/Nodal Officer for queries	Secretary, Patna Zoo Management and Development Society. Email: pzmds@bihar.gov.in
6.	Financial Bid Opening Date and Time	Date will be announced after evaluation of technical bid.

1- Detailed descriptions of the item and instructions for submitting your offer can be downloaded from e-Procurement Portal https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in or https://state.bihar.gov.in/ **forest or https://patnazoo.bihar.gov.in.**

2- To participate in the e-tendering process, the bidders are required to get registered by the service provider of e-tendering. The bidders are required to submit "Technical Bid" and "Financial Bid" separately through e-Procurement Portal (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in).

3- Bidders are advised to read the detailed Terms & conditions before submitting e-tender which can be downloaded from e-Procurement Portal **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in or** https://state.bihar.gov.in/ **forest or https://patnazoo.bihar.gov.in.**

4- A sum of Rs. 1,000/- being the cost of Tender document (non-refundable) has to be paid through e-payment mode (NEFT/RTGS, Net Banking, Credit/Debit Card) only.

5- Tender Processing Fee (TPF) amount applicable as per e-Proc Bid Processing Fee structure (non-refundable) has to be paid through e-payment mode (i.e. NEFT/RTGS, Internet Banking, Credit / Debit Card) only.

6- EMD amount has to be paid through online mode (i.e. Internet Payment Gateway) through e-payment Portal https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in only.

7- Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment Portal https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the NIT. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay/non-submission of Tender caused due to non-availability of Internet connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason.

8- Corrigendum/Addendum, if any, will be published on the departmental website https://state.bihar.gov.in/forest and e-procurement, Portal Bihar https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in

9- Note: Patna Zoo management reserves the right to accept/cancel/reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons.

Secretary,
Patna Zoo Management and Development Society.

PR. No. 014053 (Env. & Forest) 2026-27

This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also

अपने जीवन साथी के प्रति वफादार रहें,
किसी अनजान स्त्री/पुरूष से असुरक्षित यौन संबंध से बचें।

Govt. of Bihar

BIHAR STATE POWER (HOLDING) COMPANY LTD., PATNA

Office of the Chief Engineer (Civil),

3rd floor, link portion of Vidyut Bhawan, Nehru Path, Patna.

Contact No :- 7763813835, cecivilbsphclpatna@gmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

NIT No. - 29/PR/BSPHCL/2026

Tender are invited by Chief Engineer (Civil), from eligible and experienced Agency/Firm/Company/ State or Central Govt. Undertaking who have necessary experience, for the work noted below-

Sl. No.	Name of Work	E.M.D (Rs.)	Tender Fees	Completion time
1.	DEVELOPMENT, OPERATION AND MANAGEMENT OF CAFETERIA ON GROUND FLOOR, BREDA BUILDING (G+6) AT BSPHCL COLONY, PUNAICHAK, PATNA.	Rs. 1,00,000/-	Rs. 11,800/-	36 Months (3 Years)

Bid submission Start Date and Time:	**02.11.2026.(from 10.00 A.M.)** through website *https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in*
Bid submission End Date and Time:	**Up to 24.11.2026.(up to 1.00 P.M.)** through website *https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in*
Submission of Original DD/BG:	**Up to 25.11.2026 (up to 3:00 PM)** in the office of Chief Engineer (Civil), BSPHCL, Vidyut Bhawan, Patna.
Date of opening of Technical Part: -	**25.11.2026 at 3:30 PM** through website *https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in*
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting :-	**04.11.2026 at 3:00PM** in the office of Chief Engineer (Civil), BSPHCL, Vidyut Bhawan, Patna.
Date of opening of price part:	To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation through website *https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in*

1. Tender Processing Fee & Tender Fee is mandatory to be paid through online mode, i.e., internet payment gateway (Credit/Debit), Net banking, NEFT/RTGS to BSPHCL, Patna.
2. EMD shall be paid in the form of Bank Guarantee (BG) or through online mode, i.e., internet payment gateway (Credit/Debit), Net banking, NEFT/RTGS to BSPHCL, Patna.
3. Bid processing fee as mentioned in website https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in will be paid through online mode i.e. internet payment gateway (Credit/debit), Net banking, NEFT/RTGS to BSPHCL, Patna.
4. In case of submission of EMD Cost through DD/ BG, Original Demand Draft/ BG will be submitted in the office of **Chief Engineer (Civil), BSPHCL, Vidyut Bhawan, Patna** up to **25.11.2026** at **3.00 PM**.
5. Tender may be cancelled at any stage by the competent authority without assigning any reason.
6. The department doesn't take any responsibility for the delay/non-submission of tender/non-reconciliation of online payment caused due to non-availability of internet connection, network traffic/holidays or any other reasons.
7. Estimated Cost may increase or decrease in BOQ and bidder have to submit EMD cost accordingly.
8. Tender document along with General/special condition, bids and any corrigendum/ addendum of the tender are available only at website**https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**.

"विवादों के निष्पादन के लिए लोकअदालत का लाभउठावें।" "परस्परसहमति से न्यायिकनिर्णय करें।" "समय एवं खर्च की बचत करें।

Chief Engineer (Civil)
BSP(H)CL

PR. No. 014060 (B&C) 2026-27

This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also

अपने जीवन साथी के प्रति वफादार रहें,
किसी अनजान स्त्री/पुरूष से असुरक्षित यौन संबंध से बचें।

E-Tender
PRESS NOTICE
Office of the Principal Sir Chhotu Ram Government College for Women Sampla

Notice Inviting Tender

Ref. No. GCWS/2026/ETCH/2651 **DATED 21.10.2026.**

Online tenders under two bid system (Technical and Financial Bid) through website https://etenders.hry.nic.in are invited from the eligible Contractor/Service Agency/Cooperative Labour and Construction Societies (approved by Government of Haryana) for the work detailed in the table.

Particulars of the work	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Tender Document Fee	Approx. Cost	Time Period	Tender Download Start Date	Time and Last date of Submission of Tender Documents	Tender Opening Date
Cleaning of Premises and Housekeeping etc. Services	25000/- (Refundable)	500/- (Non-Refundable)	25 Lakhs	12 Months	27.10.2026	10.11.2026 till 5:00 pm	12.11.2026

1. The bidder should have minimum consecutive three years' experience in similar services.
2. Pre-bid meeting will be held on 31.10.2026 at 10:00 am in the office of the Principal Sir Chhotu Ram Government College for Women Sampla.
3. Bidders shall pay Rs. 1180/- (including GST) the E-Service fee through Net Banking in favour of "**Society for IT initiative fund for e-Governance**" payable at Chandigarh.
4. For Further details and e-tendering schedule visit the website **https://etenders.hry.nic.in**.

Sd/-
Principal
Govt. College
for Women Sampla, Rohtak

No. 50376/HRY

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा।

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई–निविदा संख्या– **02/2026-27/RWD/CHATRA** दिनांक– **21.10.2026**

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा द्वारा जिला खनिज फाउण्डेशन ट्रस्ट (DMFT) मद अन्तर्गत् निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र.सं.	आईडेन्टिफिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	पंचायत / ग्राम	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रूपये में) अंक में	प्राक्कलित राशि (रूपये में) अक्षर में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	कॉल सं.
1	RWD/ CHATRA/02/ 2026-27	लावालौंग	रिमी / रिमी	Maintenance of Road from Haldipur More to Kukurmarwa (Length- 9.300 KM)	36421600.00	तीन करोड़ चौंसठ लाख इक्कीस हजार छः सौ मात्र	18 माह	प्रथम

2. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :– **28.10.2026**
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :– **18.11.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।**
4. ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– **20.11.2026 अपराह्न 3.30 बजे।**
5. ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :– **कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा, द्वितीय तल, विकास भवन, चतरा।**
6. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष संख्या :– 06541-296208
7. यदि बिडर / निविदादाता का कोई कार्य अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय अथवा किसी भी अन्य विभाग में पिछले 06 (छः) माह से अधिक लंबित पाया जाता है तो उसकी निविदा को प्राथमिकता नहीं दी जायेगी।
8. किसी भी परिस्थिति में बिडर / निविदादाता के तकनीकी बिड खुलने / स्वीकृत होने के उपरान्त ई–निविदा से वापस होने पर बिडर / निविदादाता के विरूद्ध SBD के नियमानुसार कार्रवाई की जायेगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट **www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in** में देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा।

PR 392138 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



FOSTIIMA - PANEL DISCUSSION

FOSTIIMA Business School hosted an insightful panel discussion titled "Decoding the Executive Persona: What HR Considers Beyond a High GPA and a Flawless Resume" on October 16, 2026. The panel featured Ms. Shweta Goela, AVP, Safexpress Pvt. Ltd.; Mr. Nitin Mishra, Head of Talent Acquisition, Cushman & Wakefield; and Ms. Srishti Wadhwa, Head of Talent Acquisition, Yamaha Motors Solutions India. Moderated by Dr. Aditya Vij, Director, FOSTIIMA Business School, the discussion explored qualities employers value beyond academic achievements, including effective communication, adaptability, emotional intelligence, leadership potential, cultural alignment and a growth mindset. The session provided students with practical insights into corporate expectations and essential skills for building successful, future-ready careers.



AMITY UNIVERSITY - EVENT

Amity Educational Resource Centre organised the 17th Amity International Model United Nations (AIMUN 2026) from October 14–16 at Amity University Noida, themed "Youth Leadership is the Future of the World". Around 500 participants from India and abroad attended. H.E. Jean-Eric Paquet, Ambassador-designate of the European Union to India, inaugurated the event, emphasising international cooperation and youth leadership. Dr. Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools, highlighted AIMUN's role in nurturing future leaders, while Ms. Oh Jin-hee, Deputy Chief of Mission, Embassy of the Republic of Korea, stressed collaboration. Daniel Obst received the Young Noble Peace Prize 2026 for promoting intercultural understanding and youth development.



GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY - AWARD

Galgotias University received the "Excellence in Industry-Aligned Curriculum and Employability" award at the 36th Elets World Education Summit 2026, recognising its commitment to employability and entrepreneurship. Dr. Rabindra Narayan Behera, Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) and IIT Council member, presented the award. The recognition follows the University's honour at the Times Now Education Summit 2026 for "Excellence in Industry-Aligned Curriculum & Student Entrepreneurship Ecosystem", presented by Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya. Collaborations with Accenture LearnVantage, IBM, L&T EduTech, Tata Technologies, Microsoft and byteXL integrate industry expertise into education. CEO Dr. Dhruv Galgotia reaffirmed the University's commitment to practical skills, confidence and entrepreneurial development.



KIET UNIVERSITY - EVENT

KIET School of Management (KSOM), KIET (Deemed to be University), Ghaziabad, hosted CII – Majestic Skill Will Lead, Edition VII, bringing together student teams from six institutions to present solutions to contemporary business challenges. The event was organised under the leadership of Prof. Nagaraj Ramrao, Vice-Chancellor, and Dr Manoj Goel, Pro Vice-Chancellor. Mr Mahesh Munjal, Convenor, CII WUP Industry Academia Skill Panel and Vice Chairman, CII WUP Zone, delivered the opening remarks. Led by Prof. (Dr.) Binkey Srivastava, Dean, KSOM, the event featured judges Ms Monica Singh, Mr Charit Kishore and Mr Bharat Khetan, promoting experiential learning, managerial skills and industry–academia collaboration.



SUSHANT UNIVERSITY - CELEBRATIONS

Sushant School of Art and Architecture, Sushant University, Gurugram, celebrated World Architecture Day on 5 October 2026 at India International Centre, New Delhi, under the theme "Sushant 2049: Blueprint for Tomorrow." The event honoured architects Raj Rewal, Ram Sharma and Sushant Verma with the Legendary Practitioner, Illustrious Visionary and Design Vanguard awards, respectively. An invited talk by alumnus Ar. Gaurang Khemka and a panel discussion featuring eminent architects explored future architectural skills, artificial intelligence, technology and sustainability. Dean Dr. Navin Piplani presented the School's vision for 2049, emphasising innovation, academic excellence and preparing future architects to contribute to a sustainable, net-zero future.



ITS ENGINEERING COLLEGE - EVENT

The College under the leadership of Dr. Mayank Garg, Director, is hosting TechTrix'26, a national-level Technology, Innovation and Entrepreneurship Festival, from 22–24 October 2026. Featuring 20 competitions across technology, robotics, coding, gaming, innovation and entrepreneurship, the festival offers a prize pool of 18.62 lakh. The initiative builds on the success of TechTrix'25, which attracted over 1,650 participants, 35 schools and 20 startups. Supported by AKTU, Innovation Hub and Start in U.P., TechTrix'26 aims to strengthen innovation, industry–academia collaboration and entrepreneurial thinking among young innovators across the country.



HRIT UNIVERSITY - EVENT

UPRISE 2026, a flagship initiative of the Government of Uttar Pradesh in collaboration with Times Network, aims to empower students under the theme "Samvad. Sankalp. Safalta." The initiative connects students with startup funding, employment opportunities, industry mentors and potential investors. Under the CM-YUVA Scheme, eligible students can access collateral-free loans of up to 5 lakh to support innovative business ideas. The programme was facilitated at the university under the guidance of Chancellor Dr. Anil Agrawal, Pro Chancellor Dr. Anjul Aggarwal, Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) D.K. Sharma and Registrar Prof. (Dr.) Vinod Kumar, with Training and Placement Head Mr. Ankur Aggarwal strengthening industry linkages.



TIET - AWARD

Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology (TIET) has won two honours at the FICCI Higher Education Excellence Awards 2026—University of the Year and Excellence in Digital Transformation. Announced on 8 October at the 21st FICCI Higher Education Summit in New Delhi, the awards recognise TIET's contributions to academic excellence, research, innovation and artificial intelligence integration in education. The recognition coincides with the institute's 70th Founders' Day. Prof. Padmakumar Nair, Vice Chancellor, TIET, reiterated the institute's commitment to excellence and nurturing students with sound judgement, critical thinking and the skills to thrive in an evolving world.



FOSTIIMA - EVENT

FOSTIIMA Business School's student-driven Finance Committee, guided by Dr. Ritika Arora, organised a two-day event, 'Fun with Finance', to make financial learning interactive. The first day featured a qualifying round assessing students' financial knowledge. The second day included Finance Extempore, testing spontaneity and public speaking; Finance Charades, promoting teamwork through financial terminology; and a presentation round analysing companies' green and red flags. The event encouraged analytical thinking, business awareness, teamwork and communication, bridging theory with practice. Chairman Mr. Anil Somani and faculty members motivated students to explore finance beyond textbooks and develop essential managerial skills.

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED

(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

BY POST

Date: 21.10.2026

To,

1	**RAM DARESH MAHTO (Borrower/Mortgagor) K-317, GALI NO-6 PREM NAGAR-2, KIRARI SULEMAN NAGAR, SULTANPURI C BLOCK, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI – 110086** **Email ID: RAMMAHTO686@GMAIL.COM** **Mobile No.: 9910824003**	2	**SANJU (Co-Borrower I) K-317, GALI NO-6 PREM NAGAR-2, KIRARI SULEMAN NAGAR, SULTANPURI C BLOCK, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI – 110086** **Email ID: RAMMAHTO686@GMAIL.COM** **Mobile No.: 9654598966**

Subject: Notice for Removal of Your Movable Articles Within Seven Days- Property Sold under the SARFAESI Act

Reference: PROPERT BEARING NO. K – 317 (MEASURING 58.52. SQ. MT. (70 SQ. YDS. APPROX.) OUT OF KHASRA NO. 1211, SITUATED AT COLONY PREM NAGAR, K BLOCK, GALI NO. 6, NANGLOI, VILLAGE KIRARI SULEMAN NAGAR, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI – 110086

Dear Sir/Madam,

This is to inform you that the Axis Finance Authorised Officer has taken physical possession of the captioned property on 14th October 2026 and published the same on 16th October 2026 in Indian Express and Jansatta under the provisions of the SARFAESI Act, 2002.

At the time of taking physical possession, it has been observed that certain movable assets/articles belonging to you are still lying within the said property. You are hereby called upon to remove all your belongings, inventory, and movable assets from the premises within seven (7) days from the date of receipt of this letter.

Please take note that in case you fail to remove the said items within the stipulated period, the Axis Finance shall not be responsible for their safety, custody, loss, or damage thereafter, and no claim in this regard shall be entertained.

This may be treated as a final and urgent notice.

This communication is issued without prejudice to the Bank's rights and remedies available under the SARFAESI Act, 2002 and other applicable laws.

Authorized Officer
Axis Finance Limited

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, PHED, REGION AJMER

PHONE NO. 0145-2624748 **Email-aceregionajmer@gmail.com**
No. F.()/Ar.MP/2026-2027/12119-12168 **Dated: 13/10/26**

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS FOR WORKS

Bids for the Augmentation of Urban Water Supply Scheme for Kuchera town district Nagaur Rajasthan under AMRUT-2.0 Mission including 05 years O&M after 01 year Defect Liability Period (NIT No.09/2026-27; Estimated Cost Rs.1218.00 Lacs) are invited from interested bidders up to 03.11.2026 Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state.

UBN NO. PHE 2627WSOB06622
NIB No. PHE 2627 A3145

Sd/-
(Jagdish Prasad Sharma)
Addlitional Chief Enginer
PHED, Region, Ajmer

DIPR/C/17768/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

INDIAN RAILWAY

PUBLIC NOTIFICATION

Notice is given to all user of Railway line and premises situated on the completed section between Kosi Kalan and Hodal Railway Stations of North Central Railway, 2x25 kV Kotwan SSP will be energized on or after **22.10.2026** in the following section around the Railway line. On or from this date the overhead line will at all times be treated as a live line and no unauthorized person shall approach or work in the proximity of the said overhead line.

Date of Energization: 22.10.2026

S. N.	Section	KM/Location/Chainage From	To
1.	Energization of New 2x25 KV Kotwan SSP in connection with raising of speed to 160 Kmph/200 Kmph. Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 132/2x25 kV Traction Sub-station along with SP/SSPs between Palwal-Mathura on existing New Delhi- Mumbai Route of North Central Railway.	Kotwan Km 1444/9B (Chainage 1444/284.09)	Kotwan Km. 1444/15AT (Chainage 1444/371.74)

2398/26(A)

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Project
North Central Rafway, Prayagraj

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

NIT No. Corrigendum No 1	401695-RCNK-Elect-ISO-202 Corrigendum Publish Date 21/10/2026
Name of Work and its location	Tender for "Re-Certification of ISO 3834-2:2021/Latest Quality Requirements for Fusion Welding of Metallic Materials including Documentation, Internal Auditing, Certification and Surveillance Auditing at RCNK (as per scope of work)."
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 1,34,631.19/- including GST (Rs. One Lakh Thirty Four Thousand Six Hundred Thirty One and Nineteen Paisa Only)
Earnest Money	Rs 2,700.00/-
Completion period of work	36 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 12:00 hrs on **14/11/2026**
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No. 401695-RCNK-Elect-ISO-202 Dated: 21/10/2026 3656/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED

(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

APPENDIX IV
[See Rule 8(I)]
SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
(For immovable property)
[As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]

Whereas,

The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the **Axis Finance Limited (AFL)**, under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of Powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with the Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand notice dated **12th August, 2026** calling upon the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s)

1	**Mr. Manish Chaudhary (Borrower)** C-12 528, C-Block, Yamuna Vihar, North East Delhi, Delhi-110053 **Also at:** B37, Sholtu, Kinnaur, Himachal Pradesh-172104 **Email ID:** npti.manish20@gmail.com **Mob. No.:** 9481774359	2	**Mrs. Renu Dhama (Co-Borrower I / Mortgagor)** C-12 528, C-Block, Yamuna Vihar, North East Delhi, Delhi-110053 **Also at:** B37, Sholtu, Kinnaur, Himachal Pradesh-172104 **Also at:** House No. 09, area measuring 190.05 sq. mtrs., comprised in Khasra No.0/906/0 As per DDA, Khasra No. 76/6/1/1, situated at Ajit Vihar, Burari Garhi, Near Ajit Vihar Chowk, Village Burari, Delhi-110084 **Email ID:** npti.manish20@gmail.com **Mob. No.:** 9481774359

*(Hereinafter collectively referred **as "Borrowers"**)*

who have mortgaged the property more particularly described hereunder to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **INR. 67,73,131/- (Rupees Sixty Seven Lakhs Seventy Three Thousand One Hundred Thirty One Only) due as on 10th August 2026** with further interest at the contractual rate thereon till the date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Symbolic Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this **19TH** day of **October** of the year **2026**.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Finance Limited for an amount of **INR. 67,73,131/- (Rupees Sixty Seven Lakhs Seventy Three Thousand One Hundred Thirty One Only) due as on 10th August 2026** and further interest thereon at the contractual rates together with costs, charges, etc. of Axis Finance Ltd until the full payment or realization in full.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgagor(s) attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) & sub section (13) of section 13 of the said Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Property details –
ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF PROPERTY BEING HOUSE NO. 09, AREA MEASURING 190.05 SQ. MTRS., COMPRISED IN KHASRA NO. 0/906/0 (AS PER DDA) KHASRA NO. 76/6/1/1, SITUATED AT AJIT VIHAR BURARI GARHI, NEAR AJIT VIHAR CHOWK, VILLAGE BURARI, DELHI-110084
BOUNDED BY:

EAST	:	**ROAD 25 FT**
WEST	:	**OTHER PROPERTY & GALI 10 FT**
NORTH	:	**GALI 10 FT**
SOUTH	:	**ROAD 20 FT**

Date: 19.10.2026
Place: Delhi

Authorized Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922- 234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 23-09-2026, one person namely Sunil Dutt S/O Yog Raj R/O Village Maha Bhatti Near Primary School, Post Of&ice Maha Tehsil and District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Lakhanpur stating therein that on 22-09-2026 his daughter namely Akshara, age 18 years went missing from home. The complainant and other family members made every possible effort to trace her whereabouts, but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DDR No. 29 dated 23-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Lakhanpur.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still untraced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody

having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

Description Roll :-

PHOTOGRAPH



- **Name** **Akshara**
- **Father** **Sunil Dutt**
- **Permanent Address** **Village Maha Bhatti**
- **Present Addres** **Village Maha Bhatti**
- **Tehsi** **Kathua**
- **Police Station** **Lakhanpur**
- **Age** **18 years**
- **Height** **05 feet**
- **Complexion** **Light Brown**
- **Built** **Normal**
- **Face** **Oval**
- **Eyes** **Black**
- **Languages known** **Hindi/ Dogri**

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Lakhanpur – 9186316017

Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua.

DIP/J-12827/26- DATE 21 OCT 2026

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED

(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)

E-Auction Notice of **15 days** for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the below mentioned Borrower and/ Co- Borrower, or their legal heirs/representatives (Borrowers) that the below described immovable property mortgaged to Axis Finance Ltd. (AFL), the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AFL, will be sold **on 12-11-2026 on "As is where is" & "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" and without any recourse basis"** for recovery of outstanding dues from below mentioned Borrower and Co-Borrowers. The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit is mentioned below. Notice is hereby given that, in the absence of any postponement/ discontinuance of the sale, the said secured asset / property shall be sold by E- Auction at 2.00 P.M. on the said **12-11-2026.** The sealed envelope containing Demand Draft of EMD for participating in E- Auction shall be submitted to the Authorised Officer of the AFL on or before **11.11.2026** till 4.00 PM at Branch address **AXIS FINANCE LIMITED**, Office (Axis Finance Limited I At C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025.

The sale of the Secured Asset/ Immovable Property will be on "as is where condition is" as per brief particulars described herein below ;

Sr. No	Loan A/c. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) Legal Heir(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Auction date	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 17.10.2026
1	0456MLA00000635	RAM DARESH MAHTO (Borrower cum Mortgagor) SANJU (Co- Borrower 1)	29.12.2025 Rs. 35,84,096 /-(Rupees Thirty Five Lacs Eighty Four Thousand and Ninety Six Only) (exclusive of TDS Calculation and Pre-Payment Charges, as applicable) due as on 05.02.2025	12.11.2026	Rs. 39,03,795/- (Rupees Thirty-Nine Lakh Three Thousand Seven Hundred Ninety-Five Only) EMD (10% of RP) Rs. 3,90,379/- (Rupees Three Lakh Ninety Thousand Three Hundred Seventy-Nine Only)	Rs. 39,76,449 (Rupees Thirty-Nine Lakh Seventy-Six Thousand Four Hundred Forty-Nine Only)
				Possession: Physical	10.03.2026	

Details of Secured Assets
PROPERT BEARING NO. K – 317 (MEASURING 58.52. SQ. MT. (70 SQ. YDS. APPROX.) OUT OF KHASRA NO. 1211, SITUATED AT COLONY PREM NAGAR, K BLOCK, GALI NO. 6, NANGLOI, VILLAGE KIRARI SULEMAN NAGAR, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI – 110086 And Boundaries of the House / Plot:
EAST – 15 FT. ROAD **WEST – OTHERS PLOT**
NORTH – OTHERS PLOT **SOUTH – 15 FT. ROAD**

Note :- The bidders are advised to conduct due diligence before submitting the bid. The auction shall be subject to the outcome of the litigation, Dispute if any.

At the Auction, the public generally is invited to submit their bid(s) personally. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the Immovable Property sold.

The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and the terms and conditions prescribed :

The E-auction of the properties will take place through portal on Auction Tiger _between 2.00 PM to 3.00 PM with limited extension of 5 minutes each.

Place: Delhi
Date :22.10.2026
Contact Person:
Mr. Ayan Bhattacharya: 9811710558

Sd/-
Authorised Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.

Registered Address: At C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025.
CIN No. U65921MH1995PLC212675.
Branch Address:

दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०

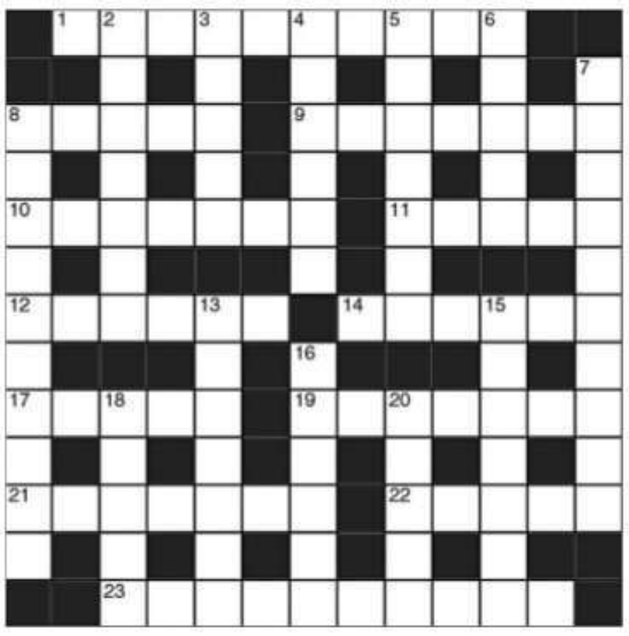
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत कार्यशाला मण्डल आगरा

पत्रांक: 25731 अधी०अभि०(कार्यशाला०) द०वि०वि०नि०लि०/ जैम बिड सूचना **दिनांक: 21.10.2026**

1. **जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8165092**:– विद्युत कार्यशाला खण्ड, आगरा के अन्तर्गत विभागीय कार्यशाला मथुरा पर 10/16 के०वी०ए० सिंगल फेज एल्यु० वाउण्ड से 630 के०वी०ए० थ्री फेज कॉपर वाउण्ड क्षमता तक के क्षतिग्रस्त वितरण परिवर्तकों की मरम्मत का कार्य। विड प्रपत्र निःशुल्क एवं ई०एम०डी० धनराशि रू० 30,000.00, अनुमानित मूल्य रू० 30,000.00 (जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त) बिड आवेदन की अन्तिम तिथि 28.10.2026, समय 13:00 बजें।
2. **जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8175268**:– विद्युत कार्यशाला खण्ड, कानपुर के अन्तर्गत विभागीय कार्यशाला फरुर्खाबाद पर 10/16 के०वी०ए० सिंगल फेज एल्यु० वाउण्ड से 630 के०वी०ए० थ्री फेज कॉपर वाउण्ड क्षमता तक के क्षतिग्रस्त वितरण परिवर्तकों की मरम्मत का कार्य। बिड प्रपत्र निःशुल्क एवं ई०एम०डी० धनराशि रू0 20,000.00, अनुमानित मूल्य रू० 20,00,000.00 (जी०एस०टी० अत्तिरिक्त) बिड आवेदन की अन्तिम तिथि 28.10.2026, समय 13:00 बजें।
3. **जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8175510**:– विद्युत कार्यशाला खण्ड, झांसी के अन्तर्गत विभागीय कार्यशाला झांसी पर 10/16 के०वी०ए० सिंगल फेज एल्यु० वाउण्ड से 630 के०वी०ए० थ्री फेज कॉपर वाउण्ड क्षमता तक के क्षतिग्रस्त वितरण परिवर्तकों की मरम्मत का कार्य। विड प्रपत्र निःशुल्क एवं ई०एम०डी० धनराशि रू0 25,000.00, अनुमानित मूल्य रू० 25,00,000.00 (जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त) बिड आवेदन की अन्तिम तिथि 28.10.2026, समय 14:00 बजे ।
4. **जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8175693**:– विद्युत कार्यशाला खण्ड, झांसी के अन्तर्गत विभागीय कार्यशाला उरई (जालौन) पर 10/16 के०वी०ए० सिंगल फेज एल्यु० वाउण्ड से 630 के०वी०ए० थ्री फेज कॉपर वाउण्ड क्षमता तक के क्षतिग्रस्त वितरण परिवर्तकों की मरम्मत का कार्य। बिड प्रपत्र निःशुल्क एवं ई०एम०डी० धनराशि रू० 25,000.00, अनुमानित मूल्य रू० 25,00,000.00 (जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त) बिड आवेदन की अन्तिम तिथि 28.10.2026, समय 14:00 बजे।

विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेवसाइट **https://gem.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएं वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएंगी।

CROSSWORD 6126



ACROSS

1 Theatre directors? (10)
8 Not intended to violate (5)
9 Bound to be against punishment (7)
10 Sound your horn with regret; that's a fact! (3,4)
11 One-man woman (5)
12 Make an appointment about four in case (6)
14 The man goes out in the country air (6)
17 Snake seen in summer? (5)
19 Simon is upset by this job (7)
21 The pictures added skill to the author's material (7)
22 Speeds back in these cars (5)
23 Share out is tried but as an alternative (10)

DOWN

2 Porter takes in work despite order to go on striking (4,3)
3 Keen to mature without hesitation (5)
4 He attacks the copper with acid (6)
5 One isn't put out by it but it's a strain (7)
6 She goes round in a radiant glow (5)
7 Settles but I need terms renegotiated (10)
8 Taking money out for retirement (10)
13 More than one kind of saviour (7)
15 A reduction in capital cover (7)
16 The object of his match is a draw (6)
18 A bit past it but still invited out (5)
20 Brush and clean thoroughly (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6125 **ACROSS:** 1 Errata, 4 Credit, 9 Theatre, 10 Idler, 11 Rayon, 12 Emerged, 13 Electricity, 18 Diarist, 20 Picot, 22 Ounce, 23 Orotund, 24 Tureen, 25 Tsetse **DOWN:** 1 Enters, 2 Reedy, 3 Titanic, 5 Raise, 6 Delight, 7 Tirade, 8 Desecration, 14 Learner, 15 Captors, 16 Adroit, 17 Stodge, 19 Irene, 21 Count

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Never ___ ___. When everyone's mind is dulled or distracted the leader must be doubly vigilant. - Colin Powell (7,7)

GSEEE

EILLNT

VAIST

CLUDGE

SOLUTIONS: Geese, Vista, Lintel/Lentil, Cudgel
ANSWER: Never **neglect details**. When every one's mind is dulled or distracted the leader must be doubly vigilant. - Colin Powell

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6479

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

					9			6
		4	2			8	1	
3							4	
2	5						6	
			5	1	6			
	8						3	7
	2							5
	6	7			5	9		
5			8					

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6478

4	6	9	2	3	5	8	7	1
7	5	1	4	9	8	2	3	6
2	3	8	7	6	1	4	9	5
8	7	4	3	2	6	1	5	9
6	2	3	1	5	9	7	8	4
1	9	5	8	7	4	3	6	2
9	4	2	6	8	7	5	1	3
5	1	7	9	4	3	6	2	8
3	8	6	5	1	2	9	4	7

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a great day to make art, which is good news for your sign because so many of you are artisans. Enjoy time alone today, and give yourself the luxury of doing what you want to do. Tonight: Relax.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a great day to chat. Relations with friends, members of groups and those who are close to you will be warm and chatty today. You want to share ideas, and you also want to hear what's happening with others. Tonight: Be friendly.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): People will notice you today, and are more inclined than usual to listen to you. Fortunately, you like to communicate your ideas! You also like to know what's going on. Cooperate with co-workers. Tonight: Make an impression on someone.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Although you are basically, a nester, obviously, you do travel. Today might be one of those days. You're keen to do something to break free of your routine. You want to learn something new. You also might teach young minds today. Tonight: Think big!

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Put on your thinking cap and explore ideas about solidifying your home base in a practical way. Family discussions might take place. You might be interested in home repairs. Put in the effort to improve your living space. Tonight: Catch up on paperwork.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today you might have to go more than halfway when dealing with others because the Moon is opposite your sign. You can talk to people today in a convincing way. You also might teach or learn something new that is thought-provoking. Tonight: Cooperate.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Roll up your sleeves today and get stuff done. This could relate to your job, health or a pet. You're thinking more about moneymaking ideas lately. And you're spending money! Tonight: Work.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You're in a creative frame of mind today. This is a great day to express your creative talents through the arts or arts and crafts. It's also a great day to chat and explore flirtatious possibilities! Shop for wardrobe treasures. Tonight: Play.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today is a mixed bag. You're keen to talk to others and interact with groups and organisations. You'll also be glad to relax at home and enjoy familiar surroundings. You might want to make travel plans for the future. Tonight: Relax at home.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Others admire you now because you look good to everyone. Today in particular, exchanges with younger people as well as creative artistic types will go well. Others are ready to jump on your bandwagon. Tonight: An interesting discussion.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Respect your moneymaking ideas today. Discussions with parents, bosses and authority figures will go well. Be patient with spouses and loved ones. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a great day for artistic projects and doing anything that will expand your mind. You'll also feel rewarded if you have an opportunity to help someone. You're ready to reach out to others today. Tonight: You're strong.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mahesh Kumar S/o** Joginder Singh **R/o** H.No. 31A, Gali No.-12, Hari Das Nagar, Jharoda Kalan, Dwarka, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 0434/2019, U/S 411 IPC, PS Rani Bagh, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mahesh Kumar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mahesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Mahesh Kumar** the said accused of **E-FIR No. 0434/2019, U/S 411 IPC, PS Rani Bagh, Outer Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
(North-West) Room No.-101, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15070/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Manoj S/o** Asha Ram, **R/o** H.No. 105/2 Gali No. 9 Kishan Kunj Laxmi Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 17001/25, U/s: 305 (B) 317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Geeta Colony, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manoj,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manoj,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Manoj,** of **FIR No. 17001/25, U/s: 305 (B) 317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Geeta Colony, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026**.

By Order
Prerna Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
East District Court No. 15
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14322/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Raja S/o** Dilip Kumar **R/o:** H.No. 96/97, Vishal Chaudhary Ka Makan, Sarai Kale Khan, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CR CASE No. 10261/25, FIR No. 393/2024, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Sunlight Colony, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Raja,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Raja,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Raja,** of **CR CASE No. 10261/25, FIR No. 393/2024, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS: Sunlight Colony, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026.**

By Order
Divyam Lila
Judicial Magistrarte First Class-07
South East District Room No. 508
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/14153/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Hariom Sharma S/o** Prakash Sharma **R/o** 1174, Gali No-12 Near V-2 Mall, Kapashera, South West Delhi, **Also at:** Village Choola, Distt.-Alwar, Rajasthan, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 90/2025, Dt.: 28.05.2025, U/S 4(C) DPT & MT Act, PS Domestic Airport, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Hariom Sharma** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Hariom Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Hariom Sharma** the said accused of **FIR No. 90/2025, Dt.: 28.05.2025, U/S 4(C) DPT & MT Act, PS Domestic Airport, New Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.01.2027.**

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09,
South-West Distt., Court No.-314,
District Courts Dwarka, New Delhi

DP/14966/IGIA/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sheetal W/o** Dharma **R/o** Gali No.-2, Milan Vihar Near Laxmi Ashram, Burari, Wazirabad, North Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CR Case No. 16130/2023, PS Wazirabad, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheetal** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheetal** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sheetal** the said accused of **CR Case No. 16130/2023, PS Wazirabad, North Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026**

By Order
Sh. Aakash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12,
(Central), Court No.-264, 2nd Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/15118/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 82 CR.P.C./ 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Manju** W/o Sanjay H. No. Jhuggi No. 101/135, CD Park, Jahangir Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 887/2021 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manju** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manju** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manju** accused of FIR No. 887/2021 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.12.2026.**

By Order: Sh. Sahil Gupta,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (North-West)
Court No. 06, Ground Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15061/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd Asad, S/o Md. Yamin, R/o Shop No. 27, DDA Flats, B-Block, Tulsi Nagar, Inderlok, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 322/2023, U/s 323/341/506 IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohd Asad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd Asad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd Asad** accused of **FIR No. 322/2023, U/s 323/341/506 IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.12.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Ankit Solanki
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04, Central
Room No. 37, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14936/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Satender Singh @ Shiva @ Tillu S/o** Devender Singh **R/o:** Hari Nagar Colony, Near Bittu General Store, Mandi Shyam Nagar, Near Dankaur Railway Station, Sikandrabad, GB Nagar, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 43/2021, U/s: 363 IPC, PS: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Satender Singh @ Shiva @ Tillu,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Satender Singh @ Shiva @ Tillu,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Satender Singh @ Shiva @ Tillu,** of **FIR No: 43/2021, U/s: 363 IPC, PS: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.12.2026.**

By Order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Room No. 06 Ground Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14961/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA, "e"-PROCUREMENT NOTICE WORKS DEPARTMENT

E-mail: ceworldbankprojects@gmail.com

34001/1038/2627

Bid Identification No. CE-Bridges-I-18/2026-27

1.	The Chief Engineer (Bridges-I), Odisha on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for construction of Road/Bridge work as detailed below:		
2.	Nature of work	:	Road work
3.	No. of work	:	01 No.
4.	Tender paper cost	:	Rs.10,000.00 (on-line)
5.	Class of Contractor	:	A/ Special Class Contractor
6.	Available of bid document in the website	:	From 10.00 AM of 22.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 12.11.2026
7.	Date of opening of Bid	:	Dt.13.11.2026 at 11.30 AM
8.	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: https://tenderodisha.gov.in. Any Addendum/ Corrigendum/ Cancellation will be hosted in the website only.		

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, Bridges-I,
Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR- 34001/34174/1/26-27/0033

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Javed Ali S/o MD. Ali R/o Ishwar ka Makan, H No. 216, Gali No. 23, Near Diler Mehndi Farm Nihar Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 571/2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Narela Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Javed Ali** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Javed Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Javed Ali** of **FIR No. 571/2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Narela Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **16.12.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/15042/ON/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Rajender Kumar S/o** Bani Singh **R/o** H.No. 746, Ward No. 1, Bahadur Garh, Distt: Jhajar, Haryana, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 910/14 U/s 3 DP DP Act**, has been registered at **PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Rajender Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Rajender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Rajender Kumar** of under **FIR No. 910/14 U/s 3 DP DP Act** Registred at: **PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.12.2026**.

By Order
Ms Anuradha Jindal
ACJM, Room No. 101
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15071/OD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Wazir S/o Sajan Singh R/o A-146, Harijan Basti, Patase Wali Gali, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 98/2024, U/s 25 Arms Act, PS Begumpur, Dist. Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Wazir** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Wazir** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Wazir** of case **FIR No. 98/2024, U/s 25 Arms Act, PS Begumpur, Dist. Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **21.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West, Court No. 101
1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15057/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

SA need six wickets to level Test series after Aus follow on

Reuters
Gqeberha, October 21

SOUTH AFRICA need six more wickets to complete a remarkable turnaround and win the second test against Australia, who were forced to follow on after being dismissed for 99 in their first innings on the fourth day at St George's Park in Gqeberha on Wednesday.

Australia were 156-4 in their second innings at close of play, still trailing by 170 runs after making a better fight of it than they had when crumbling under the South African attack earlier in the day.

But they were still facing an uphill task despite Travis Head edging close to a century. He will resume on 87 on the final day alongside nightwatchman Scott Boland, who is on two.

It was a day of tumbling wickets as Australia, resuming on 3-1, were skittled out for 99 an hour after lunch, leaving them with a 326-run deficit after South Africa had scored 425–9 declared in the first innings.

Lanky fast bowler Marco Jansen took 5-33 in 11 overs as he ripped through the tourists, who posted their fourth-lowest total against South Africa. Wiaan Mulder (2-14), Kagiso Rabada (2-33) and Anrich Nortje (1-5) took the other wickets.

It should have been a celebratory day for veteran Steve Smith, who reached the milestone of 11,000 test runs as he top-scored with 28 in the first innings.

The first two days of the test were largely washed out, but South Africa staged a major fightback on Tuesday after being 110-6 with captain Temba Bavuma turning the match on its head with a majestic 179-run knock.

BRIEF SCORES: South Africa 425/9d lead Australia 99 all out & 156/4 (Travis Head 87, Marnus Labuschagne 39, Matt Renshaw 11; Kagiso Rabada 2/30, Simon Harmer 2/47) by 170 runs.

BOUNCE, MOVEMENT, FAST BOWLERS

India's six-hitting phenoms face big pace test in New Zealand

After batting on flat tracks at home, can the top order trio of Sanju-Abhishek-Ishan adapt to conditions?

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 21



Sanju Samson signs autographs during a training session at the Hagley Oval, Christchurch. CREIMAS/PTI

IT DIDN'T take long for the thread to stop at Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in the press conference. The question's gist: "There is a lot of chatter around Vaibhav and his place in the eleven?" The reply from India's captain Shreyas Iyer was firm, rather than dismissive. "It is not like he can walk in right now, because our openers are scoring consistently, and they have won the World Cup."

It's reflection of India's glowing top-order riches that Sooryavanshi is bench-bound, or that Shubman Gill, Yashasvi Jaiswal, and Sai Sudharsan have coiled into a long queue behind him; or that the incredibly consistent KL Rahul is no longer in the selector' scheme. Iyer and the team management wouldn't fix a piece of furniture that is not broken.

Sanju Samson, Abhishek Sharma and Ishan Kishan have an imposing body of recent work, a post-modern approach that has won India the World Cup and multiple bilateral series, and hitting range the bowlers dread. Sanju was T20 World Cup's player of the tournament, Ishan helms the T20I batting rankings; Abhishek is No.2.

But they have only a lone practice session to acquaint themselves with the peculiar conditions of New Zealand. The evenings are windier, the nights are chillier, the sunlight during the day is brighter; the drop-in surfaces, specifically in Hagley Park, are quicker, bouncier and potentially with sideways movement with the new ball; the hosts' bowlers are interrogative than any others India have encountered in recent times. The circadian rhythm is desynchronised. In short, New Zealand and its caprices could show whether the perceivably glittering jewels in India's crown can shine in all conditions.

It's an examination with multiple layers. A test of technique as much as adaptability, a reflection of their courage, common sense, and cricketing wisdom. None of the surfaces would be as demonic as those that await Test batsmen in late November; some grounds are invitingly small and blissfully placid. But batting in New Zealand, irrespective of formats, could be demanding, requiring a heightened level of adapting, especially as India's batsmen have been indulged with ultra flat decks at home against the West Indies.

The troika of Sanju-Abhishek-Ishan is not hubristic enough to underestimate the conditions. The audience wouldn't probably see Sanju leaping to uppercut Jacob Duffy's hard-length ball; or Abhishek giving room and lashing Adam Milne through extra cover, or Ishan swirling Lockie Ferguson over deep fine-leg. They would obviously resort to these shots when the innings progress, but whether they temper their impulses and tweak their muscle memory at the start of the innings, would define their tours and keep the spots intact. Do they have the required gears, or the sufficient technique and flexibility, or the knack to makeover their game in one practice session?

Pakistan were shot out for 91 last year at the Hagley Oval in Christchurch, the sort of score India were plundering in powerplays against the West Indies recently. In 15 T20Is, only twice have teams scored more than 200. The average total is 159, boundaries are longer than most grounds in the country. New Zealand skipper Mitchell Santner warns that "there is always a bit (for the bowlers)." "Bhuvi would love these conditions," he adds. It is a roundabout way of saying that seamers could get some assistance.

All three have obvious flaws when the ball bends and leaps. Sanju's static feet led to a poor string of scores in Ireland and England in June (33 in four innings). His previous outings in New Zealand yielded him only 10 runs in two games. Abhishek is relatively judicious outside the off-stump on bouncy wickets abroad, but he has developed a habit of miscuing his pulls, often because he is hurried into the stroke or due to the extra bounce. The instinct to pull even hard length balls could be self-destructive in New Zealand. As is Ishan's inclination to heave across the line. England's seamers employed the short ball to good effect (dismissing him twice) as well.

True bounce

Hitting the length balls out of the park is not as straightforward as they are in the subcontinent either, owing to the bounce and hint of sideways movement. Since the 2025-26 season, New Zealand's seamers have averaged 23.41 per wicket at home, the second lowest in the world. Their economy rate has been 8.4 while picking a wicket every 17th ball. The last eight games have not produced a 200-plus total. But the positive is that the bounce would be true enough to play through the line, unlike those in Asian Games.

The conditions and ground dimensions could vary too. "You get to Wellington, dimensions again are different — short square (boundaries), longer straight... Hamilton is quite small, and Eden Park is small as well," Santner gives the local's tip.

In this vein, the series could not have been better timed. If the established trio fails, India have ample time to devise remedial measures for the World Cup defence in Australia and New Zealand the year after. They could probably experiment with a less dare-devilish batsman like Shubman Gill; they could rethink their full-throttle aggression guide. History throws up lessons — the man of the series in 2020, which India claimed 5-0, was KL Rahul, a batsman cast in a classical mould. The game has quickened up in six years, and his method could well be obsolete now.

But New Zealand offers a more strenuous assessment of top-order batsmen in this format than anywhere else in the world.

INDIA VS NEW ZEALAND: Live from 12:30 PM on Sony Sports Network and SonyLIV

Siva's advice for Kuldeep: Slow down



Kuldeep Yadav struggled for rhythm after the Sri Lanka series. FILE

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, October 21

A LOT of people had the same advice for Kuldeep Yadav: bowl quicker. Laxman Sivaramakrishnan told him to slow down.

The former India spinner calls the first piece of advice "probably the most unwanted advice that one can get as a spinner". Kuldeep, struggling for rhythm after the Sri Lanka series, reached out to Sivaramakrishnan, *The Indian Express* can reveal. What he got first was not a technical fix.

"First thing I did was, I reassured him," Sivaramakrishnan told this daily. "There was lot of slander on social media where a lot of them were saying he was finished. First thing I gave him was reassurance and said there are a few changes that you need to make in your action and if you do, you will be the number one bowler again. Giving him the confidence was foremost. He can still be a front line spinner for years to come. And spinners mature with age."

The technical inputs were specific: getting the front foot and back foot into line for a smooth transfer of body weight, imparting more revs, and bowling slower through the air.

The left-arm wrist spinner had endured a dip in form during the Test in Sri Lanka. Expected to play the role of lead spinner across formats, he had spent a considerable period warming the bench, and he appeared lost. As his childhood coach Kapil Pandey had revealed earlier, his action had been all over the place for months. His trajectory often remained flat and at times was quicker than usual.

Sivaramakrishnan saw why on video. "He was going far too across with his front leg. When we talk about alignment, we talk about the front foot and the back foot landing in a straight line. In Kuldeep's case, when I saw a video of his, he was going a long way across with his front leg and it meant his back leg was getting locked, so the transfer of body weight into the delivery was missing. And a lot of people were advising him to bowl quicker, saying you're too slow through off the pitch. That's when the batsmen are playing off the back foot."

The cost showed in the ball. Capable of turning it both ways, Kuldeep's strength over the years has been the ability to deceive batsmen with turn and bounce. Flatter and quicker, he let them play him from the crease.

"If you bowl faster through the air, the ball spends less time in the air," Sivaramakrishnan explains. "So the spin imparted on the ball and the revs on the ball will be far less because the ball is travelling very quickly through the air. So when that happens, the lack of revs and pace on the ball will make the ball skid onto the bat, making it easier to hit for the batters."

The fix was to use more of himself. "These days most spinners are bowling with their hands. So I told him to bowl with your body to be effective. Like if you're bowling with just your hands, you're using 20-25 percent of your body weight. If you bowl with your entire body, you're using 100 percent of your body weight, and that can happen only if alignment is straight at the point of release."

Implementing advice

During his stint with Yorkshire in County cricket, Kuldeep worked on the issues Sivaramakrishnan had highlighted. What followed was a different Kuldeep, one who extracted considerable turn and bounce even on green tops. "At the time of releasing the ball, the bowler should be on one leg. If he gets that in motion, because he's using his entire body, he need not bowl quicker through the air. So there is more spin, more revs on the ball. After pitching, it will grip and turn and also the chances of drifting as well," says the former spinner, who runs coaching clinics in different cities in India.

In the ODIs against West Indies at home earlier this month, Kuldeep showed what he can offer.

There are doubts whether India will use him on the smaller grounds in New Zealand, but Sivaramakrishnan says the call is straightforward. "Everybody who's involved is thinking from the batsman's point of view: good pitch, small ground, don't play a spinner. Actually, if you play a spinner, the batsman is going to take more chances, which should be an advantage for Kuldeep."

Sivaramakrishnan saw the proof on video when Kuldeep sent a stump flying in County cricket. "Normally, the stumps don't fly for a spinner, unless it's got enough momentum on the ball. But in England, I saw one of the dismissals where the stump was going flying. So I could make out that he's using his entire body in bowling. After seeing his success in England, he messaged me saying, 'thank you'."

Runs, relief, rage: Harman's mid-match tears show emotional side

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, October 21

HARMANPREET KAUR had powered India to 216/7 in the third T20I against Zimbabwe in Raipur, scoring an unbeaten 91 off 41 balls, when she came for the mid-innings interview. She started the chat smiling. But as the conversation moved forward, she began to tear up. "It feels great. Just wanted to enjoy myself, and it was great that I got some time in the middle and really enjoyed myself on the field. Just wanted to enjoy myself, just wanted to bat as long as possible, and glad that I was able to do that," she said.

"I think I should give credit to you also (speaking to WV Raman). The moment we came, you stepped in, and you said, 'Now you do what you want to do,' and that's what I want to do, and I really want to enjoy myself. Thanks for those words. After the two games, I got some time in the nets. I really want to thank Himanshu *bhaiya*, who's been working really hard on me, and today's batting is all about him," she added.

Harmanpreet struggled to hold back her tears as the interview progressed. When it ended, she lobbed the mic aside and walked away. Maybe, there was pent-up angst. Harmanpreet had stepped down as India's all-format captain two weeks ago, with Smriti Mandhana taking over. *The Indian Express* had reported that Harmanpreet wanted to continue as captain, but the selectors decided it was time for a change.



Harmanpreet Kaur scored an unbeaten 91 in 41 balls. CREIMAS

Sodhi felt her recent struggles with the bat, as well as the end of her captaincy, could have contributed to the reaction

Her childhood coach, Kamaldeesh Singh Sodhi, had never seen this side of her. "I have never seen her get so emotional," Sodhi told *The Indian Express*.

Sodhi felt her recent struggles with the bat, as well as the end of her captaincy, could have contributed to the reaction. "Since she stepped down as captain, this was her first good innings. That could be the main reason," he said.

Sodhi had advised her to play more openly. "I have told her to play openly. When you are the captain, there is a lot of pressure because of the result. Once the captaincy is gone, the mind becomes free. Then the only responsibility is batting. So there is some relaxation," he said.

Sodhi also said Harmanpreet turns to his son, Yadwinder, a migration lawyer based in Adelaide, when dealing with a "serious problem". "Whenever there is a serious problem, she discusses it with him," he said.

Yadwinder did not watch the match live but saw the highlights, including the interview. "I guess emotions come out when you don't perform. Our Indian culture is like this - when we don't perform, people get against any player," he said, referring to the criticism faced by established players such as Rohit Sharma.

Being no longer the captain, too, lifted some of her pressure, he said. "When she was playing as captain, she had to take responsibility. Sometimes she had to build the innings. There was always that fear - 'What will happen if she gets out?'" he said. "She got a green signal to play openly, which is actually her game," he added.

And one evening, after years of responsibility and scrutiny, Harmanpreet played with a free spirit, without the captain's burden.

● CONSISTENCY PAYS OFF

Shokeen's maiden five-for earns Delhi 3 points

Lalith Kalidas
New Delhi, October 21

JUST AS his lower-order pair returned to stave off the Delhi bowlers after lunch on Tuesday, Gujarat head coach Monty Desai had already turned his focus away from the play. Mid-session, he was in the nets with young Vedant Trivedi, who had cracked a century on debut last week and then failed here on a dormant strip.

The result at Air Force Ground B was a foregone conclusion even as Desai's trusted lieutenants, skipper Chintan Gaja and Manan Hingrajia, walked out in the morning, having neutralised the hosts with a stern partnership the previous evening. From their overnight 363/5 they still needed 286 for the decisive first-innings lead on day four of this second-round Ranji Trophy match. Hingrajia's resistance broke within the first 45 minutes, after nearly eight hours at the crease, and Gaja fell on 82, short of his maiden hundred, a little later. Desai turned to the more important task at hand.

Varying his pace on his loopy off-breaks, Desai tried to fine-tune Trivedi's judgement of lengths on deliveries that rose above his eyeline. "The earlier you judge, the harder you must go," he said. Not long before, out in the middle, Hingrajia's painstaking rearguard, 303 balls long, had been broken by a tossed-up delivery much like the ones Desai was bowling in the nets. Off-spinner Hrithik Shokeen's persistence finally trumped Hingrajia, who had erased an entire day from the match.

Five minutes after lunch, Shokeen dismissed Harshal Patel, leaving Delhi a wicket away from securing the innings lead. Desai didn't turn, his eyes fixed on Vedant's forward stride. Shokeen, however, would replay that moment in his head again.

A five-wicket haul had eluded the finger spinner in seven years as a professional. On a wicket where bowlers from both sides stood bereft of viable plans, Shokeen's five-for came from improved consistency across 53 overs.



Hrithik Shokeen had figures of 5/143 against Gujarat. PTI

Delhi had sifted through three new balls and 174 overs, but they were comfortable having another crack with the ball despite the workload. They enforced the follow-on, and the teams played on until the handshakes at tea. The three points gave Delhi some recovery after losing to Bengal in the first round. Big hundreds from Ayush Badoni and opener Priyansh Arya set up the game, but for a fledgling Delhi side, Shokeen's fortitude was the single key takeaway from Palam's paata.

Shokeen said the surface "wasn't the toughest pitch" to bowl on. "But yes, it was a hard-working wicket for us. Of course, it's a five-wicket haul, so it's very special," he said.

Shokeen made his T20 debut in the IPL for Mumbai Indians in 2022. With the arrival of the Impact Player rule and the shrinking role of the finger spinner, his career in the format stalled within a season.

He played only two Ranji matches last season and 10 professional matches in the last 22 months. Shokeen does not blame a lack of faith from the Delhi management. A stress fracture, uncommon for a spinner, curtailed his season, but the setback led to important tweaks in his bowling stride.

"I got injured after the 50-over games last year. I had a stress fracture in my back. My physio also told me that it was an unusual injury for a spinner to have a stress fracture in the back.

"But because of that, I worked a lot on my actions with the help of Vijay [Dahiya] sir. I worked a lot on my bowling line-up and follow-through. So because of that, I have gotten better," Shokeen told reporters.

Two gruelling days in the field ended with a reward for Shokeen (53-11-143-5) and for Ben Treloar, the Australian umpire who flew in for two Ranji Trophy games as part of an international exchange program.

The curtains were drawn soon after pacer Divij Mehra's delivery thudded low into Gujarat opener Aarya Desai's pads. After four days of quiet resignation to the batters' wont, Treloar could finally raise his finger for an LBW shout, an achievement in itself on a mulish pitch.

BRIEF SCORES: Delhi 648/8 declared in 120 overs drew with Gujarat 479 in 174.1 overs (Manan Hingrajia 123, Chintan Gaja 82; Hrithik Shokeen 5/143) and 15/1. Points: Delhi 3, Gujarat 1.

Saxena and Avasthi demolish, Saharan finishes, Jharkhand refuse to lose

SAXENA FIFER SEALS KERALA WIN

JALAJ SAXENA'S five-wicket haul helped Kerala complete an innings-and-36-run win over Odisha in the Group C match in Thiruvananthapuram. Odisha resumed their second innings on 102/4 and added only 41 before being bowled out for 143. Saxena finished with 5/34. Mohammed Azharuddeen's unbeaten 139 earned him the Player of the Match award.

BRIEF SCORES: Kerala 404 beat Odisha 225 and 143 all out (Gourav Choudhary 53, Subhranshu Senapati 30; Jalaj Saxena 5/34, Aditya Sarwate 2/45) by an innings and 36 runs. Points: Kerala 7, Odisha 0.

AVASTHI SPEARHEADS MUMBAI VICTORY

MOHIT AVASTHI'S five-wicket haul helped Mumbai make it two wins in a row as they beat Himachal Pradesh by an innings and 97 runs in the Group D match in Bilaspur. Mumbai declared on 528/8, and Himachal, who had made 140 in the first innings, were bowled out for 291. Avasthi finished with 5/44.



BRIEF SCORES: Mumbai 528/8 declared beat Himachal Pradesh 140 and 291 all out (Vaibhav Kalta 63, Pukhraj Mann 50; Mohit Avasthi 5/44, Shams Mulani 2/52, Tushar Deshpande 2/70) by an innings and 97 runs. Points: Mumbai 7, Himachal Pradesh 0.

SAHARAN STEERS PUNJAB HOME

UDAY SAHARAN followed his first-innings 161 with an unbeaten 40 as Punjab chased 86 to beat Chhattisgarh by seven wickets in the Group B match in New Chandigarh. Aayush Pandey's 111 gave Chhattisgarh hope, but Harjas Singh and Emanjot Singh Chahal took 3 wickets each to bowl them out for 335 and leave a small target.

BRIEF SCORES: Punjab 456 and 86/3 in 16.5 overs (Uday Saharan 40 not out; Dharmendrasinh Jadeja 2/40) beat Chhattisgarh 206 and 335 all out in 116.2 overs (Aayush Pandey 111, Amandeep Khare 62; Emanjot Singh Chahal 3/43, Harjas Singh 3/92) by seven wickets. Points: Punjab 6, Chhattisgarh 0.

SHIKHAR LEADS JHARKHAND RESISTANCE

SHIKHAR MOHAN'S 127 helped Jharkhand draw with Maharashtra in the Group C match in Pune. Jharkhand had conceded a first-innings lead of 358, but reached 344/8 in the second innings to deny Maharashtra an outright win. Utkarsh Singh made 58 and Aditya Singh 51 as Jharkhand held on.

BRIEF SCORES: Jharkhand 169 and 344/8 in 136 overs (Shikhar Mohan 127, Utkarsh Singh 58, Aditya Singh 51; Siddesh Veer 3/41, Rajvardhan Hangargekar 3/99) drew with Maharashtra 527/5 declared. Points: Maharashtra 3, Jharkhand 1.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

• DAY 3 HIGHLIGHTS



Ayush Verma won gold in the men's shot put (F53).

ATHLETICS GETS FIVE GOLDS
India's track-and-field contingent collected 22 medals on Wednesday, including five golds, with sprinter Simran, high-jumper Praveen Kumar and shot-putter Sachin Khilari also creating new Games records in their events. The other gold medal winners were Dilip Gavit (men's 100m T47) and Ayush Verma (men's shot put F53). Athletics has now accounted for 13 of the 14 gold medals won by India at Nagoya.

SHEETAL-PAYAL WIN SILVER
Archer Sheetal Devi picked up a women's doubles silver with Payal Nag after losing in the finals to China. In swimming, the visually impaired Ravi Kartik Budigina won his second silver of the Games, claiming the men's 100m backstroke medal in the S13 category. Powerlifter Kasthuri Rajamani won a silver medal in the women's 67kg category. The men's doubles pair of Krishna Nagar and Sivarajan Solaimalai picked up the SH6 category silver after finishing second in the group stage featuring just four teams. Medals were awarded based on group standings.

BADMINTON GLUT
India were assured of three medals in the men's singles SL4 (moderate lower-limb impairments) competition after Suhas LY, Naveen Sivakumar and Abhijeet Sakhuja advanced to the semis.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

PARA ASIAN GAMES

Preeti pays tribute to late training partner after winning silver medal

Sprinter, winner of two medals, gets emotional about Chirag Tyagi, who was shot dead by another athlete in May

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 21

WHEN INDIA'S Preeti Pal won her second silver medal at the Asian Para Games on Wednesday, she remembered her 'younger brother' and training partner Chirag Tyagi, who passed away in May. Chirag's dream of winning a medal for India was cut short when another para athlete shot him dead in Ghaziabad after suspecting his role in getting him disqualified from competitions. Preeti has no doubt that Chirag would have finished on the podium in Nagoya, Japan, if he had been alive.

Preeti and Simran Sharma — another top Indian sprinter with two gold medals at the ongoing Para Asian Games — trained along with Chirag at the JLN Stadium in New Delhi. Sharma's husband, Gajendra Singh, coached them. Memories of Chirag came flooding back when the two sprinters stood on the podium.

"Within a short time, Chirag became our trusted training partner. He was like a younger brother, but he guided us. By watching training and competition videos, Chirag was aware of the latest developments from around the world. I still remember him telling me, *'Preeti didi, ek din main bhi apki aur Simran didi ki tarah Paralympic aur Asian Games main medal jeetunga aur tirange ko rise hote dekhunga'* (One day I too will win medals for India in Paralympics and Asian Games and watch the Indian tricolour rise high). I dedicate the medals I won to Chirag," Preeti told *The Indian Express* from Nagoya.

Wednesday was a great day for the two women sprinters as they added to their medal haul. Preeti, who has cerebral palsy, won her second silver medal of the Games in the women's 100m T35 final with a time of 13.98 seconds. On Tuesday, she was second in the 200m (T35) final. Simran, who has impaired vision, made a sweep of gold medals. She won gold in the 200m T12 final on Wednesday and, in less than 24 hours, won the women's 100m T12 title with a new Asian Para Games record time of 12.02 seconds.

Shock and sadness

Preeti recalls the trauma she experienced when news about Tyagi's death broke. Preeti was in Hashimpur, Uttar Pradesh, to meet her family when Simran called with the bad news.

"Initially, we thought it was an accident. Some hours later, we were told that Chirag was murdered by a fellow athlete. It was a tough phase for us. Chirag stayed in the room opposite us at the stadium. When we are at the stadium, we are reminded of him every day," Preeti said.

Chirag's father Manoj and mother Nisha, based in Basantpur Saitli in Modinagar, followed Preeti and Simran's progress at the Para Asian Games.

"Chirag's life revolved around running. He was motivated by seeing Simran and Preeti winning medals for India. He also told us they took good care of him. On seeing Preeti and Simran win medals, we got joy because we know how close he was to both of them," Chirag's mother Nisha told this paper.

Both Preeti and Simran are in touch with Chirag's family and also helped them financially after his death.

"Simran, Preeti and Gajender (coach) have helped the family financially and call us often to check how we are doing," Manoj, who works as a supervisor, said.

Chirag, who competes in the category for athletes with vision impairment, qualified for the Para Asian Games in both the men's 400m and 1500m (T12) by winning gold at the 8th Indian Open Para Athletics International Championship held at Sri Kanteerava Stadium in Bengaluru in May. At the championship, Simran too met the qualification standards for the Para Asiad.

Last year, when Preeti won the women's 100m T35 final at the World Para Athletics Championships in New Delhi, Tyagi cheered for her from the stands.

"We had a deep bond," Preeti said. She regrets not tying a *rakhi* on Chirag's wrist. "Winning medals for India gives me joy. I wish Chirag were with us to share the joy."



Preeti Pal after winning a silver in the 100m T35 final. Preeti (2nd from R) with Chirag Tyagi (L) and Simran Sharma (2nd from L).



> **"Within a short time, Chirag became our trusted training partner. He was like a younger brother, but he guided us. By watching training and competition videos, Chirag was aware of the latest developments from around the world."**
> **PRITI PAL**
> PARA ASIAN GAMES MEDALLIST

• BRIEFLY



At 20, Kimi Antonelli can become the youngest F1 champ. REUTERS

Title beckons for Antonelli but he may have to wait a week or two

KIMI ANTONELLI is set to become Formula One's youngest champion, and Italy's first in 73 years, but the 20-year-old Mercedes driver will have to win and hope the stars align if he is to convert his first 'match point' in ☒Texas on Sunday. Four years old when Sebastian Vettel became the hitherto youngest champion at 23 with Red Bull in 2010, the racer from Bologna has a mighty 102-point lead over teammate George Russell ahead of the US Grand Prix in Austin. There will be a maximum 125 points remaining to win after the chequered flag drops at the Circuit of the Americas, meaning Antonelli will clinch the title if he extends his lead by 23. Only a win would give him that margin but the Italian will still need Russell and Ferrari's seven-time champion Lewis Hamilton to finish no higher than ninth or fifth. REUTERS

Anahat wins opener in Silicon Valley squash

INDIAN SQUASH player Anahat Singh moved into the second round of the Silicon Valley Open squash championship, which is being held in Redwood City, USA. She defeated Egypt's Nour Aboulmakarim 11-8, 11-8, 12-10 in her opener. The 18-year-old, who won a silver medal at the recent Asian Games, clinched the opening match in just 31 minutes. The reigning junior world champ will be playing against Egyptian world No.3 and top seed Nour Elsherbini next. PTI

Santner backs decision to not own team in MLC

CAPTAIN MITCHELL Santner backed New Zealand Cricket's decision to not own a team in the Major League Cricket's 2027 edition. The NZC on Wednesday announced that won't proceed with plans to have a team based in Toronto or Atlanta in the American league. "You can't do everything and it's going to be a solid investment in both," Santner said. "For them to try back a home soil competition is cool. If that gets it off the ground, that's what we want." PTI

Haryana beat MP to win Sr. National C'ship

HARYANA CAME from behind to defeat Hockey Madhya Pradesh 2-1 in their Division 'A' final and win the final of the 16th Hockey India Senior Men National Championship in Jhansi on Wednesday. Mohammad Zaid Khan gave Madhya Pradesh the lead with a field goal in the 14th minute but Haryana equalised in the second quarter when Navraj Singh scored a penalty corner in the 21st. The match stayed level until the 50th minute, when Joginder Singh scored the winner from a penalty corner. PTI

Ligue 1 game postponed amid unrest in France

TOULOUSE'S HOME Ligue 1 fixture against Troyes has been postponed from Saturday to Sunday at the request of the local prefecture, the French league's governing body LFP said on Wednesday. France had some of its worst unrest in years this month, with thousands of people arrested and shops looted or damaged during protests over high prices and declining public services. Following the protests, Toulouse imposed an overnight curfew in parts of the city, which is set to end on Sunday. REUTERS

Praveen overcomes a hip injury to reclaim high jump title

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 21

BETWEEN ATTEMPTS at the Asian Para Games, where he won the men's high jump T44/64 title with a season-best jump of 2.05metres at the Nagoya City Mizuho Park Athletics Stadium, reigning Paralympic champion Praveen Kumar was battling a bout of illness. He vomited and suffered coughing spells during the competition. Kumar had contracted a viral fever a few days after arriving in Japan and been struggling with a cough and fever for most of the week.

On Wednesday, when he cleared 2.05m, he bettered the previous Asian Para Games record of 1.95m in the T44 category to claim his second successive title.

"With the fever, cold and cough, training here became a difficult task, but I continued with short breaks. While my body felt fine during the final, my first jump gave me a severe headache. The mucus from my blocked nose and throat was also troubling me. I wanted to better my Asian Para Games record, and to achieve that in such a condition is a special feeling for me," Kumar tells *The Indian Express* from Japan.

At the Paris Paralympics, Kumar had upgraded his Tokyo silver medal to gold with a career-best jump of 2.08m, which remains the Asian record. He followed that up with a bronze medal at the World Para Athletics Championships in New Delhi last September, clearing 2.00m despite struggling with a hip injury.

The injury continued to hamper him, preventing him from crossing the 2.05m mark in the months that followed. A jump of 2.03m on the national circuit two months ago, however, offered hope of a comeback.

Ligament tear

Kumar, who has a congenital deformity in his left leg, struggled with his run-up and take-off while executing the Fosbury Flop technique.

"I suffered a ligament tear in my hip last year, which meant I could not generate enough power from the hip during take-off. When I planted my right knee to jump, my hip would hurt a lot and I could not generate the lift.

The first focus was to recover, followed by jumping exercises to strengthen the hip muscles and short sprints to build strength in my left leg. Not having a jump close to 2.05m was a bit demotivating, but I knew I had to recover and train fully to regain my old form," Kumar says.

Kumar, who initially learnt about high jumping by watching videos online, has trained under coach Satyapal Singh since 2018. With the injury stalling his progress towards bettering his personal best of 2.08m, Singh's first task was to keep the athlete motivated through regular conversations.

"Praveen's strength has always been his smooth take-off and clearance in the Fosbury Flop technique. While able-bodied high jumpers have to bend the non-leading knee during take-off, his deformity in the left leg means he does not have to worry about that aspect. He had good speed on the runway even at a young age and was also good at running the curve. His back-leaning position and flexibility during clearance were always good, and we only had to improve them with time," Singh says.

"He is a short high jumper, but he compensates for that disadvantage with almost perfect technique. After the injury, I knew rebuilding strength in his hip would take time, but I kept reminding him of his best jumps. I did not want him to think negatively," Singh adds.

> ***Kumar, who initially learnt about high jumping by watching videos online, has trained under coach Satyapal Singh since 2018.***

Two in a row

With his second successive Asian Para Games title secured, Kumar is already looking towards defending his Paralympic crown in Los Angeles. One of his biggest sources of inspiration is Canadian high jumper Derek Drouin, who won gold at the 2016 Rio Olympics with a jump of 2.38m.

"I have watched videos of Derek Drouin competing at the Rio Olympics almost daily. I closely observe how he generates explosiveness from his run-up and then almost stops at take-off to create vertical lift. Even though my left leg is not as strong as my right, I have been working on building its strength. I am also aiming to increase my run-up by one or two steps. It will take time to adjust, but I am confident I can surpass my personal best next season and work towards defending my title at the LA Paralympics," Kumar says.



High jump winner Praveen Kumar (R) with compatriot Banti, who came second at the Para Asian Games. SAI MEDIA

PSG beats Barcelona in Champions League thriller

Associated Press
Paris, October 21

PARIS SAINT-Germain was too powerful for even Lamine Yamal's magic as it ended Barcelona's 11-game winning run to top the Champions League table. A thrilling end to the game with four goals in the last 20 minutes delivered a statement win for PSG, which is joined Liverpool as the only teams with three victories after Alexis Mac Allister led a rousing 4-3 comeback triumph over Villarreal on Tuesday.

Barcelona needs to bounce back quickly ahead of a Clasico against Real Madrid on Sunday, now that its run of wins to start the season has ended. Defending champion PSG equalled a club record by going 13 Champions League games unbeaten.

Liverpool comeback

Eighteen-year-old Rio Ngumoha played a starring role in Liverpool's comeback, setting up goals for Ronald Araujo, Mac Allister and Florian Wirtz. Liverpool had been 2-0 down after an erratic start. Manchester City bounced back from defeat to PSG with a slick 5-1 win against AEK Athens, with top scorer Erling Haaland on the bench. Phil Foden scored a hat trick, with his second goal the pick of the bunch coming at the end of a sweeping attack. Atletico Madrid held on with 10 men for a 1-1 draw with Stuttgart, foiling the German underdog's bid to join PSG and Liverpool on nine points.

Julian Alvarez's goal for Atletico had canceled out Jamie Leweling's opener when midfielder Morten Hjulman made a reckless sliding tackle from behind on Angelo Stiller to leave Atletico clinging on.

Scott McTominay scored his first two goals of the season to help Napoli beat BodÃ¸/Glimt 4-3 and relieve pressure on coach Massimiliano Allegri. PSV won 1-0 against Porto, which slumped to a third loss.



Even Yamal had to look on as PSG beat Barcelona 4-2. REUTERS

• KEY RESULTS

PSG	4-2	Barcelona
Man City	5-1	AEK
Napoli	4-3	Bodo/Glimt
Porto	0-1	PSV
Roma	4-0	S Bratislava
Liverpool	4-3	Villarreal
Stuttgart	1-1	Atletico

• FRENCH OPEN

Sindhu defeats Katethong in roller-coaster first-round match

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, October 21

PV SINDHU doesn't need a biopic. She lives theatre or movie shorts — every day. Who freezes for 11 whole points from 19-8 up in the decider, and then flicks on a switch suddenly, before stretching out a climax for three match points?

The Indian brought the bright hues of autumnal leaves to her opening round match of the French Open, defeating old nemesis Supanida Katethong 21-14, 8-21, 23-21.

Sindhu was two points away from victory at 44 minutes in the match, but took 20 minutes of manic madness more to actually nail the win at the Tremblay en France in a commune arena on the outskirts of Paris.

"I kept calm and told myself, whatever has happened has happened. I need to focus on what's next. If I kept thinking about what happened earlier I'd have lost many more points and lost the match," she told *BWF* later.

The comms called it a crazy match, and it was because Sindhu contrived to create absolute cinema out of a regulation first round — by hitting snooze on the brink of a win.

And then crackling up like a threatening-to-defuse dynamite. The Thai leftie used to be an almighty headache for Sindhu once. Her southpaw angles troubled Sindhu at the most inopportune times, like playing in front of a home crowd at Delhi while guided by an ex-coach.

Since then, the Indian has started to assert her class. The comms even noted how Sindhu had gotten to the brink of a certain win in 40-odd minutes despite a third setter.

Win the first, catch her breath in the second and then race to the end in the third – Sindhu had it all figured out. So it was 19-8 and that's when Katethong started making her comeback.

Sindhu had gone into sleep-mode, returning mechanically, and bleeding points for no rhyme or reason except passivity. First it was 7 points in a row, yet panic hadn't hit. At 19-19, it whipped her face.

That Sindhu has weapons to go from 0 to 100 in a blink is known.

Shades of Venus

Her style of play tends to mirror that of Venus Williams at times, who when playing an Olympic doubles medal confirming match with Rajeev Ram in tennis at Rio, suddenly woke up and flattened Mirza-Bopanna, with no intimation of her summoning of powers. Sindhu has understated howitzers, fitted with silencers, but she boomed like Venus is Paris. A rasping smash that would've dented a softer surface than the synth court carpet. 20-19.

It still wasn't over.

An error here, the shuttle grazing the line there, and Supanida could've dreamt of a humongous come-from-behind win. But Sindhu's attack grows intimidating when she gets in the mood to annihilate.

So she pulled off three big offensive moves, and let the Thai panic after having climbed the mountain. When she was done with her, Sindhu appreciated graciously with a smile and a pat.

"Helluva match I would say. But I'm happy I'm on the winning side because I was leading by a lot. I was playing my game, but she had nothing to lose. She was playing outright and whatever she played, landed in. By the time points got closer, I was trying to be safer. But it was important to go all out after 20-all because it was anyone's game. I had to play my game irrespective of the score. One point here or there and the match was gone," she admitted to the *BWF* later.

Her power remains pristine, the strokes are evolved, but the stamina does let her down at 31. She still has the power smash – one zing to rule them all.

All, save An Se-young. Yet, it is those utterly befuddling lapses like 19-8 to 19-19 that make Sindhu entertaining. She took 64 minutes to wrap up something she could've clinically finished in under 45.

And why she freezes remains a mystery.

How she unfreezes and boils over onto her opponents' hopes is the sequel.



In the decider, PV Sindhu conceded 11 points in a row after leading 19-8 but won 23-21 to beat Supanida Katethong. FILE

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